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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 10/13/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
10/13/2026	ELECTRONIC

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sek@toolpat.com

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APPLICATION NO.	ISSUE DATE	PATENT NO.
19/075,701	13-Oct-2026	12763045

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
Arlington, VA 22213

EGRANT NOTIFICATION

Your electronic patent grant (eGrant) is now available, which can be accessed via Patent Center at https://patentcenter.uspto.gov

The electronic patent grant is the official patent grant under 35 U.S.C. 153. For more information, please visit https://www.uspto.gov/electronicgrants

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APPLICATION NO.	ISSUE DATE	PATENT NO.	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	10/13/2026	12763045	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 09/30/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

ISSUE NOTIFICATION

The projected patent number and issue date are specified above. The patent will issue electronically. The electronically issued patent is the official patent grant pursuant to 35 U.S.C. § 153. The patent may be accessed on or after the issue date through Patent Center at https://patentcenter.uspto.gov/. The patent will be available in both the public and the private sides of Patent Center. Further assistance in electronically accessing the patent, or about Patent Center, is available by calling the Patent Electronic Business Center at 1-866-217-9197.

The USPTO will automatically mail a courtesy ceremonial copy of the electronic patent grant to the correspondence address of record if the issue fee was paid before March 9, 2026. If the issue fee was paid on or after March 9, 2026, a courtesy ceremonial copy will be mailed if the applicant opted-in to receiving it. Additional copies of the patent (i.e., certified and presentation copies) may be ordered for a fee from the USPTO's Certified Copy Center at https://certifiedcopycenter.uspto.gov/index.html. The Certified Copy Center may be reached at (800)972-6382.

Determination of Patent Term Adjustment under 35 U.S.C. 154 (b)
(application filed on or after May 29, 2000)

The Patent Term Adjustment is 0 day(s). Any patent to issue from the above-identified application will include an indication of the adjustment on the front page.

If a Continued Prosecution Application (CPA) was filed in the above-identified application, the filing date that determines Patent Term Adjustment is the filing date of the most recent CPA.

Applicant will be able to obtain more detailed information by accessing the Patent Center (https://patentcenter.uspto.gov).

Any questions regarding the Patent Term Extension or Adjustment determination should be directed to the Office of Patent Legal Administration at (571)-272-7702. Questions relating to issue and publication fee payments should be directed to the Application Assistance Unit (AAU) of the Office of Patents Stakeholder Experience (OPSE), Stakeholder Support Division (SSD) at (571)-272-4200.

INVENTOR(s) (Please see PATENT CENTER site https://patentcenter.uspto.gov for additional inventors):

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

APPLICANT(s) (Please see PATENT CENTER site https://patentcenter.uspto.gov for additional applicants):

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Ceremonial Copy Requested

APPLICATION #	ATTORNEY DOCKET #	FILED ON
19075701	**LMK-001.01**	**03/10/2025**

Applicant requests a courtesy ceremonial copy of the electronic patent grant for application 19075701 on 08/19/2026 12:14:45 PM. Applicant understands that the electronic patent grant is the official statutory patent grant.

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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**08/19/2026 12:14:45 PM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	80500541	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 1

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
web85b.pdf	3	Issue Fee Payment (PTO-85B)	57 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
web85b.pdf	6F31816C0CDABE5EE3488055F4F8289AF50317133067ABA22 C7E61135FA23D41562A9EA1122B14153CEAD4CDFEA13FBF9 E30FDDF61FCE3FD2172A1AD03B303F7

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New Applications Under 35 U.S.C. 111

If a new application is being filed and the application includes the necessary components for filing date (see 37 CFR 1.53(b)-(d) and MPEP 506), a Filing Receipt (37 CFR 1.54) will be issued in due course and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the filing date of the application

National Stage of an International Application under 35 U.S.C. 371

If a timely submission to enter the national stage of an international application is compliant with the conditions of 35 U.S.C. 371 and other applicable requirements a Form PCT/DO/EO/903 indicating acceptance of the application as a national stage submission under 35 U.S.C. 371 will be issued in addition to the Filing Receipt, in due course.

New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

If a new international application is being filed and the international application includes the necessary components for an international filing date (see PCT Article 11 and MPEP 1810), a Notification of the International Application Number and of the International Filing Date (Form PCT/RO/105) will be issued in due course, subject to prescriptions concerning national security, and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the international filing date of the application.

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ELECTRONIC PAYMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**08/19/2026 12:14:45 PM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	80500541	AUTHORIZED BY	-
CUSTOMER #	178888	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz

Payment Information

PAYMENT METHOD	PAYMENT TRANSACTION ID	PAYMENT AUTHORIZED BY
CARD / 6274	**E20268IC15569919**	**SCOTT KAMHOLZ**

FEE CODE	DESCRIPTION	ITEM PRICE($)	QUANTITY	ITEM TOTAL($)
3501	UTILITY ISSUE FEE	258.00	1	258.00
			TOTAL AMOUNT:	**$258.00**

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New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

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ISSUE FEE TRANSMITTAL FORM

APPLICATION #	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19075701	**03/10/2025**	**Leah Kamholz**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	DATE DUE	08/20/2026
CONFIRMATION #	3414	ISSUE FEE DUE	$ 258
EXAMINER	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	PUBLICATION DUE	$ 0
GROUP ART UNIT	3619	TOTAL FEES DUE	$258
CLASS - SUBCLASS	084/382000	PREV. PAID FEE	$ 0
ENTITY STATUS	Micro		

1. CHANGE OF CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS AND/OR INDICATION OF FEE ADDRESS (37 CFR 1.33 & 1.363)

Correspondence Address

CURRENT ADDRESS

Maintenance Fee Address

CURRENT ADDRESS

☐ Change of correspondence address requested,system generated AIA/122-PC form attached

☐ Fee address indication requested, system generatedSB/47-PC form attached

2. ENTITY STATUS

Change in Entity Status

NEW STATUS

3. THE FOLLOWING FEES ARE SUBMITTED

☑ Issue Fee

☑ Publication Fee

4. FEE AUTHORIZATION

☐ I authorize USPTO to apply my previously paid issue fee to the current fees due

☐ The Director is herby authorized to apply my previously paid issue fee to the current fee due and to charge deficient fees to Deposit Account Number:

☐ If in addition to the payment of the issue fee amount submitted with this form, there are any discrepencies in any amount(s) due, the Director is authorized to charge any deficiency, or credit any overpayment, to Deposit Account Number:

5. FIRM AND/OR ATTORNEY NAMES TO BE PRINTED

NOTE: If no name is listed, no name will be printed
For printing on the patent front page, list to be displayed as entered

6. ASSIGNEE NAME(S) AND RESIDENCE DATA TO BE PRINTED

NOTE: Unless an assignee is identified below, no assignee data will appear on the patent. If an assignee is identified below, the document has been filed for recordation as set forth in 37 CFR 3.11. Completion of this form is NOT a susbstitute for filing an assignment.

Signature

I certify, in accordance with 37 CFR 1.4(d)(4) that I am an attorney or agent registered to practice before the Patent and Trademark Office who has filed and has been granted power of attorney in this application. I also certify that this Fee(s) Transmittal form is being transmitted to the USPTO via Patent Center on the date indicated below.

Signature	Name	Registration #	Date
/Scott E. Kamholz/	SCOTT KAMHOLZ	48543	08/19/2026

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 07/15/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
07/15/2026	ELECTRONIC

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Response to Rule 312 Communication	Application No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s)
	Examiner	Art Unit

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address –

1. ☒ The amendment filed on 6/13/2026 under 37 CFR 1.312 has been considered, and has been:

a) ☒ entered.

b) ☐ entered as directed to matters of form not affecting the scope of the invention.

c) ☐ disapproved because the amendment was filed after the payment of the issue fee.

Any amendment filed after the date the issue fee is paid must be accompanied by a petition under 37 CFR 1.313(c)(1) and the required fee to withdraw the application from issue.

d) ☐ disapproved. See explanation below.

e) ☐ entered in part. See explanation below.

C. GARNER, for
Publishing Division

IN THE UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

Application No.: 19/075,701 Filing Date: March 10, 2025 Inventor: Kamholz, Leah M. Title: *Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters* (as amended) Attorney Docket No.: LMK-001.01	Confirmation No.: 3414 Customer No.: 178888 Certificate of Electronic Transmission I hereby certify that this correspondence is being transmitted via the USPTO electronic filing system on 2026-06-13. By: /Scott E. Kamholz/ Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

AMENDMENT C AFTER ALLOWANCE UNDER 37 C.F.R. § 1.312

To the Commissioner for Patents:

Applicant responds to the Notice to File Corrected Application Papers issued June 4, 2026.

Please amend the Specification and drawings as indicated on the following pages.

Remarks follow the amendments.

AMENDMENTS TO THE SPECIFICATION

Replace paragraph [0019] with the following amended paragraph:

[0019] FIG. 12 ~~is a photograph of~~ depicts a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings.

Replace paragraph [0020] with the following amended paragraph:

[0020] FIG. 13 ~~is a photograph of~~ depicts a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings with a player's hands in position pressing each of the rings to its closed position.

Replace paragraph [0031] with the following amended paragraph:

[0031] FIG. 12 ~~is a photograph of~~ depicts a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings. Each adapter was cut from a piece of electrical tape and placed on the top surface of each tone hole ring with its adhesive surface contacting the ring. A hole was cut in the center of each piece of electrical tape to serve as an aperture. **FIG. 13** ~~is a photograph of~~ depicts the same clarinet shown in **FIG. 12** with a player's hands positioned on the clarinet and holding all visible tone hole rings in their closed positions.

AMENDMENTS TO THE DRAWINGS

The attached replacement drawing sheet 5 presents revised Fig. 12 and Fig. 13.

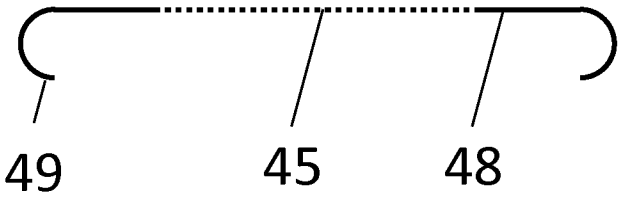


FIG. 10

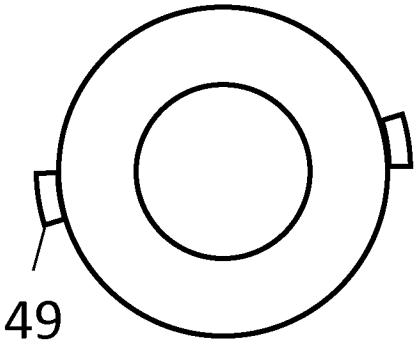


FIG. 11

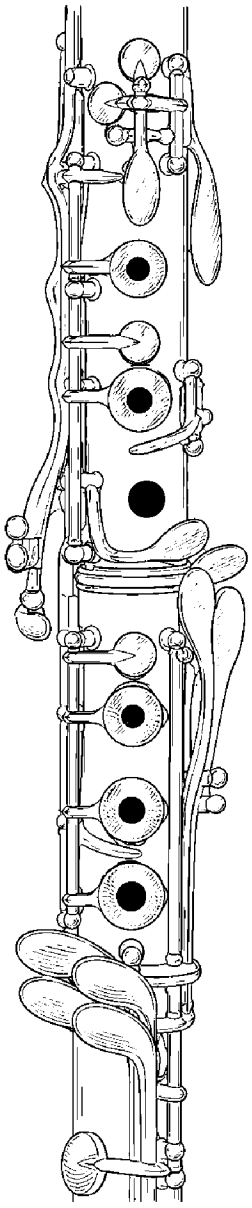


FIG. 12

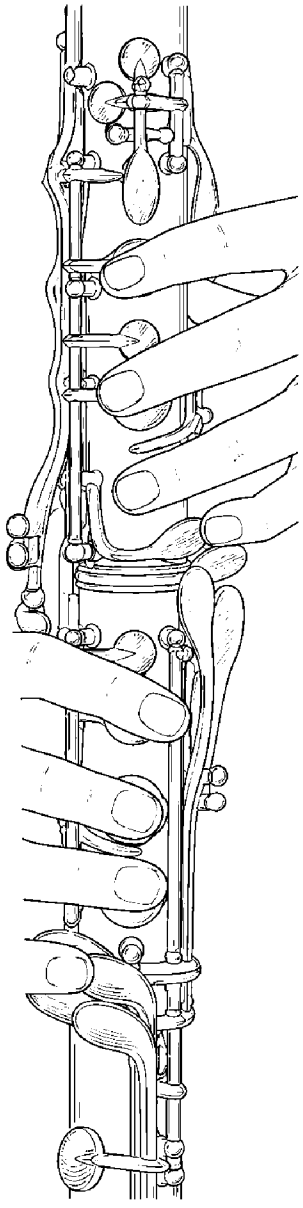


FIG. 13

REMARKS

Amendments to Drawings and Specification

Fig. 12 and Fig. 13 are amended in accordance with the "Notice to File Corrected Application Papers" issued June 4, 2026 which required Applicant to replace the photographs depicted in those figures with line drawings. Paragraphs [0019], [0020], and [0031] are amended to remove references to "photograph." No new matter is entered.

Applicant asks the Examiner or Publication Branch to contact the attorney of record in case this Amendment cannot be entered or otherwise leaves any issues unresolved.

Respectfully submitted,

Date: 2026-06-13

By: /Scott E. Kamholz/
Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543
Attorney for Applicant
Telephone: 617-678-0222

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19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 06/04/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
06/04/2026	ELECTRONIC

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Application No. : 19075701
Applicant : Kamholz
Filing Date : 03/10/2025
Date Mailed : 06/04/2026

NOTICE TO FILE CORRECTED APPLICATION PAPERS

Notice of Allowance Mailed

This application has been accorded an Allowance Date and is being prepared for issuance. The application, however, is incomplete for the reasons below.

Applicant is given two (2) months from the mail date of this Notice within which to respond. This time period for reply is extendable under 37 CFR 1.136(a) for only TWO additional MONTHS.

The informalities requiring correction are indicated in the attachment(s). If the informality pertains to the abstract, specification (including claims) or drawings, the informality must be corrected with an amendment in compliance with 37 CFR 1.121 (or, if the application is a reissue application, 37 CFR 1.173). Such an amendment may be filed after payment of the issue fee if limited to correction of informalities noted herein. See Waiver of 37 CFR 1.312 for Documents Required by the Office of Patent Publication, 1280 Off. Gaz. Patent Office 918 (March 23, 2004). In addition, if the informality is not corrected until after payment of the issue fee, for purposes of 35 U.S.C. 154(b)(1)(iv), "all outstanding requirements" will be considered to have been satisfied when the informality has been corrected. A failure to respond within the above-identified time period will result in the application being ABANDONED.

See attachment(s).

A copy of this notice MUST be returned with the reply. Please address response to "Mail Stop Issue Fee, Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450".

/Naran Hem/
Publication Branch
Office of Data Management
(571) 272-4200

Application No. 19075701 **Drawings filed: 03/10/2025**

IDENTIFICATION OF DRAWING DEFICIENCIES

- [ ] There is a hole or the image thereof within the illustration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The illustration is penetrated or traversed by a solid or broken line that is not intended to be part of the drawing, such as a dark line caused by a flaw in the copying process. FIG(s)
- [ ] An ink stamp or the image thereof obscures part of the illustration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing is marred by black smudges, obliterations, or fax/copier marks (for example, speckles or dots in a substantial portion of the drawing). FIG(s)
- [ ] Figure numbers are duplicated or missing. FIG(s)
- [ ] Drawing sheet or figure is missing. FIG(s)
- [ ] Numbers, letters, or reference characters in the drawing have been crossed out or are illegibly handwritten. FIG(s)
- [ ] The character of the lines, numbers, and letters is poor. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing's background shows that the original drawing was made on graph paper or other paper with a pattern or decoration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The FIG. number label is placed in a location that causes the drawing to be read upside down. FIG(s)
- [ ] Data, a reference number, or part of the drawing is truncated or missing, or a lead line has no reference number. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing and/or the FIG. label contain(s) foreign language. FIG(s)
- [X] This utility application contains a photograph of a view that is capable of being illustrated as a line drawing. FIG(s) 12, 13
- [ ] A petition under 37 CFR 1.84(a)(2) to accept color drawings has been granted, but the brief description of the drawings in the specification does not contain (or has not been amended to contain) the paragraph required by 37 CFR 1.84(a)(2)(iii).
- [ ] This reissue application contains added and/or amended drawings that are not labeled as “New” or “Amended” or “Canceled” as required by 37 CFR 1.173(b)(3). FIG(s)
- [ ] This Design reissue application contains a drawing that is labeled as “Canceled” but is not surrounded by brackets, or a drawing that is surrounded by brackets but is not labeled as “Canceled.” See 37 CFR 1.173(b)(3). FIG(s)
- [ ] OTHER:
- [ ] COMMENTS:

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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**06/13/2026 02:42:27 PM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	77395790	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 4

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
LMK-00101-amendment-C-after-allowance-APP.TEXT.docx	0	Application body structured text document	39 KB
Warning: The automatic document description has been replaced.			
LMK-00101-replacement-sheet-5.pdf	1	Drawings-only black and white line drawings	66 KB
Notice_to_file_Corrected_Application_Papers.pdf	3	Applicant Response to Pre-Exam Formalities Notice	107 KB
LMK-00101-amendment-C-after-allowance.pdf	4	Auxiliary PDF of Application	217 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
LMK-00101-amendment-C-after-allowance-APP.TEXT.docx	5B117B47E1F12CB49750D09B2E7EF90172334B24D4AEB4B167968AED8B0793A6D9F2984D8998B15B4523E9E99FFD4D5E70CDAA0693C0A7A9B95565796D04B6E9
LMK-00101-replacement-sheet-5.pdf	F9581BDA3A11F77738E6C6F721F1B0FB3349BD0B1EBAD4EAD818A855B69411C2901D98A48D0D5A8402E14AE0478F90385C3A5074E2BABDDA4E514A423F9A2C34
Notice_to_file_Corrected_Application_Papers.pdf	226D4E13C7F1CB3424F205F70DFCB8BAA105A40DFD66B9DD5CED26D2F236B847CE613A340C00C3146E17FCB9A3F996DECE44B5F3D21EBD6CF96A36398065B1A4
LMK-00101-amendment-C-after-allowance.pdf	C159D3418778B08A2CB968118D7FE53CB336034ACFFE966E266193FB9728CEAFEE8CC6B42067BCE1CF39386C76794AABCC70EF53A29B9EDC011FD65A51C37C2D

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 06/04/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
06/04/2026	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

sek@toolpat.com

UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

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Application No. : 19075701
Applicant : Kamholz
Filing Date : 03/10/2025
Date Mailed : 06/04/2026

NOTICE TO FILE CORRECTED APPLICATION PAPERS

Notice of Allowance Mailed

This application has been accorded an Allowance Date and is being prepared for issuance. The application, however, is incomplete for the reasons below.

Applicant is given two (2) months from the mail date of this Notice within which to respond. This time period for reply is extendable under 37 CFR 1.136(a) for only TWO additional MONTHS.

The informalities requiring correction are indicated in the attachment(s). If the informality pertains to the abstract, specification (including claims) or drawings, the informality must be corrected with an amendment in compliance with 37 CFR 1.121 (or, if the application is a reissue application, 37 CFR 1.173). Such an amendment may be filed after payment of the issue fee if limited to correction of informalities noted herein. See Waiver of 37 CFR 1.312 for Documents Required by the Office of Patent Publication, 1280 Off. Gaz. Patent Office 918 (March 23, 2004). In addition, if the informality is not corrected until after payment of the issue fee, for purposes of 35 U.S.C. 154(b)(1)(iv), "all outstanding requirements" will be considered to have been satisfied when the informality has been corrected. A failure to respond within the above-identified time period will result in the application being ABANDONED.

See attachment(s).

A copy of this notice MUST be returned with the reply. Please address response to "Mail Stop Issue Fee, Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450".

/Naran Hem/
Publication Branch
Office of Data Management
(571) 272-4200

Application No. 19075701 **Drawings filed: 03/10/2025**

IDENTIFICATION OF DRAWING DEFICIENCIES

- [ ] There is a hole or the image thereof within the illustration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The illustration is penetrated or traversed by a solid or broken line that is not intended to be part of the drawing, such as a dark line caused by a flaw in the copying process. FIG(s)
- [ ] An ink stamp or the image thereof obscures part of the illustration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing is marred by black smudges, obliterations, or fax/copier marks (for example, speckles or dots in a substantial portion of the drawing). FIG(s)
- [ ] Figure numbers are duplicated or missing. FIG(s)
- [ ] Drawing sheet or figure is missing. FIG(s)
- [ ] Numbers, letters, or reference characters in the drawing have been crossed out or are illegibly handwritten. FIG(s)
- [ ] The character of the lines, numbers, and letters is poor. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing's background shows that the original drawing was made on graph paper or other paper with a pattern or decoration. FIG(s)
- [ ] The FIG. number label is placed in a location that causes the drawing to be read upside down. FIG(s)
- [ ] Data, a reference number, or part of the drawing is truncated or missing, or a lead line has no reference number. FIG(s)
- [ ] The drawing and/or the FIG. label contain(s) foreign language. FIG(s)
- [X] This utility application contains a photograph of a view that is capable of being illustrated as a line drawing. FIG(s) 12, 13
- [ ] A petition under 37 CFR 1.84(a)(2) to accept color drawings has been granted, but the brief description of the drawings in the specification does not contain (or has not been amended to contain) the paragraph required by 37 CFR 1.84(a)(2)(iii).
- [ ] This reissue application contains added and/or amended drawings that are not labeled as “New” or “Amended” or “Canceled” as required by 37 CFR 1.173(b)(3). FIG(s)
- [ ] This Design reissue application contains a drawing that is labeled as “Canceled” but is not surrounded by brackets, or a drawing that is surrounded by brackets but is not labeled as “Canceled.” See 37 CFR 1.173(b)(3). FIG(s)
- [ ] OTHER:
- [ ] COMMENTS:

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NOTICE OF ALLOWANCE AND FEE(S) DUE

178888 7590 05/20/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	
ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

DATE MAILED: 05/20/2026

APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

TITLE OF INVENTION: Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

APPLN. TYPE	ENTITY STATUS	ISSUE FEE DUE	PUBLICATION FEE DUE	PREV. PAID ISSUE FEE	TOTAL FEE(S) DUE	DATE DUE
nonprovisional	MICRO	$258	$0.00	$0.00	$258	08/20/2026

THE APPLICATION IDENTIFIED ABOVE HAS BEEN EXAMINED AND IS ALLOWED FOR ISSUANCE AS A PATENT. PROSECUTION ON THE MERITS IS CLOSED. THIS NOTICE OF ALLOWANCE IS NOT A GRANT OF PATENT RIGHTS. THIS APPLICATION IS SUBJECT TO WITHDRAWAL FROM ISSUE AT THE INITIATIVE OF THE OFFICE OR UPON PETITION BY THE APPLICANT. SEE 37 CFR 1.313 AND MPEP 1308.

THE ISSUE FEE AND PUBLICATION FEE (IF REQUIRED) MUST BE PAID WITHIN THREE MONTHS FROM THE MAILING DATE OF THIS NOTICE OR THIS APPLICATION SHALL BE REGARDED AS ABANDONED. THIS STATUTORY PERIOD CANNOT BE EXTENDED. SEE 35 U.S.C. 151. THE ISSUE FEE DUE INDICATED ABOVE DOES NOT REFLECT A CREDIT FOR ANY PREVIOUSLY PAID ISSUE FEE IN THIS APPLICATION. IF AN ISSUE FEE HAS PREVIOUSLY BEEN PAID IN THIS APPLICATION (AS SHOWN ABOVE), THE RETURN OF PART B OF THIS FORM WILL BE CONSIDERED A REQUEST TO REAPPLY THE PREVIOUSLY PAID ISSUE FEE TOWARD THE ISSUE FEE NOW DUE.

HOW TO REPLY TO THIS NOTICE:

I. Review the ENTITY STATUS shown above. If the ENTITY STATUS is shown as SMALL or MICRO, verify whether entitlement to that entity status still applies.

If the ENTITY STATUS is the same as shown above, pay the TOTAL FEE(S) DUE shown above.

If the ENTITY STATUS is changed from that shown above, on PART B - FEE(S) TRANSMITTAL, complete section number 5 titled "Change in Entity Status (from status indicated above)".

For purposes of this notice, small entity fees are 40% the amount of undiscounted fees, and micro entity fees are 20% the amount of undiscounted fees.

II. PART B - FEE(S) TRANSMITTAL, or its equivalent, must be completed and returned to the United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) with your ISSUE FEE and PUBLICATION FEE (if required). If you are charging the fee(s) to your deposit account, section "4b" of Part B - Fee(s) Transmittal should be completed. If an equivalent of Part B is filed, a request to reapply a previously paid issue fee must be clearly made, and delays in processing may occur due to the difficulty in recognizing the paper as an equivalent of Part B.

III. All communications regarding this application must give the application number. Please direct all communications prior to issuance to Mail Stop ISSUE FEE unless advised to the contrary.

IMPORTANT REMINDER: Maintenance fees are due in utility patents issuing on applications filed on or after Dec. 12, 1980. It is patentee's responsibility to ensure timely payment of maintenance fees when due. More information is available at www.uspto.gov/PatentMaintenanceFees.

PART B - FEE(S) TRANSMITTAL

Complete and send this form, together with applicable fee(s), by mail or fax, or via the USPTO patent electronic filing system.

By mail, send to: Mail Stop ISSUE FEE
Commissioner for Patents
P.O. Box 1450
Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450

By fax, send to: (571)-273-2885

INSTRUCTIONS: This form should be used for transmitting the ISSUE FEE and PUBLICATION FEE (if required). Blocks 1 through 6 should be completed where appropriate. All further correspondence will be mailed to the current correspondence address as indicated unless corrected below or directed otherwise in Block 1, by (a) specifying a new correspondence address; and/or (b) indicating a separate "FEE ADDRESS" for maintenance fee notifications. **Because electronic patent issuance may occur shortly after issue fee payment, any desired continuing application should preferably be filed prior to payment of this issue fee in order not to jeopardize copendency.**

CURRENT CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS (Note: Use Block 1 for any change of address)

178888 7590 05/20/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

Note: A certificate of mailing can only be used for domestic mailings of the Fee(s) Transmittal. This certificate cannot be used for any other accompanying papers. Each additional paper, such as an assignment or formal drawing, must have its own certificate of mailing or transmission.

Certificate of Mailing or Transmission

I hereby certify that this Fee(s) Transmittal is being deposited with the United States Postal Service with sufficient postage for first class mail in an envelope addressed to the Mail Stop ISSUE FEE address above, or being transmitted to the USPTO via the USPTO patent electronic filing system or by facsimile to (571) 273-2885, on the date below.

(Typed or printed name)
(Signature)
(Date)

APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

TITLE OF INVENTION: Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

APPLN. TYPE	ENTITY STATUS	ISSUE FEE DUE	PUBLICATION FEE DUE	PREV. PAID ISSUE FEE	TOTAL FEE(S) DUE	DATE DUE
nonprovisional	MICRO	$258	$0.00	$0.00	$258	08/20/2026

EXAMINER	ART UNIT	CLASS-SUBCLASS
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	3619	084-382000

1. Change of correspondence address or indication of "Fee Address" (37 CFR 1.363).

❑ Change of correspondence address (or Change of Correspondence Address form PTO/AIA/122 or PTO/SB/122) attached.

❑ "Fee Address" indication (or "Fee Address" Indication form PTO/AIA/47 or PTO/SB/47; Rev 03-02 or more recent) attached. **Use of a Customer Number is required.**

2. For printing on the patent front page, list
(1) The names of up to 3 registered patent attorneys or agents OR, alternatively,
(2) The name of a single firm (having as a member a registered attorney or agent) and the names of up to 2 registered patent attorneys or agents. If no name is listed, no name will be printed.

1 _____
2 _____
3 _____

3. ASSIGNEE NAME AND RESIDENCE DATA TO BE PRINTED ON THE PATENT (print or type)

PLEASE NOTE: Unless an assignee is identified below, no assignee data will appear on the patent. If an assignee is identified below, the document must have been previously recorded, or filed for recordation, as set forth in 37 CFR 3.11 and 37 CFR 3.81(a). Completion of this form is NOT a substitute for filing an assignment.

(A) NAME OF ASSIGNEE (B) RESIDENCE: (CITY and STATE OR COUNTRY)

Please check the appropriate assignee category or categories (will not be printed on the patent) : ❑ Individual ❑ Corporation or other private group entity ❑ Government

4a. Fees submitted: ❑Issue Fee ❑Publication Fee (if required)

4b. Method of Payment: *(Please first reapply any previously paid fee shown above)*

❑ Electronic Payment via the USPTO patent electronic filing system ❑ Enclosed check ❑ Non-electronic payment by credit card (Attach form PTO-2038)

❑ The Director is hereby authorized to charge the required fee(s), any deficiency, or credit any overpayment to Deposit Account No. _____

5. **Change in Entity Status** (from status indicated above)

❑ Applicant certifying micro entity status. See 37 CFR 1.29

NOTE: Absent a valid certification of Micro Entity Status (see forms PTO/SB/15A and 15B), issue fee payment in the micro entity amount will not be accepted at the risk of application abandonment.

❑ Applicant asserting small entity status. See 37 CFR 1.27

NOTE: If the application was previously under micro entity status, checking this box will be taken to be a notification of loss of entitlement to micro entity status.

❑ Applicant changing to regular undiscounted fee status.

NOTE: Checking this box will be taken to be a notification of loss of entitlement to small or micro entity status, as applicable.

6. **Courtesy Ceremonial Copy**

❑ Applicant requests a courtesy ceremonial copy of the electronic patent grant. Applicant understands that the electronic patent grant is the official statutory patent grant.

NOTE: This form must be signed in accordance with 37 CFR 1.31 and 1.33. See 37 CFR 1.4 for signature requirements and certifications.

Authorized Signature _____ Date _____

Typed or printed name _____ Registration No. _____

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 05/20/2026

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EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	
ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

DATE MAILED: 05/20/2026

Determination of Patent Term Adjustment under 35 U.S.C. 154 (b)
(Applications filed on or after May 29, 2000)

The Office has discontinued providing a Patent Term Adjustment (PTA) calculation with the Notice of Allowance.

Section 1(h)(2) of the AIA Technical Corrections Act amended 35 U.S.C. 154(b)(3)(B)(i) to eliminate the requirement that the Office provide a patent term adjustment determination with the notice of allowance. See Revisions to Patent Term Adjustment, 78 Fed. Reg. 19416, 19417 (Apr. 1, 2013). Therefore, the Office is no longer providing an initial patent term adjustment determination with the notice of allowance. The Office will continue to provide a patent term adjustment determination with the Issue Notification Letter that is mailed to applicant approximately three weeks prior to the issue date of the patent, and will include the patent term adjustment on the patent. Any request for reconsideration of the patent term adjustment determination (or reinstatement of patent term adjustment) should follow the process outlined in 37 CFR 1.705.

Any questions regarding the Patent Term Extension or Adjustment determination should be directed to the Office of Patent Legal Administration at (571)-272-7702. Questions relating to issue and publication fee payments should be directed to the Customer Service Center of the Office of Patent Publication at 1-(888)-786-0101 or (571)-272-4200.

OMB Clearance and PRA Burden Statement for PTOL-85 Part B

The Paperwork Reduction Act (PRA) of 1995 requires Federal agencies to obtain Office of Management and Budget approval before requesting most types of information from the public. When OMB approves an agency request to collect information from the public, OMB (i) provides a valid OMB Control Number and expiration date for the agency to display on the instrument that will be used to collect the information and (ii) requires the agency to inform the public about the OMB Control Number's legal significance in accordance with 5 CFR 1320.5(b).

The information collected by PTOL-85 Part B is required by 37 CFR 1.311. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 30 minutes to complete, including gathering, preparing, and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450. Under the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a valid OMB control number.

Privacy Act Statement

The Privacy Act of 1974 (P.L. 93-579) requires that you be given certain information in connection with your submission of the attached form related to a patent application or patent. The United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) collects the information in this record under authority of 35 U.S.C. 2. The USPTO's system of records is used to manage all applicant and owner information including name, citizenship, residence, post office address, and other information with respect to inventors and their legal representatives pertaining to the applicant's/ owner's activities in connection with the invention for which a patent is sought or has been granted. The applicable Privacy Act System of Records Notice for the information collected in this form is COMMERCE/PAT-TM-7 Patent Application Files, available in the Federal Register at 78 FR 19243 (March 29, 2013).
https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2013-03-29/pdf/2013-07341.pdf

Routine uses of the information in this record may include disclosure to:

1) law enforcement, in the event that the system of records indicates a violation or potential violation of law;
2) a federal, state, local, or international agency, in response to its request;
3) a contractor of the USPTO having need for the information in order to perform a contract;
4) the Department of Justice for determination of whether the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requires disclosure of the record;
5) a Member of Congress submitting a request involving an individual to whom the record pertains, when the individual has requested the Member's assistance with respect to the subject matter of the record;
6) a court, magistrate, or administrative tribunal, in the course of presenting evidence, including disclosures to opposing counsel in the course of settlement negotiations;
7) the Administrator, General Services Administration (GSA), or their designee, during an inspection of records conducted by GSA under authority of 44 U.S.C. 2904 and 2906, in accordance with the GSA regulations and any other relevant (i.e., GSA or Commerce) directive, where such disclosure shall not be used to make determinations about individuals;
8) another federal agency for purposes of National Security review (35 U.S.C. 181) and for review pursuant to the Atomic Energy Act (42 U.S.C. 218(c));
9) the Office of Personnel Management (OPM) for personnel research purposes; and
10) the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) for legislative coordination and clearance.

If you do not furnish the information requested on this form, the USPTO may not be able to process and/or examine your submission, which may result in termination of proceedings, abandonment of the application, and/or expiration of the patent.

Notice of Allowability	Application No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s) Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	AIA (First Inventor to File) Status Yes

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address--

All claims being allowable, PROSECUTION ON THE MERITS IS (OR REMAINS) CLOSED in this application. If not included herewith (or previously mailed), a Notice of Allowance (PTOL-85) or other appropriate communication will be mailed in due course. **THIS NOTICE OF ALLOWABILITY IS NOT A GRANT OF PATENT RIGHTS.** This application is subject to withdrawal from issue at the initiative of the Office or upon petition by the applicant. See 37 CFR 1.313 and MPEP 1308.

1. ☑ This communication is responsive to amendment filed 30 January 2026.
   ☐ A declaration(s)/affidavit(s) under **37 CFR 1.130(b)** was/were filed on _____.

2. ☐ An election was made by the applicant in response to a restriction requirement set forth during the interview on _____; the restriction requirement and election have been incorporated into this action.

3. ☑ The allowed claim(s) is/are See Continuation Sheet . As a result of the allowed claim(s), you may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at a participating intellectual property office for the corresponding application. For more information, please see **http://www.uspto.gov/patents/init_events/pph/index.jsp** or send an inquiry to **PPHfeedback@uspto.gov.**

4. ☐ Acknowledgment is made of a claim for foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a)-(d) or (f).

   Certified copies:

   a) ☐ All b) ☐ Some* c) ☐ None of the:

   1. ☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received.
   2. ☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received in Application No. _____ .
   3. ☐ Copies of the certified copies of the priority documents have been received in this national stage application from the International Bureau (PCT Rule 17.2(a)).

   * Certified copies not received: _____ .

Applicant has THREE MONTHS FROM THE "MAILING DATE" of this communication to file a reply complying with the requirements noted below. Failure to timely comply will result in ABANDONMENT of this application.
THIS THREE-MONTH PERIOD IS NOT EXTENDABLE.

5. ☐ CORRECTED DRAWINGS (as "replacement sheets") must be submitted.
   ☐ including changes required by the attached Examiner's Amendment / Comment or in the Office action of Paper No./Mail Date _____ .

   Identifying indicia such as the application number (see 37 CFR 1.84(c)) should be written on the drawings in the front (not the back) of each sheet. Replacement sheet(s) should be labeled as such in the header according to 37 CFR 1.121(d).

6. ☐ DEPOSIT OF and/or INFORMATION about the deposit of BIOLOGICAL MATERIAL must be submitted. Note the attached Examiner's comment regarding REQUIREMENT FOR THE DEPOSIT OF BIOLOGICAL MATERIAL.

Attachment(s)

1. ☑ Notice of References Cited (PTO-892)
2. ☐ Information Disclosure Statements (PTO/SB/08), Paper No./Mail Date _____.
3. ☐ Examiner's Comment Regarding Requirement for Deposit of Biological Material _____.
4. ☐ Interview Summary (PTO-413), Paper No./Mail Date. _____.
5. ☑ Examiner's Amendment/Comment
6. ☑ Examiner's Statement of Reasons for Allowance
7. ☐ Other _____.

/Christopher Uhlir/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619

Continuation of 3. The allowed claim(s) is/are: 28,33-48,50 and 52-53

DETAILED ACTION

Notice of Pre-AIA or AIA Status

1. The present application, filed on or after March 16, 2013, is being examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

Response to Amendment

2. Receipt is acknowledged of applicant's amendments filed January 30, 2026. Claims 13-27 and 29-32 have been canceled without prejudice. Claims 28 and 33-51 are pending and an action on the merits is as follows.

Rejections of claims 15-20 under 35 U.S.C. 112(b) or 35 U.S.C. 112 (pre-AIA), second paragraph have been withdrawn.

EXAMINER'S AMENDMENT

3. An examiner's amendment to the record appears below. Should the changes and/or additions be unacceptable to applicant, an amendment may be filed as provided by 37 CFR 1.312. To ensure consideration of such an amendment, it MUST be submitted no later than the payment of the issue fee.

Authorization for this examiner's amendment was given by Scott Kamholz on May 12, 2026 via email communications.

The application has been amended as follows:

- *Claim 28 lines 2-3, after the phrase "adhering an adapter" delete the phrase*—comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material—

- *Claim 28 line 4 after the phrase "air-tight seal" insert the phrase*—wherein the adapter consists of a flat disk having rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole,--
- *Claim 33 lines 1-3, after the phrase "wherein the" delete the phrase*—adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole—*and replace with the phrase*—disk comprises more than one layer—
- *Claim 35 lines 2-4, after the phrase "bottom component" delete the phrase*—, the rigid or semirigid material forming one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forming the other of the top component and the bottom component—
- *Claim 36 lines 1-2, after the word "claim", delete the phrase*—28, wherein the adapter further comprises an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole—*and replace with the phrase*—35, wherein the rigid or semirigid material forms one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forms the other of the top component and the bottom component—
- *Claim 37 line 1, after the word "claim" delete the number*—36—*and replace with the number*—28—
- *Claim 40 line 1, after the word "wherein" delete the phrase*—the disk is flat and—
- *Claim 43 lines 1-2 after the phrase "wherein the" delete the phrase*—adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and the adhesive on the underside of the disk—*and replace with the phrase*—disk comprises more than one layer—
- *Claim 44 lines 1-9, after the word "playing" delete the phrase*—by a person having a finger too small to cover a corresponding tone hole on the clarinet, the method comprising reducing a diameter of the

corresponding tone hole, wherein the tone hole diameter reduction comprises removably adhering an adapter to a top surface of the corresponding tone hole, and wherein when the adapter is removably adhered to the top surface of the corresponding tone hole, a temporary tone hole formed by a central void defined in the adapter is generated for the corresponding tone hole, thereby providing a temporary tone hole configured for use by a person having a finger too small to form an airtight seal on the corresponding clarinet tone hole—*and replace with the phrase*—the method comprising reducing a diameter of a tone hole of the clarinet, wherein the tone hole diameter reduction comprises removably adhering an adapter to a top surface of the tone hole, the adapter consisting of a flat disk and an adhesive on an underside of the flat disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the tone hole, and wherein when the adapter is removably adhered to the top surface of the tone hole, a temporary tone hole formed by a central void defined in the adapter is provided for the tone hole—

- *Claim 45 line 1, after the phrase "wherein the" delete the word*—adapter—*and replace with*—disk—
- *Claims 46 and 47 line 1, after the phrase "wherein the" delete the word*—corresponding—
- *Cancel claims 49 and 51*
- *Claim 50, lines 1-4, after the word "claim" delete the phrase*—49, wherein adhesive on an underside of the flat disk removably adheres the adapter to the top surface of the corresponding tone hole with an airtight seal between the adapter and the top surface of the corresponding tone hole to generate—*and replace with the phrase*—44, wherein the adhesive removably adheres the adapter to the top surface of the tone hole with an air-tight seal between the adapter and the top surface of the tone hole to provide—
- *Add new Claim 52*: The method of claim 44, wherein the disk comprises more than one layer.

- *Add new Claim 53*: The method of claim 52, wherein the disk comprises a top component and a bottom component, a rigid or semirigid material forming one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forming the other of the top component and the bottom component.

Reasons for Allowance

4. The following is an examiner's statement of reasons for allowance:

Claims 28 and 44: Although the prior art (US 11,127,382 B1) teaches a method of facilitating clarinet playing, comprising reducing the diameter of a tone hole on the clarinet by adhering an adapter (chimney member 112) to a top surface of a tone hole (column 8 lines 56-63), wherein the adapter is shown in FIG. 2 to comprise a flat disk (flanged head 114) and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the tone hole, the disk comprising an aperture defining a central void (channel 214) in the disk, the prior art does not teach nor suggest the adapter consisting of a flat disk and the adhesive. The combinations of the claimed limitations are novel and found to be allowable over prior art. The cited references taken singly or in combination do not anticipate nor make obvious applicant's claimed invention.

Claims 33-43, 45-48, 50, 52 and 53 depend from claims 28 or 44 and therefore inherit all allowed claim limitations.

Any comments considered necessary by applicant must be submitted no later than the payment of the issue fee and, to avoid processing delays, should preferably

accompany the issue fee. Such submissions should be clearly labeled "Comments on Statement of Reasons for Allowance."

Conclusion

5. The prior art made of record and not relied upon is considered pertinent to applicant's disclosure. US 4,798,122 pertaining to an adapter to decrease a size of a tone hole diameter, US 9,558,725 B2 pertaining to an adapter contacting a top of a turret of a tone hole.

Any inquiry concerning this communication or earlier communications from the examiner should be directed to CHRISTOPHER UHLIR whose telephone number is (571)270-3091. The examiner can normally be reached M-F 8:30-4.

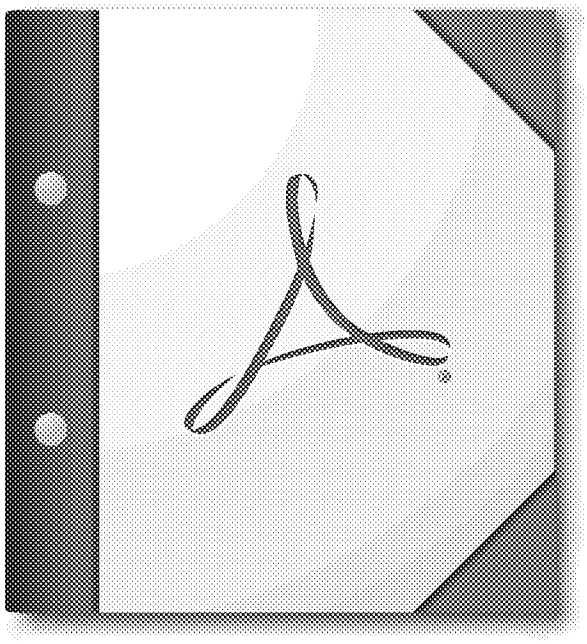
Examiner interviews are available via telephone, in-person, and video conferencing using a USPTO supplied web-based collaboration tool. To schedule an interview, applicant is encouraged to use the USPTO Automated Interview Request (AIR) at http://www.uspto.gov/interviewpractice.

If attempts to reach the examiner by telephone are unsuccessful, the examiner's supervisor, Anita Coupe can be reached at 571-270-3614. The fax phone number for the organization where this application or proceeding is assigned is 571-273-8300.

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https://www.uspto.gov/patents/docx for information about filing in DOCX format. For additional questions, contact the Electronic Business Center (EBC) at 866-217-9197 (toll-free). If you would like assistance from a USPTO Customer Service Representative, call 800-786-9199 (IN USA OR CANADA) or 571-272-1000.

/Christopher Uhlir/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619
May 14, 2026



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28. (Currently amended) A method of facilitating clarinet playing, comprising reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet by adhering an adapter ~~comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material~~ to a top surface of a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet with an air-tight seal, wherein the adapter consists of a flat disk having rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole, the disk comprising an aperture defining a central void in the disk.

33. (Currently amended) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk comprises more than one layer.~~adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole.~~

34. (Previously presented) The method of claim 28, wherein the clarinet is a Boehm system clarinet, and only one tone hole, being a lowest tone hole of the Boehm system clarinet above which a ring is positioned, is reduced in diameter.

35. (Currently amended) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk comprises a top component and a bottom component~~, the rigid or semirigid material forming one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forming the other of the top component and the bottom component~~.

36. (Currently amended) The method of claim ~~28, wherein the adapter further comprises an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole~~ 35, wherein the rigid or semirigid material forms one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forms the other of the top component and the bottom component.

37. (Currently amended) The method of claim 28, ~~36,~~ wherein the adapter is removably adhered by the adhesive to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole.

38. (Previously presented) The method of claim 37, wherein the turret comprises a bore wall extending above a main body surface of the clarinet.

39. (Previously presented) The method of claim 38, wherein the bore wall terminates with the top surface of the turret.

40. (Currently amended) The method of claim 39, wherein ~~the disk is flat and~~ the top surface of the turret of the tone hole is flat.

41. (Previously presented) The method of claim 40, wherein the diameter of only one tone hole is reduced, and the tone hole to which the adapter is adhesively adhered is a lowest tone hole on the clarinet above which a ring is positioned.

42. (Previously presented) The method of claim 41, wherein the clarinet is a Boehm system clarinet, and the ring positioned above the lowest tone hole is pivotably received in a ring sink surrounding the turret of the lowest tone hole.

43. (Currently amended) The method of claim 42, wherein the disk comprises more than one layer.~~adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and the adhesive on the underside of the disk.~~

44. (Currently amended) A method of facilitating clarinet playing~~ by a person having a finger too small to cover a corresponding tone hole on the clarinet~~, the method comprising reducing a diameter of ~~the corresponding~~ a tone hole of the clarinet, wherein the tone hole diameter reduction comprises removably adhering an adapter to a top surface of the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole, the adapter consisting of a flat disk and an adhesive on an underside of the flat disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the tone hole, and wherein when the adapter is removably adhered to the top surface of the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole, a temporary tone hole formed by a central void defined in the adapter is ~~generated~~ provided for the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole~~, thereby providing a temporary tone hole configured for use by a person having a finger too small to form an airtight seal on the corresponding clarinet tone hole~~.

45. (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, wherein the disk ~~adapter~~ is configured with a rigid or semi-rigid material.

46. (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, wherein the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole is a lowest tone hole on the clarinet above which a ring is positioned.

47. (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, wherein the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole is defined by a circumferential bore wall extending above a main body surface of the clarinet and terminating at the top surface of the tone hole.

48. (Previously presented) The method of claim 47, wherein the top surface of the tone hole is flat.

Cancel claim 49.

50. (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, ~~49,~~ wherein the adhesive ~~on an underside of the flat disk~~ removably adheres the adapter to the top surface of the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole with an ~~airtight~~ air-tight seal between the adapter and the top surface of the ~~corresponding~~ tone hole to ~~generate~~ provide the temporary tone hole.

Cancel claim 51.

52. (New) The method of claim 44, wherein the disk comprises more than one layer.

53. (New) The method of claim 52, wherein the disk comprises a top component and a bottom component, a rigid or semirigid material forming one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forming the other of the top component and the bottom component.

Notice of References Cited	Application/Control No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	Page 1 of 1

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Document Number Country Code-Number-Kind Code	Date YYYY-MM-DD	Name	CPC Classification	US Classification
*	A	US-4798122-A	1989-01-17	Gisler; Barbara	G10D9/047	84/385P
*	B	US-9558725-B2	2017-01-31	Uesawa; Haruo	G10D9/08	1/1
	C					
	D					
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	I					
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FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Document Number Country Code-Number-Kind Code	Date YYYY-MM-DD	Country	Name	CPC Classification
	N					
	O					
	P					
	Q					
	R					
	S					
	T					

NON-PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Include as applicable: Author, Title, Date, Publisher, Edition or Volume, Pertinent Pages
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Dates in YYYY-MM-DD format are publication dates. Classifications may be US or foreign.

Search Notes	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	Art Unit
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

CPC - Searched*		
Symbol	**Date**	**Examiner**
G10D 9/00,04,047	07/11/2025	CU
G10D 7/00-08	05/12/2026	CU
G10D 9/00,01,04-06,10	05/12/2026	CU

CPC Combination Sets - Searched*		
Symbol	**Date**	**Examiner**

US Classification - Searched*			
Class	**Subclass**	**Date**	**Examiner**

* See search history printout included with this form or the SEARCH NOTES box below to determine the scope of the search.

Search Notes		
Search Notes	**Date**	**Examiner**
Inventor name search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Keyword search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Similarity search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Keyword search in PE2E SEARCH	10/09/2025	CU
Similarity search in PE2E SEARCH	10/09/2025	CU
Keyword search in PE2E SEARCH	05/12/2026	CU
Similarity search in PE2E SEARCH	05/12/2026	CU

/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	

Search Notes	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	Art Unit
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

Interference Search			
US Class/CPC Symbol	US Subclass/CPC Group	Date	Examiner
	Interference search in PE2E SEARCH	05/12/2026	CU

/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	

PE2E SEARCH - Search History (Prior Art)

Ref #	Hits	Search Query	DBs	Default Operator	Plurals	British Equivalents	Time Stamp
L1	0	((("KAMHOLZ") near3 ("Leah"))).INV.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; EPO; JPO; DERWENT)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:30 PM
L2	3	("4798122" OR "7468479" OR "7851685").pn.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:30 PM
L3	829	g10d9/00,04,047.cpc.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:34 PM
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L15	93	L14 AND (((partial$3 OR part$3 OR semi OR portion OR segment$3 OR fraction$5 OR small OR little OR ring) near3 (cover$4 OR block$4 OR restrict$5 OR limit$4 OR shell OR lid OR top OR jacket OR cas$3 OR cap OR hat OR closure OR plug OR overla$4 OR shutter)) near5 (air OR flow$4 OR airflow$4 OR hole OR open$4 OR aperture OR turret))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 01:21 PM
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		diameter OR ridge OR lip) near3 (hole OR tonehole OR open$4 OR aperture)))					
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L30	4584	L29 NOT (brass OR trumpet OR tuba OR trombone OR guitar OR keyboard OR piano OR percuss$4).ab,ti.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 02:07 PM
L31	700	L30 AND (clarinet OR sax OR saxophone OR flute OR music$4 OR instrument).ab,ti.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 02:08 PM
L32	611	L31 NOT L24	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 02:08 PM
L33	385	L32 AND ((cover$4 OR top OR atop OR ontop OR upper OR rim OR ridge OR lip) near3 (hole OR tonehole OR open$4 OR aperture OR chimney OR turret))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:07 PM
L34	383	L33 NOT pad$4.ti.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:07 PM
L35	25	L34 AND g10d.cpcl.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT;	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12

			EPO; JPO)				03:08 PM
L36	0	L34 AND 84/380r,382,385r-386,458.icls.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:12 PM
L37	0	L34 AND "84".icls.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:13 PM
L38	68016	(clarinet OR sax OR saxophone OR flute)	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:15 PM
L39	1607	L38 AND ((cover$4 OR against OR mount$ OR secur$5 OR adher$4 OR adhesiv$4 OR glu$4 OR attach$4 OR fix$4 OR affix$4 OR remov$5 OR contact$4 OR coupl$4 OR engag$5 OR sit$4 OR set$4 OR plac$5) near3 (hole OR tonehole OR soundhole OR open$4 OR aperture OR chimney OR turret)).ab,ti.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:16 PM
L40	395	L39 AND ((cover$4 OR against OR mount$ OR secur$5 OR adher$4 OR adhesiv$4 OR glu$4 OR attach$4 OR fix$4 OR affix$4 OR remov$5 OR contact$4 OR coupl$4 OR engag$5 OR sit$4 OR set$4 OR plac$5) near3 ((top OR atop OR ontop OR upper OR rim OR above OR circumferen$5 OR diameter OR ridge OR lip) near3 (hole OR tonehole OR open$4 OR aperture OR chimney OR turret)))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:17 PM
L41	16	L40 AND clarinet	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:18 PM
L42	24	L40 AND woodwind	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:48 PM

PE2E SEARCH - Search History (Interference)

Ref #	Hits	Search Query	DBs	Default Operator	Plurals	British Equivalents	Time Stamp
N1	0	(clarinet playing).clm.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT)	ADJ	ON	ON	2026/05/12 03:52 PM

PE2E SEARCH - Search History (Similarity Search)

Ref #	Sort and Retrieval Information	Text Selections	CPC Selections
L10	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	No selections	No selections
L11	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	(Abstract) tone hole rings (Specification) clarinet (Specification) fit around tone hole	(G10D9/047) Valves; Valve controls for wood wind instruments
L18	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	No selections	No selections
L19	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	(Specification) removeable or otherwise temporary (Specification) tone hole ring adapter in the form of a disk has been fitted placed on a tone hole ring (Specification) affix the disk to ring 20 with an airtight seal	(G10D9/047) Valves; Valve controls for wood wind instruments
L25	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	No selections	No selections
L26	Sort results by: Similarity to Application # 19/075,701 Retrieve results by: Application # 19/075,701	(Abstract) clarinet tone hole (Specification) air-tight seal of tone hole (Specification) adhesive provided on the underside surface that corresponds to the tone hole (Specification) disk 48 placed on top of tone hole (Specification) clarinet	No selections

Issue Classification	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	**Art Unit**
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

CPC						
Symbol					**Type**	**Version**
G10D	/	9	/	047	F	2020-02-01

CPC Combination Sets							
Symbol					**Type**	**Set**	**Ranking**	**Version**
	/		/					

NONE		**Total Claims Allowed:**	
(Assistant Examiner)	(Date)	20	
/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	14 May 2026	O.G. Print Claim(s)	O.G. Print Figure
(Primary Examiner)	(Date)	28	12

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Issue Classification	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	Art Unit
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

INTERNATIONAL CLASSIFICATION					
CLAIMED					
G10D	/	9	/	00	

NON-CLAIMED				
	/		/	

US ORIGINAL CLASSIFICATION	
CLASS	SUBCLASS
84	382

CROSS REFERENCES(S)						
CLASS	SUBCLASS (ONE SUBCLASS PER BLOCK)					

NONE		Total Claims Allowed:	
(Assistant Examiner)	(Date)	20	
/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	14 May 2026	O.G. Print Claim(s)	O.G. Print Figure
(Primary Examiner)	(Date)	28	12

Issue Classification	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	**Art Unit**
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

☐ Claims renumbered in the same order as presented by applicant ☐ CPA ☐ T.D. ☐ R.1.47

CLAIMS

Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original	Final	Original
	1		10		19	1	28	6	37	15	46				
	2		11		20		29	7	38	16	47				
	3		12		21		30	8	39	17	48				
	4		13		22		31	9	40		49				
	5		14		23		32	10	41	18	50				
	6		15		24	2	33	11	42		51				
	7		16		25	3	34	12	43	19	52				
	8		17		26	4	35	13	44	20	53				
	9		18		27	5	36	14	45						

NONE		**Total Claims Allowed:**	
(Assistant Examiner)	(Date)	20	
/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	14 May 2026	O.G. Print Claim(s)	O.G. Print Figure
(Primary Examiner)	(Date)	28	12

Bibliographic Data

Application No: 19/075,701

Foreign Priority claimed: ○ Yes ◉ No

35 USC 119 (a-d) conditions met: ☐ Yes ☑ No ☐ Met After Allowance

Verified and Acknowledged: /Christopher Uhlir/ (Examiner's Signature) | (Initials)

Title: Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

FILING or 371(c) DATE	CLASS	GROUP ART UNIT	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.
03/10/2025	084	3619	LMK-001.01
RULE			

APPLICANTS

INVENTORS

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA, UNITED STATES

CONTINUING DATA

FOREIGN APPLICATIONS

IF REQUIRED, FOREIGN LICENSE GRANTED**

03/17/2025

** MICRO ENTITY **

STATE OR COUNTRY

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FILING FEE RECEIVED

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APPLICATION NUMBER	FILING or 371(c) DATE	GRP ART UNIT	FIL FEE REC'D	ATTY.DOCKET.NO	TOT CLAIMS	IND CLAIMS
19/075,701	03/10/2025	3619	434	LMK-001.01	12	1

CONFIRMATION NO. 3414

CORRECTED FILING RECEIPT

178888
Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

OC00000100988129

Date Mailed: 02/04/2026

Receipt is acknowledged of this non-provisional utility patent application. The application will be taken up for examination in due course. Applicant will be notified as to the results of the examination. Any correspondence concerning the application must include the following identification information: the U.S. APPLICATION NUMBER, FILING DATE, NAME OF FIRST INVENTOR, and TITLE OF INVENTION. Fees transmitted by check or draft are subject to collection.

Please verify the accuracy of the data presented on this receipt. If an error is noted on this Filing Receipt, please submit a written request for a corrected Filing Receipt, including a properly marked-up ADS showing the changes with strike-through for deletions and underlining for additions. If you received a "Notice to File Missing Parts" or other Notice requiring a response for this application, please submit any request for correction to this Filing Receipt with your reply to the Notice. When the USPTO processes the reply to the Notice, the USPTO will generate another Filing Receipt incorporating the requested corrections provided that the request is grantable.

Inventor(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Applicant(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Power of Attorney: The patent practitioners associated with Customer Number 178888

Domestic Applications for which benefit is claimed - None.
A proper domestic benefit claim must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim for domestic benefit. See 37 CFR 1.76 and 1.78.

Foreign Applications for which priority is claimed (You may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at the USPTO. Please see http://www.uspto.gov for more information.) **- None.**
Foreign application information must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim to foreign priority. See 37 CFR 1.55 and 1.76.

Permission to Access Application via Priority Document Exchange: No

Permission to Access Search Results: No

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If Required, Foreign Filing License Granted: 03/17/2025

The country code and number of your priority application, to be used for filing abroad under the Paris Convention, is **US 19/075,701**

Projected Publication Date: Request for Non-Publication Acknowledged

Non-Publication Request: Yes

Early Publication Request: No
**** MICRO ENTITY ****
Title

Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters

Preliminary Class

084

Statement under 37 CFR 1.55 or 1.78 for AIA (First Inventor to File) Transition Applications: No

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Title 37, Code of Federal Regulations, 5.11 & 5.15

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IN THE UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

Application No.: 19/075,701 Filing Date: March 10, 2025 Inventor: Kamholz, Leah M. Title: *Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters* (as amended) Attorney Docket No.: LMK-001.01	Confirmation No.: 3414 Customer No.: 178888 Certificate of Electronic Transmission I hereby certify that this correspondence is being transmitted via the USPTO electronic filing system on 2026-01-30. By: /Scott E. Kamholz/ Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

AMENDMENT B AND RESPONSE TO OFFICE ACTION

To the Commissioner for Patents:

Applicant responds to the non-final Office Action issued 2025-10-15. Applicant petitions for a one-month extension of time to respond and has paid the required fee.

Please amend the Specification, Abstract, drawings, and claims as indicated on the following pages.

Remarks follow the amendments.

AMENDMENTS TO THE SPECIFICATION

Replace paragraph [0005] with the following amended paragraph:

[0005] A problem may arise, however, if a player's fingers are too small to cover the hole fully, or a player's fingers lack full mobility such as due to arthritis, trauma, or neurological impairment. In such cases, a player may find it difficult or impossible to form an ~~airtight~~ air-tight seal, particularly on the lower tone holes, and especially the lowest or largest tone hole. Players with small fingers, such as young children in the early stages of clarinet playing, can find it essentially impossible to close the lower tone holes. Players desiring to wear gloves while playing, such as participants in an outdoor performance, may similarly find it impossible to achieve air-tight seals on the tone holes due to the intervening fabric.

Insert after paragraph [0015] the following new paragraph [0015.1]:

[0015.1] FIGS. 8A-E are top, isometric, side, in situ, and schematic median longitudinal cross-section views, respectively, of a clarinet tone hole adapter applied directly to the top surface of a tone hole turret.

Insert after paragraph [0016] the following new paragraph [0016.1]:

[0016.1] FIGS. 9A-B are side and isometric views, respectively, of an adapter disk having a top component and a bottom component.

Replace paragraph [0021] with the following amended paragraph:

[0021] FIG. 1 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section (i.e., taken along a plane cutting front-to-back through the middle of a clarinet) of clarinet tone hole **10** and tone hole ring **20**. Tone hole ring **20** is depicted in the open position, in which it lies above the tone hole and typically does not contact it. Ring **20** extends from a ring arm **22** which is mounted on shaft **24**. Ring arm **22** is typically biased to its open position by a biaser such as a spring (not shown). Shaft **24** is secured to the clarinet body by one or [[most]]more posts (not shown) that allow shaft **24** and ring arms attached to it to pivot on the shaft long axis. Tone hole **10** is

formed in clarinet body **1** and communicates with clarinet main bore **2** by tone hole bore **12**. Tone hole bore **12** is defined by circumferential bore wall **13**, which extends above the surface of clarinet main body **1** to circumferential turret **14** having top surface **15**. Ring sink **16** surrounds bore wall **13** and forms a sunken area relative to the surface of clarinet body **1**. Tone hole rings typically have inner diameters of about 8 mm to about 13 mm, with the smaller rings toward the top of the clarinet and larger rings toward the bottom. The rings are typically about 1 mm in width, giving outer diameters of about 10 mm to about 15 mm. Adapters may be sized and shaped to accommodate these dimensions.

Replace paragraph [0022] with the following amended paragraph:

[0022] FIG. 2 schematically shows the same view as **FIG. 1** but with tone hole ring **20** in a closed position. In the closed position, top surface **21** of tone hole ring **20** is flush or is approximately flush with top surface **15** of tone hole [[**20**]]turret **14**. Ring sink **16** provides clearance for tone hole ring **20** to reach its closed position without contacting clarinet body **1**. Tone hole ring **20** thus extends at least partly into ring sink **16** when in the closed position.

Replace paragraph [0024] with the following amended paragraph:

[0024] FIG. 4 schematically depicts tone hole ring adapter **40** deployed on tone hole ring **20**. In the schematically-depicted embodiment, adapter **40** includes elastomer tube **42**. Tube **42** includes first end **41** and second end **43**. First end **41** is open, and second end **43** may be open or closed. Elastomer tube **42** may be, for example, the stem portion of a latex balloon, with thickened lip **44** from the balloon forming first end **41** and second end **43** being a cut surface of the balloon. Inclusion of lip **44** or other thickening at first end **41** may help keep adapter **40** in position on tone ring **20** by providing physical obstruction or other resistance to ~~tube 40~~ tube **42** slippage. Aperture **45** may be formed in the sidewalls of tube **42** to provide a transverse path for airflow across tube **42**. In the case of tube **42** being cut from a balloon stem, aperture **45** may be formed by, for example, pricking or hole-punching the stem. Although shown here loosely surrounding tone hole ring **20**, ~~adapted~~ adapter **40** may fit snugly, or it may be stretched to fit around tone hole ring **20**.

Replace paragraph [0025] with the following amended paragraph:

[0025] FIG. **5** shows the same view as **FIG. 3** but with ring adapter **40** deployed on tone hole ring **20**. Finger **30** is depressing tube **42** of adapter **40**, thereby stretching it into tone hole **10** and pressing it into inner edges of top surface **15** (which is flat as shown in **FIGS. 1, 2, 3, and 5**). The gaps allowing airflow around finger **30** are thereby obliterated (schematically depicted as **32**′ and **34**′). Adapter **40** thereby assists finger **30** in sealing tone hole **10** and allowing the clarinet to sound the intended pitch. When finger **30** is lifted (not shown), tone hole ring **20** returns to the open position and lifts adapter **40** out of contact with tone hole **10**, thereby restoring the possibility of airflow through tone hole **10**.

Replace paragraph [0026] with the following amended paragraph:

[0026] **FIG. 6** is a perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which tone hole ring adapter **40** has been fitted to tone hole ring **20**. Tone hole ring **20** is in the open position. Adapter **40** includes aperture **45** in its top surface; a similar aperture **45** is provided on the bottom surface of ~~tube 40~~ tube **42** (not shown). Clarinet body **1**, tone hole top surface **15**, tone hole ring arm **22**, and shaft **24** are shown for context with the other drawings.

Replace paragraph [0027] with the following amended paragraph:

[0027] A tone hole ring adapter may serve as a substitute for, or approximation of, a plateau key, in the sense of providing a way to close ringed tone holes with an air-tight seal when the player is otherwise unable to do so. An adapter may be ~~removeable~~ removable or otherwise temporary. An adapter may define apertures in its surfaces separating a player's finger from the tone hole in order to provide a path for air to escape the tone hole across the adapter when a finger is not pressing on the corresponding tone hole ring. The adapter may include a peripheral region sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with a clarinet tone hole ring about the ring's entire circumference. The peripheral region may define a central void (that is, an aperture).

Replace paragraph [0028] with the following amended paragraph:

[0028] A variety of shapes, sizes, and configurations are suitable for a tone hole ring adapter. As described above, an adapter may be formed from a sleeve or tube of elastic material. As shown in **FIG. 7**, an adapter may be formed as a slipcover with top and bottom layers and side passage **46** through which the tone hole ring **20** is passed, so that the slipcover encases the tone hole ring. As shown in **FIG. 8**, a slipcover aperture may include stem **47**. A slipcover-style adapter should be made of an especially thin, flexible, and/or elastic material, at least on the bottom layer to accommodate the tone hole turret in order to allow the tone hole ring to reach the closed position essentially without obstruction. As shown in **FIGS. 8A-E**, [[The]] adapter **48** could be applied directly to the top surface **15** of turret **14**, typically in the form of a single layer with adhesive on the underside.

Replace paragraph [0029] with the following amended paragraph:

[0029] As shown in **FIG. 9**, an adapter may be a flat (or essentially flat) disk **48** placed on top of tone hole ring **20**. Disk **48** may be circular, oval, or elliptical. It may also be polygonal (though still may be referred to figuratively as a "disk"). The underside of disk **48** may include an adhesive material or a deformable material, such as glue, wax, or putty, to affix the disk to ring **20** with an ~~airtight~~ air-tight seal. Disk **48** may be rigid or semirigid, or may have a rigid or semirigid component together with a flexible component. For example, as shown in **FIGS. 9A-B**, disk **48** may have rigid top component 60 made of plastic or metal and [[a]]bottom component 62 made of cork, felt, or other material typically used in clarinet key pads. The bottom component may be a bladder typically used in clarinet key pads. An adapter can include a top piece with only an annulus of adhesive provided on the underside surface that corresponds to the tone hole ring, so that there is no adhesive on the underside that is exposed to the turret. An adapter can include a top piece with adhesive provided on the underside, and a second piece of material covering the portion of the adhesive corresponding to the inner diameter of the tone hole ring (that is, the turret location), similarly to prevent unwanted sticking to the turret. The second piece would have an aperture if there is an aperture in the top piece.

Replace paragraph [0030] with the following amended paragraph:

[0030] As shown in **FIG. 10**, disk **48** may include side clip **49** that clips around ring **20**. Side clip **49** may extend circumferentially around disk **48** or may be formed by a series of clips distributed around the circumference, such as two clips as shown in **FIG. 11**. Clips may be lined with rubber or another material to improve grip on ring **20** and/or help create an ~~airtight~~ air-tight seal. Disk **48** may be made of flexible materials, such as plastic, paper, electrical tape, or other adhesive tape. In one embodiment, an adapter can be formed from two ~~piece~~ pieces of opposing adhesive tape between which a tone hole ring is sandwiched. In another embodiment, an adapter may include an annular ring of paper or cardboard (resembling a binder paper hole reinforcement). Adapters, regardless of the particular form, can include a transverse passage through the adapter, represented in the drawings by aperture **45**, to allow airflow from the tone hole when a finger is not pressing the tone hole ring. An adapter with more than one layer, such as an upper layer positioned on the upper side of the tone hole ring and a lower layer positioned on the bottom side of the tone hole ring, may have apertures that are in register with one another, that is, aligned with one another, to define the transverse passage.

Replace paragraph [0032] with the following amended paragraph:

[0032] A wide variety of materials, shapes, sizes, and properties are suitable for a tone hole ring adapter. An adapter could be made from thin latex or another elastomer. An adapter could be made of a deformable plastic, such as plastic wrap made from polyethylene, low-density polyethylene, polyvinyl chloride, or polyvinylidene chloride. In the case of plastic wrap, the wrap could simply be folded over the tone hole ring and pressed together. Other materials include fabric and felt. Such materials should be ~~airtight~~ air-tight or treated to be ~~airtight,~~ air-tight, such as being impregnated with wax or plastic or coated with a sealant, as in the tip of a glove. An adapter could be made from a piece of plastic wrap, such as is used for food storage, folded over the tone hole ring.

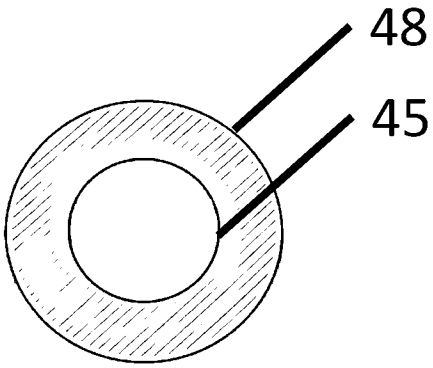


FIG. 8A

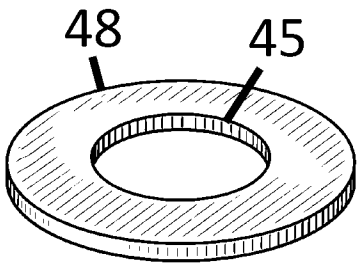


FIG. 8B

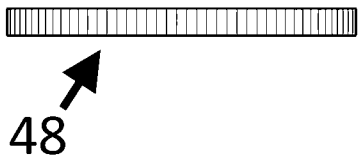


FIG. 8C

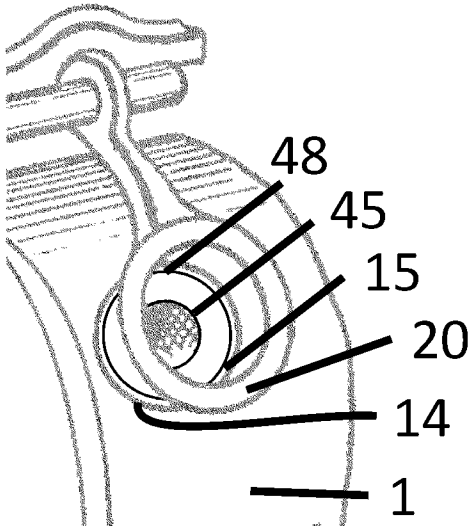


FIG. 8D

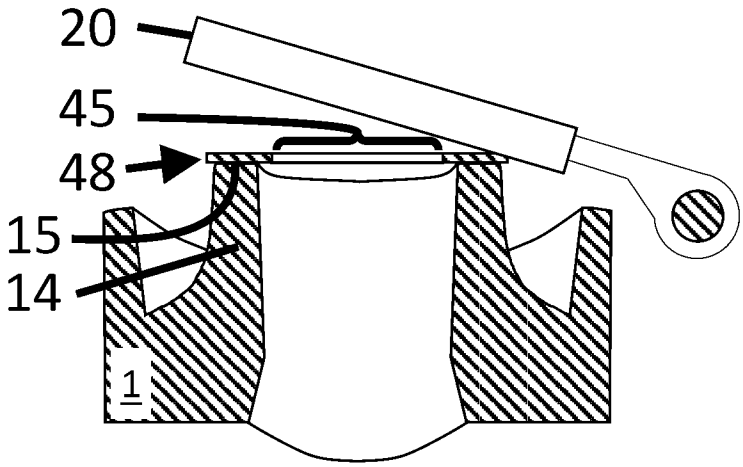


FIG. 8E

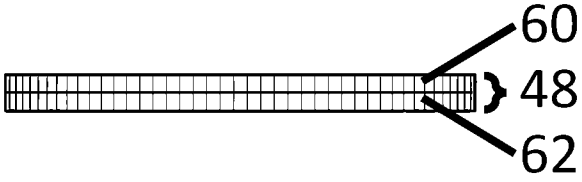


FIG. 9A

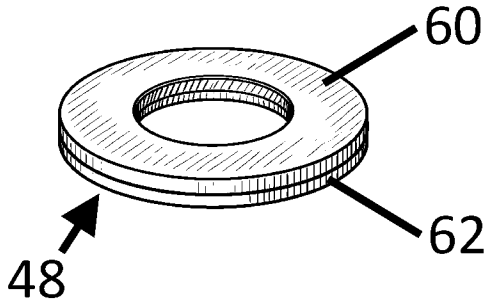


FIG. 9B

AMENDMENTS TO THE DRAWINGS

The attached new sheet of drawings presents new drawings Fig. 8A, Fig. 8B, Fig. 8C, Fig. 8D, Fig. 8E, Fig. 9A, and Fig. 9B and should be inserted after the third sheet of drawings, which includes Figs. 6–9.

AMENDMENTS TO THE CLAIMS

Claims 1–27 (canceled)

28. (Currently amended) A method of facilitating clarinet playing, comprising reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet by adhering an adapter comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material to a top surface of a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet with an air-tight seal, the disk comprising an aperture defining a central void in the disk.

Claims 29–32 (canceled)

33. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole.

34. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the clarinet is a Boehm system clarinet, and only one tone hole, being a lowest tone hole of the Boehm system clarinet above which a ring is positioned, is reduced in diameter.

35. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk comprises a top component and a bottom component, the rigid or semirigid material forming one of the top component and the bottom component, and a flexible material forming the other of the top component and the bottom component.

36. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the adapter further comprises an adhesive on an underside of the disk that adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole.

37. (New) The method of claim 36, wherein the adapter is removably adhered by the adhesive to the top surface of the turret of the tone hole.

38. (New) The method of claim 37, wherein the turret comprises a bore wall extending above a main body surface of the clarinet.

39. (New) The method of claim 38, wherein the bore wall terminates with the top surface of the turret.

40. (New) The method of claim 39, wherein the disk is flat and the top surface of the turret of the tone hole is flat.

41. (New) The method of claim 40, wherein the diameter of only one tone hole is reduced, and the tone hole to which the adapter is adhesively adhered is a lowest tone hole on the clarinet above which a ring is positioned.

42. (New) The method of claim 41, wherein the clarinet is a Boehm system clarinet, and the ring positioned above the lowest tone hole is pivotably received in a ring sink surrounding the turret of the lowest tone hole.

43. (New) The method of claim 42, wherein the adapter consists of the disk of rigid or semirigid material and the adhesive on the underside of the disk.

44. (New) A method of facilitating clarinet playing by a person having a finger too small to cover a corresponding tone hole on the clarinet, the method comprising reducing a diameter of the corresponding tone hole, wherein the tone hole diameter reduction comprises removably adhering an adapter to a top surface of the corresponding tone hole, and wherein when the adapter is removably adhered to the top surface of the corresponding tone hole, a temporary tone hole formed by a central void defined in the adapter is generated for the corresponding tone hole, thereby providing a temporary tone hole configured for use by a person having a finger too small to form an airtight seal on the corresponding clarinet tone hole.

45. (New) The method of claim 44, wherein the adapter is configured with a rigid or semi-rigid material.

46. (New) The method of claim 44, wherein the corresponding tone hole is a lowest tone hole on the clarinet above which a ring is positioned.

47. (New) The method of claim 44, wherein the corresponding tone hole is defined by a circumferential bore wall extending above a main body surface of the clarinet and terminating at the top surface of the tone hole.

48. (New) The method of claim 47, wherein the top surface of the tone hole is flat.

49. (New) The method of claim 48, wherein the adapter comprises a flat disk.

50. (New) The method of claim 49, wherein adhesive on an underside of the flat disk removably adheres the adapter to the top surface of the corresponding tone hole with an airtight seal between the adapter and the top surface of the corresponding tone hole to generate the temporary tone hole.

51. (New) The method of claim 50, wherein the adapter consists of the flat disk and the adhesive on the underside of the flat disk.

AMENDMENTS TO THE ABSTRACT

Adapters that cover or narrow the apertures of clarinet tone holes ~~tones or tone hole rings~~ may be used to make it easier for players with small fingers or reduced finger mobility to achieve air-tight seals of the tone holes. An adapter may be formed, for example, by a disk ~~of material~~ that is adhered to a top surface of a tone hole with an air-tight seal. The disk defines a hole through the plane of the disk that reduces the diameter of the clarinet tone hole.

REMARKS

Status of Claims

Claims 13–32 were pending. Claims 13–27 and 29–32 are canceled, claim 28 is amended, and new claims 33–51 are presented. Support for the new claims is provided throughout the Specification and drawings as filed. No new matter is introduced.

Amendments to Specification, Abstract, and Drawings

The Specification is amended to correct typographical errors, improve clarity, and to add description of new drawing Figures 8A-E and 9A-B. The Abstract is amended to correct a typographical error and for clarity. The drawings are amended to present new Figures 8A-8E and 9A-B in order to comply with the illustration requirements of 37 C.F.R. § 1.83(a). No new matter is introduced. A corrected ADS is filed herewith to indicate the Title change made in the prior amendment. Applicant suggests new Figure 8D for publication.

Interview Summary

Applicant thanks the Examiner for conducting a telephonic interview on January 22, 2026 with the inventor and the attorney of record to discuss claim amendments, drawing amendments, and patentability arguments. The Examiner's interview summary entered on January 27, 2026 accurately sets forth the substance of the interview.

Rejections – 35 U.S.C. § 112(b)

Claims 15-20 were rejected under 35 U.S.C. § 112(b) because the Examiner questioned how "adhering" an adapter could temporarily reduce a tone hole diameter and avoid damage when the adapter is removed from the clarinet.

Claims 15-20 are canceled, but new claims 37, 44, and 50 recite "removably adher[ing]" the adapter. Applicant asks the Examiner to reconsider and not reject these claims on analogous grounds, because the Specification discloses that an adapter "may be removable or otherwise temporary" (¶ [0027]) and "may include an adhesive material or a deformable material, such as glue, wax, or putty" to affix it with an airtight seal (¶ [0029]). Numerous examples of glue, wax, and putty adhesives that are temporary or removable are known in the art, such as craft glue, Blu-Tack® adhesive putty, sticky wax for mounting figurines or other small pieces in museums,

and the adhesive coatings on Post-It® stationery notes and painter's tape. These examples illustrate that adhering can be temporary and not cause damage when removed.

Rejections – 35 U.S.C. § 102

Claims 13–16, 20, 28, and 29 were rejected for anticipation by Ruggles US 11,127,382.

During the interview, the Examiner suggested that specifying that the adapter be adhered to the "top surface" of the turret of the tone hole would overcome the rejection and also overcome US 9,520,111 (Clissold) and US 4,798,122 (Gisler). Claim 28 has been amended accordingly. New claims 33 and 43 correspond to claims 34 and 42 proposed during the interview that the Examiner also considered to overcome Ruggles.

A question arose during the interview about whether Ruggles discloses creating a new hole 108*n* in the barrel of the musical instrument in addition to the original holes 108*a-n*, which appeared to be the Examiner's understanding. Ruggles does not disclose this. Rather, Ruggles discloses that chimney 112 allows hole 108*n* to be "moved" up to a higher position (col. 6, ll. 33–36). Ruggles Fig. 1 similarly shows that original tone hole 108*n* is absent from the modified instrument and replaced by a higher-up hole plugged by chimney 112. There is no disclosure that original hole 108*n* is retained in the modified instrument along with the new hole.

Rejections – 35 U.S.C. § 103

Claims 17–19 and 30–32 were rejected as being obvious over Ruggles. The rejection is moot because those claims are canceled.

For these reasons, Applicant requests reconsideration and withdrawal of all rejections.

Applicant asks the Examiner to contact the attorney of record before issuing another office action if any issues remain outstanding, or if the application is in any way not in condition for allowance, after entry and consideration of this response.

Respectfully submitted,

Date: 2026-01-30 By: /Scott E. Kamholz/
Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543
Attorney for Applicant
Telephone: 617-678-0222

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Corrected Application Data Sheet

19075701 : Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

~~Strike through~~ indicates removal of data from existing record Underline indicates new data being added to the application If no data is shown, no data has been corrected

Inventor Information

Data of record	Updated Data
No data change in this section	

Application Information

Title of Invention	~~**Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters**~~	**Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters**
Attorney Docket Number	**LMK-001.01**	
Entity Status	**Micro**	

Domestic Benefit/National Stage Information

This section allows for the applicant to either claim benefit under 35 U.S.C. 119(e), 120, 121, or 365(c), 386(c), or indicate National Stage entry from a PCT application. Providing benefit claim information in the Application Data Sheet constitutes the specific reference required by 35 U.S.C. 119(e) or 120, and 37 CFR 1.78(a)(2) or CFR 1.78(a)(4), and need not otherwise be made part of the specification.

Data of record	Updated Data
No data change in this section	

Foreign Priority Information

This section allows for the applicant to claim benefit of foreign priority and to identify any prior foreign application for which priority is not claimed. Providing this information in the Application Data Sheet constitutes the claim for priority as required by 35 U.S.C. 119 (b) and 37 CFR 1.55. When priority is claimed to a foreign application that is eligible for retrieval under the priority document exchange program (PDX) the information will be used by the Office to automatically attempt retrieval pursuant to 37 CFR 1.55(i)(1) and (2). Under the PDX program, applicant bears the ultimate responsibility for ensuring that a copy of the foreign application is received by the Office from the participating foreign intellectual property office, or a certified copy of the foreign priority application is filed, within the time period specified in 37 CFR 1.55(g)(1).

Data of record	Updated Data
No data change in this section	

Applicant Information

The information to be provided in this section is the name and address of the legal representative who is the applicant under 37 CFR 1.43; or the name and address of the assignee, person to whom the inventor is under an obligation to assign the invention, or person who otherwise shows sufficient proprietary interest in the matter who is the applicant under 37 CFR 1.46.

Data of record	Updated Data
No data change in this section	

Assignee Information including Non-Applicant Assignee Information

Providing assignment information in this section does not substitute for compliance with any requirement of part 3 of Title 37 of CFR to have an assignment recorded by the Office.

Data of record	Updated Data

No data change in this section

Signature

NOTE:

This Application Data Sheet must be signed in accordance with 37 CFR 1.33(b).

This Application Data Sheet **must** be signed by a patent practitioner if one or more of the applicants is a **juristic entity** (e.g., corporation or association). If the applicant is two or more joint inventors, this form must be signed by a patent practitioner, **all** joint inventors who are the applicant, or one or more joint inventor-applicants who have been given power of attorney (e.g., see USPTO Form PTO/AIA/81) on behalf of **all** joint inventor-applicants.

See CFR 1.4(d) for the manner of making signatures and certifications.

Signature	First name	Last name	Registration #	Date
/Scott E Kamholz/	SCOTT	KAMHOLZ	48543	01/30/2026

DocCode - SCORE

Placeholder Sheet for Supplemental Content

Application Number: 19075701 Document Date: 01/30/2026

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APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**01/30/2026 11:21:15 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	74252482	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 1

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
CorrectedADS.pdf	3	Application Data Sheet to update/correct info	59 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
CorrectedADS.pdf	F74D91ECF07431F10E9E43D0BBFA01D78C3A34817054D6F4685D21F46865E49153B1BB45C8D99BC89B845447B061FF1749FDAA09B7C7827C36DBC8956F75CFDD

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If a new application is being filed and the application includes the necessary components for filing date (see 37 CFR 1.53(b)-(d) and MPEP 506), a Filing Receipt (37 CFR 1.54) will be issued in due course and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the filing date of the application

National Stage of an International Application under 35 U.S.C. 371

If a timely submission to enter the national stage of an international application is compliant with the conditions of 35 U.S.C. 371 and other applicable requirements a Form PCT/DO/EO/903 indicating acceptance of the application as a national stage submission under 35 U.S.C. 371 will be issued in addition to the Filing Receipt, in due course.

New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

If a new international application is being filed and the international application includes the necessary components for an international filing date (see PCT Article 11 and MPEP 1810), a Notification of the International Application Number and of the International Filing Date (Form PCT/RO/105) will be issued in due course, subject to prescriptions concerning national security, and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the international filing date of the application.

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ELECTRONIC PAYMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**01/30/2026 11:16:28 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	74252039	AUTHORIZED BY	-
CUSTOMER #	178888	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz

Payment Information

PAYMENT METHOD	PAYMENT TRANSACTION ID	PAYMENT AUTHORIZED BY
CARD / 6274	**E20261TB17497702**	**SCOTT KAMHOLZ**

FEE CODE	DESCRIPTION	ITEM PRICE($)	QUANTITY	ITEM TOTAL($)
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If a timely submission to enter the national stage of an international application is compliant with the conditions of 35 U.S.C.

371 and other applicable requirements a Form PCT/DO/EO/903 indicating acceptance of the application as a national stage submission under 35 U.S.C. 371 will be issued in addition to the Filing Receipt, in due course.

New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**01/30/2026 11:16:28 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

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CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 3

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
LMK-00101-amendment-B-and-response-to-nfoa-APP.TEXT.docx	12	Application body structured text document	45 KB
Warning: The automatic document description has been replaced. Bookmarks were found and have been removed. Bookmarks were found and have been removed.			
LMK-00101-new-drawings1-1.pdf	1	Drawings-only black and white line drawings	133 KB
LMK-00101-amendment-B-and-response-to-nfoa.pdf	12	Auxiliary PDF of Application	270 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
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LMK-00101-new-drawings1-1.pdf	B23CB9E01A7026A44BCB1A87141D0B503B9529A6CC90ACF9E66D242DE284F2C87D352D8727461B8FE0DB17FDB7147BB1272550D4AE4E2B3EA8A296F28B73A546
LMK-00101-amendment-B-and-response-to-nfoa.pdf	2510E94CEA26717585168D326F424A5BABFB9836269CE02DED39EF86A8F4E661B6DDFE4DAAD87F0F137079EE763FE95C281C4BFA31DF85C46F26643B83DDC49B

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If a new international application is being filed and the international application includes the necessary components for an international filing date (see PCT Article 11 and MPEP 1810), a Notification of the International Application Number and of the International Filing Date (Form PCT/RO/105) will be issued in due course, subject to prescriptions concerning national security, and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the international filing date of the application.

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PATENT APPLICATION FEE DETERMINATION RECORD Substitute for Form PTO-875	Application or Docket Number 19/075,701	Filing Date 03/10/2025	☐ To be Mailed

ENTITY: ☐ LARGE ☐ SMALL ☑ MICRO

APPLICATION AS FILED - PART I

FOR	(Column 1) NUMBER FILED	(Column 2) NUMBER EXTRA		RATE ($)	FEE ($)
☐ BASIC FEE (37 CFR 1.16(a), (b), or (c))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
☐ SEARCH FEE (37 CFR 1.16(k), (i), or (m))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
☐ EXAMINATION FEE (37 CFR 1.16(o), (p), or (q))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
TOTAL CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(i))	minus 20 =	*		x $40 =	
INDEPENDENT CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(h))	minus 3 =	*		x $ 120 =	
☐ APPLICATION SIZE FEE (37 CFR 1.16(s))	If the specification and drawings exceed 100 sheets of paper, the application size fee due is $310 ($155 for small entity) for each additional 50 sheets or fraction thereof. See 35 U.S.C. 41(a)(1)(G) and 37 CFR 1.16(s).				
☐ MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM PRESENT (37 CFR 1.16(j))					
* If the difference in column 1 is less than zero, enter "0" in column 2.				TOTAL	

APPLICATION AS AMENDED - PART II

		(Column 1)		(Column 2)	(Column 3)			
AMENDMENT	01/30/2026	CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	PRESENT EXTRA		RATE ($)	ADDITIONAL FEE ($)
	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	* 20	Minus	** 20	= 0		x $40 =	0
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	* 2	Minus	*** 3	= 0		x $ 120 =	0
	☐ Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))							
	☐ FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							
							TOTAL ADD'L FEE	0

		(Column 1)		(Column 2)	(Column 3)			
AMENDMENT		CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	PRESENT EXTRA		RATE ($)	ADDITIONAL FEE ($)
	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=		x $0 =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=		x $0 =	
	☐ Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))							
	☐ FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							
							TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

* If the entry in column 1 is less than the entry in column 2, write "0" in column 3.	ADMIN
** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 20, enter "20".	/ERNEST D DAVIS/
*** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 3, enter "3".	
The "Highest Number Previously Paid For" (Total or Independent) is the highest number found in the appropriate box in column 1.	

This collection of information is required by 37 CFR 1.16. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 12 minutes to complete, including gathering, preparing, and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. **SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450.**

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 01/27/2026

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
01/27/2026	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

sek@toolpat.com

Applicant-Initiated Interview Summary	Application No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s) Kamholz, Leah M.		
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	AIA (First Inventor to File) Status Yes	Page 1 of 2

All Participants (applicant, applicants representative, PTO personnel)	Title	Type
CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Primary Examiner	Telephonic
Scott Kamholz	Attorney of Record	
Leah Kamholz	Inventor	

Date of Interview: 22 January 2026

Issues Discussed:

35 U.S.C. 112

Discussion was made as to adhesives being able to be removable, as described in the specification. Upon filing formal arguments, the rejection of claim 15 under 35 U.S.C. 112(b) would be withdrawn.

35 U.S.C. 102

Discussion was made as to the structure shown in Ruggles (US 111,127,382 B1) not including a turret. However the reference was shown to described the device being used with a clarinet, where clarinets include turrets as described in the present application. Lack of application to a specific key or area of the clarinet in the claims allows for any tone hole to include Ruggles's device. Discussion was further made as to the claims broadly describing the device being adhered to the instrument, and therefore Ruggles's broad description of adhering the device was sufficient to disclose the limitation.

Proposed Amendment(s)

Proposed claims 34, 36 and 42 overcome the Ruggles reference, however examiner suggested to further include the disk being removably adhered to the top surface of the tone hole to overcome US 9,520,111 B1 and US 4,798,122.

Drawings

Proposed drawings were discussed, but it was suggested that the adapter be shown to be larger than a tone hole, consistent with the other drawings in the application, so as to avoid any new matter issues.

Other

Brief discussion was further made regarding US 9,520,111 B1 teaching a device being fixed inside a tone hole and and US 4,798,122 teaching a device on the top of a tone hole.

☑ Attachment

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	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	**Art Unit** 3619	**AIA (First Inventor to File) Status** Yes	**Page** **2 of 2**

/Christopher Uhlir/ Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619	

Applicant is reminded that a complete written statement as to the substance of the interview must be made of record in the application file. It is the applicants responsibility to provide the written statement, unless the interview was initiated by the Examiner and the Examiner has indicated that a written summary will be provided. See MPEP 713.04
Please further see:
MPEP 713.04
Title 37 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) § 1.133 Interviews, paragraph (b)
37 CFR § 1.2 Business to be transacted in writing

Applicant recordation instructions: The formal written reply to the last Office action must include the substance of the interview. (See MPEP section 713.04). If a reply to the last Office action has already been filed, applicant is given a non-extendable period of the longer of one month or thirty days from this interview date, or the mailing date of this interview summary form, whichever is later, to file a statement of the substance of the interview.

Examiner recordation instructions: Examiners must summarize the substance of any interview of record. A complete and proper recordation of the substance of an interview should include the items listed in MPEP 713.04 for complete and proper recordation including the identification of the general thrust of each argument or issue discussed, a general indication of any other pertinent matters discussed regarding patentability and the general results or outcome of the interview, to include an indication as to whether or not agreement was reached on the issues raised.

1. **Claim 28: 102 rejection over Ruggles**
    a. Rejection does not identify what structure in Ruggles corresponds to recited "turret."
        i. Ruggles's tone holes are simple holes formed in the body with no other surface features.
        ii. As properly construed in light of the Specification, "turret" must require some demarcation from surrounding structure
            1. Specification describes one exemplary structure as bore wall 13 surrounded by ring sink 16 (¶ [0021]; Fig. 1)
            2. "Turret" does not necessarily require a wall and surrounding sink, but it does require something more than just a hole.
    b. Rejection does not identify how Ruggles is "adhering" flanged head 114 anywhere with an air-tight seal.
        i. Ruggles discloses that flanged head 114 is "affixedly coupled" to bore but does not disclose that this coupling involves adhering.
        ii. Ruggles discloses flanged head 114 is used to provide "structural support" (9:7–8) but does not disclose that "structural support" includes an air-tight seal.
2. **New drawings**
    a. New drawings 8A-8C are added:

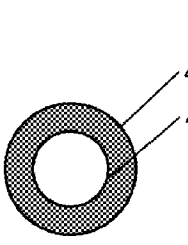


FIG. 8A

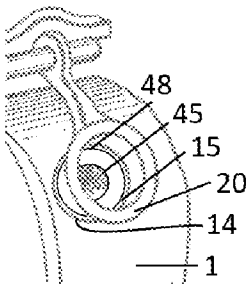


FIG. 8B

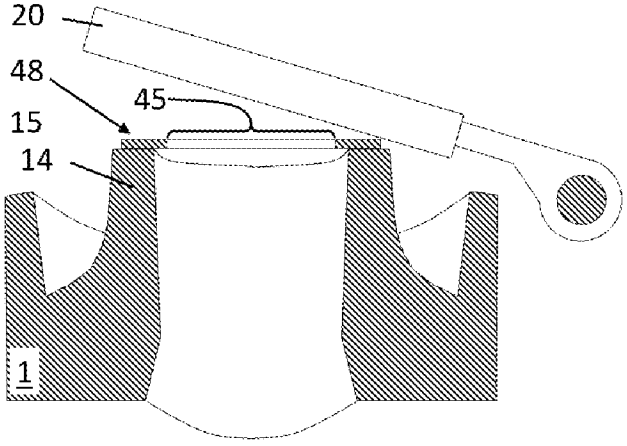


FIG. 8C

    b. They illustrate the claimed embodiment of adhering an adapter to a turret, as required by 37 C.F.R. § 1.83
    c. Intended to illustrate the statements in the specification as filed:
        i. "The adapter could be applied directly to the top surface **15** of turret **14**" (¶ [0028])
        ii. "[A]n adapter may be a flat (or essentially flat) disk **48**" (¶ [0029])
        iii. No other disclosure is intended to be conveyed

iv. Applicant requests an indication that these drawings would be acceptable.

3. New claims depending from claim 28

Applicant proposes the following new claims and requests an indication whether any would avoid a 102 or 103 rejection over Ruggles:

33. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the adapter **consists essentially of** the disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk.

34. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the adapter **consists of** the disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on an underside of the disk.

35. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the turret comprises a bore wall extending above a main body surface of the clarinet.

36. (New) The method of claim 35, wherein the bore wall terminates with a top surface of the turret, and an underside of the disk is adhered to the top surface of the turret.

37. (New) The method of claim 36, wherein adhesive on the underside of the disk adhesively adheres the adapter to the top surface of the turret with an airtight seal between the underside of the disk and the top surface.

38. (New) The method of claim 37, wherein the adapter is a flat disk and the top surface of the turret is flat.

39. (New) The method of claim 38, wherein the tone hole to which the adapter is adhesively adhered is a lowest tone hole on the clarinet.

40. (New) The method of claim 39, wherein the clarinet is a Boehm system clarinet comprising a lowest tone hole ring pivotably received in a ring sink surrounding the turret.

41. (New) The method of claim 40, wherein the aperture in the disk has a diameter of about 8 mm.

42. (New) The method of claim 41, wherein the adapter **consists of** the disk of rigid or semirigid material and the adhesive on the underside of the disk, and wherein the adhesive is removable.

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 10/15/2025

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
10/15/2025	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

sek@toolpat.com

Office Action Summary	Application No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s) Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	AIA (First Inventor to File) Status Yes

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address --

Period for Reply

A SHORTENED STATUTORY PERIOD FOR REPLY IS SET TO EXPIRE 3 MONTHS FROM THE MAILING DATE OF THIS COMMUNICATION.

- Extensions of time may be available under the provisions of 37 CFR 1.136(a). In no event, however, may a reply be timely filed after SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- If NO period for reply is specified above, the maximum statutory period will apply and will expire SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- Failure to reply within the set or extended period for reply will, by statute, cause the application to become ABANDONED (35 U.S.C. § 133). Any reply received by the Office later than three months after the mailing date of this communication, even if timely filed, may reduce any earned patent term adjustment. See 37 CFR 1.704(b).

Status

1)☑ Responsive to communication(s) filed on 28 August 2025.

☐ A declaration(s)/affidavit(s) under **37 CFR 1.130(b)** was/were filed on _____.

2a)☐ This action is **FINAL.** 2b) ☑ This action is non-final.

3)☐ An election was made by the applicant in response to a restriction requirement set forth during the interview on _____; the restriction requirement and election have been incorporated into this action.

4)☐ Since this application is in condition for allowance except for formal matters, prosecution as to the merits is closed in accordance with the practice under *Ex parte Quayle*, 1935 C.D. 11, 453 O.G. 213.

Disposition of Claims*

5) ☑ Claim(s) 13-32 is/are pending in the application.

5a) Of the above claim(s) 21-27 is/are withdrawn from consideration.

6) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are allowed.

7) ☑ Claim(s) 13-20 and 28-32 is/are rejected.

8) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are objected to.

9) ☐ Claim(s) _____ are subject to restriction and/or election requirement

* If any claims have been determined allowable, you may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at a participating intellectual property office for the corresponding application. For more information, please see http://www.uspto.gov/patents/init_events/pph/index.jsp or send an inquiry to **PPHfeedback@uspto.gov.**

Application Papers

10)☐ The specification is objected to by the Examiner.

11)☑ The drawing(s) filed on 10 March 2025 is/are: a)☑ accepted or b)☐ objected to by the Examiner.

Applicant may not request that any objection to the drawing(s) be held in abeyance. See 37 CFR 1.85(a).

Replacement drawing sheet(s) including the correction is required if the drawing(s) is objected to. See 37 CFR 1.121(d).

Priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119

12)☐ Acknowledgment is made of a claim for foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a)-(d) or (f).

Certified copies:

a)☐ All b)☐ Some** c)☐ None of the:

1.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received.

2.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received in Application No. _____.

3.☐ Copies of the certified copies of the priority documents have been received in this National Stage application from the International Bureau (PCT Rule 17.2(a)).

** See the attached detailed Office action for a list of the certified copies not received.

Attachment(s)

1) ☑ Notice of References Cited (PTO-892)

2) ☑ Information Disclosure Statement(s) (PTO/SB/08a and/or PTO/SB/08b) Paper No(s)/Mail Date 03/10/2025 and 08/28/2025.

3) ☐ Interview Summary (PTO-413) Paper No(s)/Mail Date _____.

4) ☐ Other: _____.

DETAILED ACTION

Notice of Pre-AIA or AIA Status

1. The present application, filed on or after March 16, 2013, is being examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

Response to Amendment

2. Receipt is acknowledged of applicant's amendment filed August 28, 2025. Claims 1-12 have been canceled without prejudice. Claims 13-32 are pending and an action on the merits is as follows.

Election/Restrictions

3. Applicant's Species election in the reply filed on August 28, 2025 is acknowledged. Because applicant did not distinctly and specifically point out the supposed errors in the restriction requirement, the election has been treated as an election without traverse (MPEP § 818.01(a)).

4. Claims 21-27 are withdrawn from further consideration pursuant to 37 CFR 1.142(b) as being drawn to a nonelected species, there being no allowable generic or linking claim.

Claim Rejections - 35 USC § 112

5. The following is a quotation of 35 U.S.C. 112(b):

> (b) CONCLUSION.—The specification shall conclude with one or more claims particularly pointing out and distinctly claiming the subject matter which the inventor or a joint inventor regards as the invention.

The following is a quotation of 35 U.S.C. 112 (pre-AIA), second paragraph:

> The specification shall conclude with one or more claims particularly pointing out and distinctly claiming the subject matter which the applicant regards as his invention.

6. Claims 15-20 are rejected under 35 U.S.C. 112(b) or 35 U.S.C. 112 (pre-AIA), second paragraph, as being indefinite for failing to particularly point out and distinctly claim the subject matter which the inventor or a joint inventor (or for applications subject to pre-AIA 35 U.S.C. 112, the applicant), regards as the invention.

Claim 15 includes the limitation "reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet comprises/by adhering an adapter to a turret or a tone hole of the clarinet with an air-tight seal". However claim 13, from which claim 15 depends, required the diameter to be temporarily reduced. It is unclear how the diameter of a tone hole can be temporarily reduced, i.e., temporarily affixing an adapter, since the adapter is adhered to a turret of a tone hole and any removal of the adhesive used in adhering the adapter would damage the clarinet.

Claim 18 includes the limitation "the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises paper". However as is recognized in the art, paper is neither rigid nor semirigid. It is unclear how paper, sized and shaped to attach to a tone hole of a clarinet can have be rigid or semirigid.

Claims 16, 17, 19 and 20 depend from claim 15 and therefore inherit all claimed limitations. These claims do not correct the deficiencies of claim 15.

Claim Rejections - 35 USC § 102

7. In the event the determination of the status of the application as subject to AIA 35 U.S.C. 102 and 103 (or as subject to pre-AIA 35 U.S.C. 102 and 103) is incorrect, any correction of the statutory basis (i.e., changing from AIA to pre-AIA) for the rejection will

not be considered a new ground of rejection if the prior art relied upon, and the rationale supporting the rejection, would be the same under either status.

8. The following is a quotation of the appropriate paragraphs of 35 U.S.C. 102 that form the basis for the rejections under this section made in this Office action:

> A person shall be entitled to a patent unless –
>
> (a)(1) the claimed invention was patented, described in a printed publication, or in public use, on sale, or otherwise available to the public before the effective filing date of the claimed invention.

9. Claims 13-16, 20, 28 and 29 are rejected under 35 U.S.C. 102(a)(1) as being anticipated by Ruggles (US 11,127,382 B1).

Claim 13: Ruggles discloses a method of facilitating playing a wind instrument (100) (column 9 lines 20-23), where the wind instrument includes a clarinet (column 6 lines 56-60). A chimney member is removably coupled to the wind instrument (column 8 lines 63-64) to thereby temporarily reduce a diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet (column 8 lines 33-41), as can be seen in FIG. 2.

Claim 14: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where temporarily reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet comprises attaching an adapter (chimney member) to a clarinet tone hole turret (column 2 lines 41-42), the adapter comprising a peripheral region sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with the turret and having a central void (channel 214) defined by the peripheral region as shown in FIG. 2 (column 8 lines 56-59).

Claim 15: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where temporarily reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet comprises attaching an adapter (chimney member) to a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet (column 2 lines 41-

42) with an air-tight seal via adhering the adapter (column 8 lines 56-61). The adapter is shown in FIG. 2 to comprise a disk (flange head 114) of rigid or semirigid material in order to provide additional structural support (column 9 lines 5-10), and an aperture (channel 214) defining a central void in the disk.

Claim 16: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises plastic (polymeric composition) (column 7 lines 53-56).

Claim 20: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where the adapter is made of a material best suited for musical wind instruments, such as polymeric composition (column 7 lines 53-56). Therefore the adapter includes a bottom surface defined by an airtight material.

Claim 28: Ruggles discloses a method of facilitating playing a wind instrument (100) (column 9 lines 20-23), where the wind instrument includes a clarinet (column 6 lines 56-60). An adapter (chimney member) is attached to a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet (column 2 lines 41-42) with an air-tight seal via adhering the adapter (column 8 lines 56-61). The adapter is shown in FIG. 2 to comprise a disk (flange head 114) of rigid or semirigid material in order to provide additional structural support (column 9 lines 5-10), and an aperture (channel 214) defining a central void in the disk.

Claim 29: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises plastic (polymeric composition) (column 7 lines 53-56).

Claim Rejections - 35 USC § 103

10. The following is a quotation of 35 U.S.C. 103 which forms the basis for all obviousness rejections set forth in this Office action:

> A patent for a claimed invention may not be obtained, notwithstanding that the claimed invention is not identically disclosed as set forth in section 102, if the differences between the claimed invention and the prior art are such that the claimed invention as a whole would have been obvious before the effective filing date of the claimed invention to a person having ordinary skill in the art to which the claimed invention pertains. Patentability shall not be negated by the manner in which the invention was made.

11. Claims 17-19 and 30-32 are rejected under 35 U.S.C. 103 as being obvious over Ruggles (US 11,127,382 B1).

Claims 17 and 30: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, but fails to disclose the disk of rigid or semirigid material to comprise polyvinyl chloride.

However it would have been obvious to one of ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the claimed invention to provide the disk of rigid or semirigid material to comprise polyvinyl chloride, since it has been held to be within the general skill of a worker in the art to select a known material on the basis of its suitability for the intended use. In *re Leshin*, 125 USPQ 416. Doing so would reduce the cost to manufacture said adapter due to the availability of the material, while limiting providing strength to the adapter.

Claims 18 and 31: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, but fails to disclose the disk of rigid or semirigid material to comprise paper.

However it would have been obvious to one of ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the claimed invention to provide the disk of rigid or semirigid material to comprise paper, since it has been held to be within the general skill of a worker in the art to select a known material on the basis of its suitability for the intended use. In *re Leshin*, 125 USPQ 416. Doing so would reduce the cost to manufacture said adapter due to the availability of the material, while limiting the overall weight of the adapter.

Claims 19 and 32: Ruggles discloses a method as stated above, where the disk has an inner diameter of 8 mm (column 10 lines 3-5). This reference fails to disclose the disk to have an outer diameter of about 10 mm.

However it would have been obvious to one of ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the claimed invention to provide the disk to have an outer diameter of about 10 mm, since it has been held that where the general conditions of a claim are disclosed in the prior art, discovering the optimum or working ranges involves only routine skill in the art. In *re Aller*, 105 USPQ 233. Doing so would provide additional structural support, as taught in Ruggles (column 9 lines 5-10), while preventing obstruction with other tone holes when playing the clarinet.

Conclusion

12. The prior art made of record and not relied upon is considered pertinent to applicant's disclosure. US 4,539,888 and US 9,520,111 B1 pertaining to an adapter formed to reduce a diameter of a tone hole.

13. Any inquiry concerning this communication or earlier communications from the examiner should be directed to CHRISTOPHER UHLIR whose telephone number is (571)270-3091. The examiner can normally be reached M-F 8:30-4.

Examiner interviews are available via telephone, in-person, and video conferencing using a USPTO supplied web-based collaboration tool. To schedule an interview, applicant is encouraged to use the USPTO Automated Interview Request (AIR) at http://www.uspto.gov/interviewpractice.

If attempts to reach the examiner by telephone are unsuccessful, the examiner's supervisor, Anita Coupe can be reached at 571-270-3614. The fax phone number for the organization where this application or proceeding is assigned is 571-273-8300.

Information regarding the status of published or unpublished applications may be obtained from Patent Center. Unpublished application information in Patent Center is available to registered users. To file and manage patent submissions in Patent Center, visit: https://patentcenter.uspto.gov. Visit https://www.uspto.gov/patents/apply/patent-center for more information about Patent Center and https://www.uspto.gov/patents/docx for information about filing in DOCX format. For additional questions, contact the Electronic Business Center (EBC) at 866-217-9197 (toll-free). If you would like assistance from a USPTO Customer Service Representative, call 800-786-9199 (IN USA OR CANADA) or 571-272-1000.

/Christopher Uhlir/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619
October 10, 2025

Notice of References Cited	Application/Control No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	Page 1 of 1

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Document Number Country Code-Number-Kind Code	Date YYYY-MM-DD	Name	CPC Classification	US Classification
*	A	US-4539888-A	1985-09-10	Whelan; Maurice	G10D7/063	984/145
*	B	US-9520111-B1	2016-12-13	Clissold; Maximilian Spencer	G10D9/04	1/1
*	C	US-11127382-B1	2021-09-21	Ruggles; Richard	G10D7/10	1/1
	D					
	E					
	F					
	G					
	H					
	I					
	J					
	K					
	L					
	M					

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Document Number Country Code-Number-Kind Code	Date YYYY-MM-DD	Country	Name	CPC Classification
	N					
	O					
	P					
	Q					
	R					
	S					
	T					

NON-PATENT DOCUMENTS

*		Include as applicable: Author, Title, Date, Publisher, Edition or Volume, Pertinent Pages
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	V	
	W	
	X	

*A copy of this reference is not being furnished with this Office action. (See MPEP § 707.05(a).)
Dates in YYYY-MM-DD format are publication dates. Classifications may be US or foreign.

NO IDS SIZE FEE REQUIRED

Doc code: IDS
Doc description: Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Filed

PTO/SB/08 (01-25)
Approved for use through 11/30/2027. OMB 0651-0031
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INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	19075701
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

U.S. PATENTS Remove

Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Patent Number	Kind Code[1]	Issue Date	Name of Inventor of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear
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Examiner Initials*	Cite No	Include name of the author (in CAPITAL LETTERS), title of the article (when appropriate), title of the item (book, magazine, journal, serial, symposium, catalog, etc), date, pages(s), volume-issue number(s), publisher, city and/or country where published.	T[5]

ALL REFERENCES CONSIDERED EXCEPT WHERE LINED THROUGH. /cu/

INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	19075701
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

	1	"uxcell 240 Pcs M8 PVC Flat Washers 8mm ID 12mm OD 0.5mm Thick" - retrieved from the internet on 2028-08-28 from https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0DRGH9TKW	☐
	2	"Padding for small fingers" message thread - retrieved from the internet on 2028-08-17 from test.woodwind.org/clarinet/BBoard/read.html?f=1&i=215830&t=215830	☐

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EXAMINER SIGNATURE

Examiner Signature	/Christopher Uhlir/	Date Considered	10/10/2025

*EXAMINER: Initial if reference considered and whether or not citation is in conformance with MPEP 609. Draw line through a citation if not in conformance and not considered. Include copy of this form with next communication to applicant.

[1] See Kind Codes of USPTO Patent Documents at www.USPTO.GOV or MPEP 901.04. [2] Enter office that issued the document, by the two-letter code (WIPO Standard ST.3). [3] For Japanese patent documents, the indication of the year of the reign of the Emperor must precede the serial number of the patent document. [4] Kind of document by the appropriate symbols as indicated on the document under WIPO Standard ST.16 if possible. [5] Applicant is to place a check mark here if English language translation is attached.

ALL REFERENCES CONSIDERED EXCEPT WHERE LINED THROUGH. /cu/

Doc code: IDS
Doc description: Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Filed

PTO/SB/08 (01-25)
Approved for use through 11/30/2027. OMB 0651-0031
U.S. Patent and Trademark Office; U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
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INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	
Examiner Name	
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

U.S. PATENTS Remove

Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Patent Number	Kind Code[1]	Issue Date	Name of Inventor of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear
	1	4798122		1989-01-17	Gisler	
	2	7468479		2008-12-23	Kraus	
	3	7851685		2010-12-14	Reissner	

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Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Publication Number	Kind Code[1]	Publication Date	Name of Inventor or Applicant of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear
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Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Foreign Document Number[3]	Country Code[2] i	Kind Code[4]	Publication Date	Name of Patentee or Applicant of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear	T[5]
	1							☐

ALL REFERENCES CONSIDERED EXCEPT WHERE LINED THROUGH. /cu/

INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	
Examiner Name	
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

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Examiner Initials*	Cite No	Include name of the author (in CAPITAL LETTERS), title of the article (when appropriate), title of the item (book, magazine, journal, serial, symposium, catalog, etc), date, pages(s), volume-issue number(s), publisher, city and/or country where published.	T[5]
	1	"Plateau Mechanism - Covered Holes" -- retrieved from the internet on March 8, 2025 from https://www.clarinet.dk/content/show_content.php?id=101&cont=eu&lang=en&instr=cla	☐
	2	"10pcs Open Hole Flute Plugs" -- retrieved from the internet on March 8, 2025 from https://www.amazon.com/MusicMedic-10pcs-Open-Flute-Plugs/dp/B0829D5DXF	☐

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EXAMINER SIGNATURE

Examiner Signature	/Christopher Uhlir/	Date Considered	10/10/2025

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[1] See Kind Codes of USPTO Patent Documents at www.USPTO.GOV or MPEP 901.04. [2] Enter office that issued the document, by the two-letter code (WIPO Standard ST.3). [3] For Japanese patent documents, the indication of the year of the reign of the Emperor must precede the serial number of the patent document. [4] Kind of document by the appropriate symbols as indicated on the document under WIPO Standard ST.16 if possible. [5] Applicant is to place a check mark here if English language translation is attached.

ALL REFERENCES CONSIDERED EXCEPT WHERE LINED THROUGH. /cu/

Search Notes	Application/Control No.	Applicant(s)/Patent Under Reexamination
	19/075,701	Kamholz, Leah M.
	Examiner	Art Unit
	CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	3619

CPC - Searched*		
Symbol	Date	Examiner
G10D 9/00,04,047	07/11/2025	CU

CPC Combination Sets - Searched*		
Symbol	Date	Examiner

US Classification - Searched*			
Class	Subclass	Date	Examiner

* See search history printout included with this form or the SEARCH NOTES box below to determine the scope of the search.

Search Notes		
Search Notes	Date	Examiner
Inventor name search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Keyword search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Similarity search in PE2E SEARCH	07/11/2025	CU
Keyword search in PE2E SEARCH	10/09/2025	CU
Similarity search in PE2E SEARCH	10/09/2025	CU

Interference Search			
US Class/CPC Symbol	US Subclass/CPC Group	Date	Examiner

PE2E SEARCH - Search History (Prior Art)

Ref #	Hits	Search Query	DBs	Default Operator	Plurals	British Equivalents	Time Stamp
L1	0	((("KAMHOLZ") near3 ("Leah"))).INV.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; EPO; JPO; DERWENT)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:30 PM
L2	3	("4798122" OR "7468479" OR "7851685").pn.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:30 PM
L3	829	g10d9/00,04,047.cpc.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:34 PM
L4	305	L3 AND (clarinet OR woodwind OR flute OR oboe OR bassoon)	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:34 PM
L5	25	L4 AND ((sleeve OR ring OR guid$3 OR aid OR circle OR circular$2 OR disk OR band OR loop) near3 ((attach$4 OR mount$4 OR fix$4 OR affix$4 OR secur$4 OR adher$5 OR tap$3 OR stick$4 OR stuck OR plac$5 OR position$4 OR locat$4 OR surround$4 OR aroun$4 OR circumfer$5) near3 (tonehole OR hole OR open$4 OR aperture)))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:35 PM
L6	17077	g10d.cpcl.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:38 PM
L7	1173	L6 AND (clarinet OR woodwind OR flute OR oboe OR bassoon)	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:38 PM
L8	67	L7 AND ((sleeve OR ring OR guid$3 OR aid OR circle OR circular$2 OR disk OR band OR loop) near3 ((attach$4 OR mount$4 OR fix$4 OR affix$4 OR secur$4 OR adher$5 OR glu$3 OR tap$3 OR stick$4 OR stuck OR plac$5 OR position$4 OR locat$4 OR surround$4 OR aroun$4 OR circumfer$5) near3 (tonehole OR hole OR open$4 OR aperture)))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:40 PM
L9	42	L8 NOT L5	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:40 PM

L10	48	(Artificial Intelligence) Similar to: 19/075,701 with 0 CPC Selections and 0 Text Selections Text: (RU-2380235-C2 OR WO-2025129907-A1 OR JP-S60107096-A OR WO-2025132736-A1 OR CN-2036302-U OR JP-2000312851-A OR JP-3252914-B2 OR EP-0840088-B1 OR JP-3166189-U OR JP-4439577-B1 OR JP-2010125162-A OR RU-2623516-C2 OR EP-1604755-A1 OR JP-4389111-B2 OR US-1089528-A OR BR-202012028620-U2 OR EP-2590161-A1 OR JP-4984804-B2 OR FR-3052997-A1 OR EP-1604755-B1 OR JP-2008086689-A OR PL-2231100-T3 OR US-20240078985-A1 OR JP-H0580748-A OR US-20130192449-A1 OR US-1344386-A OR TW-I576265-B OR JP-2021092735-A OR EP-3372122-B1 OR CN-107970117-B OR AT-129237-B OR US-5341790-A OR ES-2191304-T3 OR US-1586260-A OR US-20200348103-A1 OR DE-4233461-C2 OR CN-213994237-U OR US-20190234704-A1 OR JP-3166779-U OR US-20220011065-A1 OR EP-2535108-B1 OR TW-568838-B OR CN-216148595-U OR US-20210147138-A1 OR US-20210190448-A1 OR DE-4203572-A1 OR US-20180321004-A1 OR US-20210272544-A1 OR JP-H01240477-A OR US-3168764-A).did.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; FIT (CA, CH, CN, DE, EA, EP, FI, FR, GB, JP, KR, NL, TW, WO))	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:45 PM

L11	41	(Artificial Intelligence) Similar to: 19/075,701 with 1 CPC Selection and 3 Text Selections Text: (EP-2590161-A1 OR GB-2030752-B OR JP-3252914-B2 OR DK-132298-B OR US-20200284537-A1 OR JP-S60107096-A OR RU-2623516-C2 OR BR-202012028620-U2 OR CN-2036302-U OR IT-1080013-B OR GB-2169542-B OR AT-149559-B OR DE-19609543-A1 OR DE-212020000431-U1 OR EP-0294519-A2 OR JP-6017873-B2 OR US-4934919-A OR EP-0294519-B1 OR US-1344386-A OR DK-2373361-T3 OR JP-H0830264-A OR US-20030039715-A1 OR SU-1679537-A1 OR GB-1562330-A OR KR-101644083-B1 OR DE-202006003351-U1 OR JP-2008281745-A OR KR-20140092737-A OR KR-20220100814-A OR EP-0298044-A2 OR KR-102483158-B1 OR KR-102394495-B1 OR US-20180304299-A1 OR JP-2022075435-A OR KR-20190055595-A OR EP-3162716-A1 OR KR-20230076311-A OR US-20240078985-A1 OR CN-108367817-A OR EP-0210209-B1 OR ES-2341779-T3 OR RU-2697624-C2 OR US-7448307-B1 OR CN-109073345-B OR US-20210063104-A1 OR US-2362065-A OR ES-2266706-T3 OR US-20220077537-A1 OR BR-PI0911648-A2 OR EP-3886227-B1).did.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; FIT (CA, CH, CN, DE, EA, EP, FI, FR, GB, JP, KR, NL, TW, WO))	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/07/11 03:47 PM

L12	11	"20130283996" "4392408"	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	OR	ON	ON	2025/07/24 01:41 PM
L13	17143	g10d.cpcl.	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 01:12 PM
L14	979	L13 AND (clarinet OR woodwind OR oboe OR bassoon OR (wood wind))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 01:13 PM
L15	93	L14 AND (((partial$3 OR part$3 OR semi OR portion OR segment$3 OR fraction$5 OR small OR little OR ring) near3 (cover$4 OR block$4 OR restrict$5 OR limit$4 OR shell OR lid OR top OR jacket OR cas$3 OR cap OR hat OR closure OR plug OR overla$4 OR shutter)) near5 (air OR flow$4 OR airflow$4 OR hole OR open$4 OR aperture OR turret))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 01:21 PM
L16	105	L14 AND (((decreas$4 OR reduc$4 OR small$4 OR less$5 OR diminish$4) near3 (siz$3 OR diameter OR amount OR perimeter OR circumferen$5 OR area OR surface)) near5 (air OR flow$4 OR airflow$4 OR hole OR open$4 OR aperture OR turret))	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 02:26 PM
L17	77	L16 NOT L15	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; EPO; JPO)	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 02:26 PM
L18	46	(Artificial Intelligence) Similar to: 19/075,701 with 0 CPC Selections and 0 Text Selections Text: (DE-102006043690-A1 OR WO-2025109975-A1 OR JP-2023007982-A OR CN-215581660-U OR RU-2380235-C2 OR US-5734117-A OR CN-2036302-U OR RU-2623516-C2 OR WO-2025132736-A1 OR EP-0840088-B1 OR US-1300112-A OR TW-568838-B OR JP-	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; FIT (CA, CH, CN, DE, EA, EP, FI, FR, GB, JP, KR, NL, TW, WO))	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 02:38 PM

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L19	48	(Artificial Intelligence) Similar to: 19/075,701 with 1 CPC Selection and 3 Text Selections Text: (US-4139958-A OR JP-2004055238-A OR JP-2016043379-A OR JP-2025110387-A OR EP-3372122-B1 OR JP-WO2014148445-A1 OR CZ-32655-U1 OR JP-2003181929-A OR NL-8801384-A OR EP-0827222-A2 OR JP-H0119356-B2 OR JP-H05176997-A OR RU-	(US-PGPUB; USPAT; USOCR; FIT (CA, CH, CN, DE, EA, EP, FI, FR, GB, JP, KR, NL, TW, WO))	ADJ	ON	ON	2025/10/09 02:41 PM

		2005129262-A OR DE-102006043690-A1 OR JP-2003225928-A OR JP-2022185624-A OR WO-2014013563-A1 OR JP-2007165170-A OR CN-101141990-A OR CN-1401492-A OR JP-7249983-B2 OR CN-112128384-B OR JP-2007173062-A OR DE-102013003224-A1 OR JP-H06304981-A OR JP-5114842-B2 OR US-4011744-A OR JP-S59206153-A OR WO-2025109975-A1 OR TW-568838-B OR EP-3415136-A2 OR JP-2008059973-A OR US-20050262750-A1 OR US-9533130-B2 OR JP-2024014664-A OR JP-2006518658-A OR JP-4843947-B2 OR JP-2023007982-A OR EP-2923687-A1 OR ES-3010570-T3 OR JP-2008243657-A OR WO-2024058131-A1 OR JP-S6090889-A OR US-1300112-A OR JP-S62204538-A OR CN-110588245-A OR FR-2664969-A1 OR US-5886719-A OR JP-5651803-B1 OR JP-3166779-U).did.					

PE2E SEARCH - Search History (Interference)

There are no Interference searches to show.

Bibliographic Data

Application No: 19/075,701

Foreign Priority claimed: ○ Yes ◉ No

35 USC 119 (a-d) conditions met: ☐ Yes ☑ No ☐ Met After Allowance

Verified and Acknowledged: /Christopher Uhlir/ Examiner's Signature | Initials

Title: Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

FILING or 371(c) DATE	CLASS	GROUP ART UNIT	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.
03/10/2025	084	3619	LMK-001.01
RULE			

APPLICANTS

INVENTORS

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA, UNITED STATES

CONTINUING DATA

FOREIGN APPLICATIONS

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03/17/2025

**** MICRO ENTITY ****

STATE OR COUNTRY

UNITED STATES

ADDRESS

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213
UNITED STATES

FILING FEE RECEIVED

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Application No.: 19/075,701 Filing Date: March 10, 2025 Inventor: Kamholz, Leah M. Title: *Clarinet Tone Hole Adapters* (as amended) Attorney Docket No.: LMK-001.01	Confirmation No.: 3414 Customer No.: 178888 Certificate of Electronic Transmission I hereby certify that this correspondence is being transmitted via the USPTO electronic filing system on 2025-08-28. By: /Scott E. Kamholz/ Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

AMENDMENT AND RESPONSE TO SPECIES ELECTION REQUIREMENT

To the Commissioner for Patents:

The Specification is amended to correct typographical errors and to revise the Title. The claims are amended to cancel claims 1–12 and present new claims 13–32. Support for the new claims are found throughout the Specification, drawings, and claims as originally filed. No new matter is entered.

In response to the Species Election Requirement mailed 2025-07-28, Applicant elects a species newly claimed by this amendment, namely, a method of facilitating clarinet playing by adhering to a clarinet tone hole turret an adapter comprising a flat disc with an adhesive on one side and a central void defining an aperture. Claims 13–20 and 28-32 encompass the elected species. Claims 13 and 14 are generic.

Respectfully submitted,

Date: 2025-08-28 By: /Scott E. Kamholz/
Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

AMENDMENTS TO THE SPECIFICATION

Replace the Title on the first page of the Specification with the following amended Title:

CLARINET TONE HOLE ~~RING~~ ADAPTERS

Replace paragraph [0016] with the following amended paragraph:

[0016] FIG. 9 is a schematic perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which a tone hole ring adapter in the form of a disk has been ~~fitted~~ placed on a tone hole ring.

Replace paragraph [0032] with the following amended paragraph:

[0032] A wide variety of materials, shapes, sizes, and properties are suitable for a tone hole ring adapter. An adapter could be made from thin latex or another elastomer. An adapter could be made of a deformable plastic, such as plastic wrap made from polyethylene, low-density polyethylene, polyvinyl chloride, or polyvinylidene chloride. In the case of plastic wrap, the wrap could simply be folded over the tone hole ring and pressed together. Other materials include fabric and felt. Such materials should be airtight or treated to be airtight, such as being impregnated with wax or plastic or coated with a sealant, as in [[.]]the tip of a glove ~~made from think latex or another thin elastomer~~. An adapter could be made from a piece of plastic wrap, such as is used for food storage, folded over the tone hole ring.

AMENDMENTS TO THE CLAIMS

Claims 1-12 (Canceled)

13. (New) A method of facilitating clarinet playing, comprising temporarily reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet.

14. (New) The method of claim 13, wherein temporarily reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet comprises attaching an adapter to a clarinet tone hole turret or to a clarinet tone hole ring about the ring's entire circumference, the adapter comprising a peripheral region sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with the turret or the ring and having a central void defined by the peripheral region.

15. (New) The method of claim 13, wherein temporarily reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet comprises adhering an adapter to a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet with an air-tight seal, the adapter comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material and comprising an aperture defining a central void in the disk.

16. (New) The method of claim 15, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises plastic.

17. (New) The method of claim 16, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises polyvinyl chloride.

18. (New) The method of claim 15, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises paper.

19. (New) The method of claim 15, wherein the disk has an outer diameter of about 10 mm and an inner diameter of about 8 mm.

20. (New) The method of claim 15, wherein the adapter has a bottom surface defined by an airtight material.

21. (New) The method of claim 14, wherein the peripheral region is sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with the clarinet tone hole ring about the ring's entire circumference, and the adapter comprises and upper layer of adhesive tape having an adhesive side and a lower layer of adhesive tape having an adhesive side, the adhesive sides of the layers facing one another, further wherein the upper layer is sized and

shaped to be adhered to a top surface of the tone hole ring, and the lower layer is sized and shaped to be adhered to a bottom surface of the tone hole ring, further wherein the central void is defined in the upper layer and the lower layer by apertures.

22. (New) The method of claim 14, wherein the adapter further comprises one or more clips extending from the peripheral region, wherein the adapter is sized and shaped to attach to the tone hole ring by the one or more clips.

23. (New) The method of claim 22, wherein the clips are lined with airtight material to seal against the tone hole ring.

24. (New) The method of claim 14, wherein the adapter comprises a slipcover having a top layer attached peripherally to a bottom layer leaving a side passage sized and shaped to permit passage of the tone hole ring such that the slipcover encases the tone hole ring, further wherein the top layer and the bottom layer define apertures to form the central void.

25. (New) The method of claim 24, wherein the adapter further comprises a stem extending from the slipcover sized and shaped to permit passage of the tone hole ring.

26. (New) The method of claim 14, wherein the adapter comprises a first layer of adhesive tape sized and shaped to adhere to the tone hole ring, the first layer defining an aperture to form the central void.

27. (New) The method of claim 26, wherein the adapter further comprises a second layer adhered to a bottom surface of the first layer, the second layer sized and shaped to correspond to an inner diameter of the tone hole ring, thereby shielding adhesive from exposure, the second layer defining an aperture to form the central void.

28. (New) A method of facilitating clarinet playing, comprising reducing the diameter of one or more tone holes on the clarinet by adhering an adapter comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material to a turret of a tone hole of the clarinet with an air-tight seal, the disk comprising an aperture defining a central void in the disk.

29. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises plastic.

30. (New) The method of claim 29, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises polyvinyl chloride.

31. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk of rigid or semirigid material comprises paper.

32. (New) The method of claim 28, wherein the disk has an outer diameter of about 10 mm and an inner diameter of about 8 mm.

ABSTRACT

Replace the Abstract on page 10 of the Specification with the following amended Abstract:

Adapters that cover or narrow the apertures of clarinet tones or tone hole rings may be used to make it easier for players with small fingers or reduced finger mobility to achieve air-tight seals of the tone holes. An adapter may be formed, for example, by a ~~sleeve of a thin, flexible, and elastic~~ disk of material that is adhered to a tone hole~~slipped over a clarinet ring~~. The disk ~~sleeve may~~ defines a hole through the plane of the disk that reduces the diameter of the clarinet tone hole.

NO IDS SIZE FEE REQUIRED

Doc code: IDS
Doc description: Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Filed

PTO/SB/08 (01-25)
Approved for use through 11/30/2027. OMB 0651-0031
U.S. Patent and Trademark Office; U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
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INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	19075701
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

U.S. PATENTS

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Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Patent Number	Kind Code[1]	Issue Date	Name of Inventor of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear
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U.S. PATENT APPLICATION PUBLICATIONS

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NON-PATENT LITERATURE DOCUMENTS

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INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	19075701
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

	1	"uxcell 240 Pcs M8 PVC Flat Washers 8mm ID 12mm OD 0.5mm Thick" - retrieved from the internet on 2028-08-28 from https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0DRGH9TKW	☐
	2	"Padding for small fingers" message thread - retrieved from the internet on 2028-08-17 from test.woodwind.org/clarinet/BBoard/read.html?f=1&i=215830&t=215830	☐

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EXAMINER SIGNATURE

Examiner Signature		Date Considered	

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[1] See Kind Codes of USPTO Patent Documents at www.USPTO.GOV or MPEP 901.04. [2] Enter office that issued the document, by the two-letter code (WIPO Standard ST.3). [3] For Japanese patent documents, the indication of the year of the reign of the Emperor must precede the serial number of the patent document. [4] Kind of document by the appropriate symbols as indicated on the document under WIPO Standard ST.16 if possible. [5] Applicant is to place a check mark here if English language translation is attached.

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First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

TIMING STATEMENT

Please see 37 CFR 1.97(e) to make the appropriate selection(s):

☐ That each item of information contained in the information disclosure statement was first cited in any communication from a foreign patent office in a counterpart foreign application not more than three months prior to the filing of the information disclosure statement. See 37 CFR 1.97(e)(1).

OR

☐ That no item of information contained in the information disclosure statement was cited in a communication from a foreign patent office in a counterpart foreign application, and, to the knowledge of the person signing the certification after making reasonable inquiry, no item of information contained in the information disclosure statement was known to any individual designated in 37 CFR 1.56(c) more than three months prior to the filing of the information disclosure statement. See 37 CFR 1.97(e)(2).

☐ See attached timing statement under 37 CFR 1.97(e).

☒ A timing statement under 37 CFR 1.97(e) is not submitted herewith.

TIMING FEE

☐ The fee set forth in 37 CFR 1.17(p) has been submitted herewith.

COPIES

☐ An identification of an earlier application pursuant to 37 CFR 1.98(d)(1) is attached.

SIZE FEE ASSERTION

Please see 37 CFR 1.17(v) and the IDS Auto-Load Instructions for completing this form to make the appropriate selection of an assertion under 37 CFR 1.98. For the information disclosure statement (IDS) submitted herewith, the applicant or patent owner certifies the following with respect to the cumulative number of applicant-provided or patent-owner provided items of information submitted to date including those in the accompanying IDS (select only one):

☒ No IDS size fee is required under 37 CFR 1.17(v) at this time.

☐ The IDS is accompanied by the IDS size fee under 37 CFR 1.17(v)(1).

☐ The IDS is accompanied by the IDS size fee under 37 CFR 1.17(v)(2).

☐ The IDS is accompanied by the IDS size fee under 37 CFR 1.17(v)(3).

SIGNATURE

A signature of the applicant or representative is required in accordance with 37 CFR 1.33 and 11.18. Please see 37 CFR 1.4(d) for the form of the signature.

Signature	/Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543/	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)	2025-08-28
Name/Print	Scott E. Kamholz	Registration Number	48543

INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	19075701
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	3619
Examiner Name	Uhlir, Christopher J.
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

This collection of information is required by 37 CFR 1.97 and 1.98. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 1 hour to complete, including gathering, preparing and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. **SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450.**

Privacy Act Statement

The Privacy Act of 1974 (P.L. 93-579) requires that you be given certain information in connection with your submission of the attached form related to a patent application or patent. Accordingly, pursuant to the requirements of the Act, please be advised that: (1) the general authority for the collection of this information is 35 U.S.C. 2(b)(2); (2) furnishing of the information solicited is voluntary; and (3) the principal purpose for which the information is used by the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office is to process and/or examine your submission related to a patent application or patent. If you do not furnish the requested information, the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office may not be able to process and/or examine your submission, which may result in termination of proceedings or abandonment of the application or expiration of the patent.

The information provided by you in this form will be subject to the following routine uses:

1. The information on this form will be treated confidentially to the extent allowed under the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552) and the Privacy Act (5 U.S.C. 552a). Records from this system of records may be disclosed to the Department of Justice to determine whether the Freedom of Information Act requires disclosure of these record s.

2. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, in the course of presenting evidence to a court, magistrate, or administrative tribunal, including disclosures to opposing counsel in the course of settlement negotiations.

3. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a Member of Congress submitting a request involving an individual, to whom the record pertains, when the individual has requested assistance from the Member with respect to the subject matter of the record.

4. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a contractor of the Agency having need for the information in order to perform a contract. Recipients of information shall be required to comply with the requirements of the Privacy Act of 1974, as amended, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 552a(m).

5. A record related to an International Application filed under the Patent Cooperation Treaty in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the International Bureau of the World Intellectual Property Organization, pursuant to the Patent Cooperation Treaty.

6. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to another federal agency for purposes of National Security review (35 U.S.C. 181) and for review pursuant to the Atomic Energy Act (42 U.S.C. 218(c)).

7. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the Administrator, General Services, or his/her designee, during an inspection of records conducted by GSA as part of that agency's responsibility to recommend improvements in records management practices and programs, under authority of 44 U.S.C. 2904 and 2906. Such disclosure shall be made in accordance with the GSA regulations governing inspection of records for this purpose, and any other relevant (i.e., GSA or Commerce) directive. Such disclosure shall not be used to make determinations about individuals.

8. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the public after either publication of the application pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 122(b) or issuance of a patent pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 151. Further, a record may be disclosed, subject to the limitations of 37 CFR 1.14, as a routine use, to the public if the record was filed in an application which became abandoned or in which the proceedings were terminated and which application is referenced by either a published application, an application open to public inspections or an issued patent.

9. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a Federal, State, or local law enforcement agency, if the USPTO becomes aware of a violation or potential violation of law or regulation.

UNITED STATES
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Alexandria, VA 22313 - 1450
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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**08/28/2025 09:15:38 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	72053222	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 5

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
LMK-00101-amendment-and-response-2028-08-28-clean-APP.TEXT.docx	6	Application body structured text document	35 KB
Warning: The abstract contains more than one paragraph. Please review and revise if necessary. The automatic document description has been replaced. The abstract contains more than one paragraph. Please review and revise if necessary.			
washers.pdf	5	Non Patent Literature	1291 KB
LMK-00101-IDS-2028-08-28.pdf	5	Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Form (SB08)	1315 KB
padding-for-small-fingers.pdf	4	Non Patent Literature	278 KB
LMK-00101-amendment-and-response-2028-08-28-clean.pdf	6	Auxiliary PDF of Application	199 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
LMK-00101-amendment-and-response-2028-08-28-clean-APP.TEXT.docx	BCC4742AD2C3B15EBC48247E20EEF7AD5A3467463037FA79633694126EF6C83912D0AFA1A725A0E08D606D189A1EEC8C703A7CB931224051FA784054BA32A43C
washers.pdf	6ED1F465F90F7D1FC5491D1834C205C435B73DD96A9D733B98A911AC7B3CDE92212C698D0E7EB6B0C3FB794C579C6414B854AE861164CB9ADC48E225A13B8586
LMK-00101-IDS-2028-08-28.pdf	2120CA9A38A6FCC84FFA1EC2B301D4142C6E10AFA9BE3C0AFE8DB8AB1ACEB9310DC8459B296675754D05D467E7E3365CB0258D3D25C2885E12DEA9D4328D916C
padding-for-small-fingers.pdf	BB45CD71325F7A7387A7B6E6986D92FEB4EB31ABB1ECBF58F14A5A0498F84475F9C737DCBFEBBA7526F188A7B7CA4C2D77E92B92C77C26ACDD3AB1AF3F7AEC0A
LMK-00101-amendment-and-response-2028-08-28-clean.pdf	068295E3E4C8F31A376C71BA8D4A974532BF1F0A0320435CFF2ABDE2B90CC5EE2A01D8876693541E22B3A4E3A5CE7B7DF4A380195BCB8E525077CA095D324620

This Acknowledgement Receipt evidences receipt on the noted date by the USPTO of the indicated documents, characterized by the applicant, and including page counts, where applicable. It serves as evidence of receipt similar to a Post Card, as described in MPEP 503.

New Applications Under 35 U.S.C. 111

If a new application is being filed and the application includes the necessary components for filing date (see 37 CFR 1.53(b)-(d) and MPEP 506), a Filing Receipt (37 CFR 1.54) will be issued in due course and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the filing date of the application

National Stage of an International Application under 35 U.S.C. 371

If a timely submission to enter the national stage of an international application is compliant with the conditions of 35 U.S.C. 371 and other applicable requirements a Form PCT/DO/EO/903 indicating acceptance of the application as a national stage submission under 35 U.S.C. 371 will be issued in addition to the Filing Receipt, in due course.

New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

If a new international application is being filed and the international application includes the necessary components for an international filing date (see PCT Article 11 and MPEP 1810), a Notification of the International Application Number and of the International Filing Date (Form PCT/RO/105) will be issued in due course, subject to prescriptions concerning national security, and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the international filing date of the application.

PTO/SB/06 (09-11)
Approved for use through 1/31/2014. OMB 0651-0032
U.S. Patent and Trademark Office; U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
Under the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a valid OMB control number.

PATENT APPLICATION FEE DETERMINATION RECORD Substitute for Form PTO-875	Application or Docket Number 19/075,701	Filing Date 03/10/2025	☐ To be Mailed

ENTITY: ☐ LARGE ☐ SMALL ☑ MICRO

APPLICATION AS FILED - PART I

FOR	(Column 1) NUMBER FILED	(Column 2) NUMBER EXTRA		RATE ($)	FEE ($)
☐ BASIC FEE (37 CFR 1.16(a), (b), or (c))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
☐ SEARCH FEE (37 CFR 1.16(k), (i), or (m))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
☐ EXAMINATION FEE (37 CFR 1.16(o), (p), or (q))	N/A	N/A		N/A	
TOTAL CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(i))	minus 20 =	*		x $40 =	
INDEPENDENT CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(h))	minus 3 =	*		x $ 120 =	
☐ APPLICATION SIZE FEE (37 CFR 1.16(s))	If the specification and drawings exceed 100 sheets of paper, the application size fee due is $310 ($155 for small entity) for each additional 50 sheets or fraction thereof. See 35 U.S.C. 41(a)(1)(G) and 37 CFR 1.16(s).				
☐ MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM PRESENT (37 CFR 1.16(j))					
* If the difference in column 1 is less than zero, enter "0" in column 2.				TOTAL	

APPLICATION AS AMENDED - PART II

		(Column 1)		(Column 2)	(Column 3)			
AMENDMENT	08/28/2025	CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	PRESENT EXTRA		RATE ($)	ADDITIONAL FEE ($)
	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	* 20	Minus	** 20	= 0		x $40 =	0
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	* 2	Minus	*** 3	= 0		x $ 120 =	0
	☐ Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))							
	☐ FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							
							TOTAL ADD'L FEE	0

		(Column 1)		(Column 2)	(Column 3)			
AMENDMENT		CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	PRESENT EXTRA		RATE ($)	ADDITIONAL FEE ($)
	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=		x $ 0 =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=		x $ 0 =	
	☐ Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))							
	☐ FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							
							TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

* If the entry in column 1 is less than the entry in column 2, write "0" in column 3.	LIE
** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 20, enter "20".	/VENICE M WILLIAMS/
*** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 3, enter "3".	
The "Highest Number Previously Paid For" (Total or Independent) is the highest number found in the appropriate box in column 1.	

This collection of information is required by 37 CFR 1.16. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 12 minutes to complete, including gathering, preparing, and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. **SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450.**

If you need assistance in completing the form, call 1-800-PTO-9199 and select option 2.

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UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
United States Patent and Trademark Office
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P.O. Box 1450
Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450
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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 07/28/2025

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	
UHLIR, CHRISTOPHER J	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
3619	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
07/28/2025	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

sek@toolpat.com

Office Action Summary	Application No. 19/075,701	Applicant(s) Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner CHRISTOPHER UHLIR	Art Unit 3619	AIA (First Inventor to File) Status Yes

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address --

Period for Reply

A SHORTENED STATUTORY PERIOD FOR REPLY IS SET TO EXPIRE 2 MONTHS FROM THE MAILING DATE OF THIS COMMUNICATION.

- Extensions of time may be available under the provisions of 37 CFR 1.136(a). In no event, however, may a reply be timely filed after SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- If NO period for reply is specified above, the maximum statutory period will apply and will expire SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- Failure to reply within the set or extended period for reply will, by statute, cause the application to become ABANDONED (35 U.S.C. § 133). Any reply received by the Office later than three months after the mailing date of this communication, even if timely filed, may reduce any earned patent term adjustment. See 37 CFR 1.704(b).

Status

1)☑ Responsive to communication(s) filed on 19 March 2025.

☐ A declaration(s)/affidavit(s) under **37 CFR 1.130(b)** was/were filed on _____.

2a)☐ This action is **FINAL.** 2b) ☑ This action is non-final.

3)☐ An election was made by the applicant in response to a restriction requirement set forth during the interview on _____; the restriction requirement and election have been incorporated into this action.

4)☐ Since this application is in condition for allowance except for formal matters, prosecution as to the merits is closed in accordance with the practice under *Ex parte Quayle*, 1935 C.D. 11, 453 O.G. 213.

Disposition of Claims*

5) ☑ Claim(s) 1-12 is/are pending in the application.

5a) Of the above claim(s) _____ is/are withdrawn from consideration.

6) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are allowed.

7) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are rejected.

8) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are objected to.

9) ☑ Claim(s) 1-12 are subject to restriction and/or election requirement

* If any claims have been determined allowable, you may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at a participating intellectual property office for the corresponding application. For more information, please see http://www.uspto.gov/patents/init_events/pph/index.jsp or send an inquiry to **PPHfeedback@uspto.gov.**

Application Papers

10)☐ The specification is objected to by the Examiner.

11)☐ The drawing(s) filed on _____ is/are: a)☐ accepted or b)☐ objected to by the Examiner.

Applicant may not request that any objection to the drawing(s) be held in abeyance. See 37 CFR 1.85(a).

Replacement drawing sheet(s) including the correction is required if the drawing(s) is objected to. See 37 CFR 1.121(d).

Priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119

12)☐ Acknowledgment is made of a claim for foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a)-(d) or (f).

Certified copies:

a)☐ All b)☐ Some** c)☐ None of the:

1.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received.

2.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received in Application No. _____.

3.☐ Copies of the certified copies of the priority documents have been received in this National Stage application from the International Bureau (PCT Rule 17.2(a)).

** See the attached detailed Office action for a list of the certified copies not received.

Attachment(s)

1) ☐ Notice of References Cited (PTO-892)

2) ☐ Information Disclosure Statement(s) (PTO/SB/08a and/or PTO/SB/08b) Paper No(s)/Mail Date _____.

3) ☐ Interview Summary (PTO-413) Paper No(s)/Mail Date _____.

4) ☐ Other: _____.

DETAILED ACTION

Election/Restriction

1. This application contains claims directed to the following patentably distinct species:

- Species I directed to the adapter comprising a tube of elastomeric material able to stretch-fit around a tone hole ring
- Species II directed to the adapter comprising upper and lower layers of adhesive tape to be adhered to a tone hole ring
- Species III directed to the adapter comprising a disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on a bottom surface to adhere to a tone hole ring
- Species IV directed to the adapter comprising one or more clips to attach to a tone hole ring
- Species V directed to the adapter comprising a slipcover to encase a tone hole ring

The species are independent or distinct because the claims to the different species recite the mutually exclusive characteristics of such species, i.e., how the adapter is secured to the tone hole ring. In addition, these species are not obvious variants of each other based on the current record.

Applicant is required under 35 U.S.C. 121 to elect a single disclosed species, or a single grouping of patentably indistinct species, for prosecution on the merits to which the claims shall be restricted if no generic claim is finally held to be allowable. Currently, Claim 1 is generic.

There is a serious search and/or examination burden for the patentably distinct species as set forth above because at least the following reason(s) apply: the species or groupings of patentably indistinct species require a different field of search (e.g., searching different classes/subclasses or electronic resources, or employing different search strategies or search queries).

Applicant is advised that the reply to this requirement to be complete must include (i) an election of a species to be examined even though the requirement may be traversed (37 CFR 1.143) **and (ii) identification of the claims encompassing the elected species or grouping of patentably indistinct species**, including any claims subsequently added. An argument that a claim is allowable or that all claims are generic is considered nonresponsive unless accompanied by an election.

The election may be made with or without traverse. To preserve a right to petition, the election must be made with traverse. If the reply does not distinctly and specifically point out supposed errors in the election of species requirement, the election shall be treated as an election without traverse. Traversal must be presented at the time of election in order to be considered timely. Failure to timely traverse the requirement will result in the loss of right to petition under 37 CFR 1.144. If claims are added after the election, applicant must indicate which of these claims are readable on the elected species or grouping of patentably indistinct species.

Should applicant traverse on the ground that the species, or groupings of patentably indistinct species from which election is required, are not patentably distinct, applicant should submit evidence or identify such evidence now of record showing them to be obvious variants or clearly admit on the record that this is the case. In either

instance, if the examiner finds one of the species unpatentable over the prior art, the evidence or admission may be used in a rejection under 35 U.S.C. 103 or pre-AIA 35 U.S.C. 103(a) of the other species.

Upon the allowance of a generic claim, applicant will be entitled to consideration of claims to additional species which depend from or otherwise require all the limitations of an allowable generic claim as provided by 37 CFR 1.141.

Any inquiry concerning this communication or earlier communications from the examiner should be directed to CHRISTOPHER UHLIR whose telephone number is (571)270-3091. The examiner can normally be reached M-F 8:30-4.

Examiner interviews are available via telephone, in-person, and video conferencing using a USPTO supplied web-based collaboration tool. To schedule an interview, applicant is encouraged to use the USPTO Automated Interview Request (AIR) at http://www.uspto.gov/interviewpractice.

If attempts to reach the examiner by telephone are unsuccessful, the examiner's supervisor, Anita Coupe can be reached at 571-270-3614. The fax phone number for the organization where this application or proceeding is assigned is 571-273-8300.

Information regarding the status of published or unpublished applications may be obtained from Patent Center. Unpublished application information in Patent Center is available to registered users. To file and manage patent submissions in Patent Center, visit: https://patentcenter.uspto.gov. Visit https://www.uspto.gov/patents/apply/patent-center for more information about Patent Center and https://www.uspto.gov/patents/docx for information about filing in DOCX format. For additional questions, contact the Electronic Business Center (EBC) at 866-217-9197

(toll-free). If you would like assistance from a USPTO Customer Service

Representative, call 800-786-9199 (IN USA OR CANADA) or 571-272-1000.

/Christopher Uhlir/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 3619
July 24, 2025

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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01	3414

178888 7590 06/25/2025

Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

EXAMINER	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
06/25/2025	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

sek@toolpat.com

Decision Granting Petition to Make Special Under the First-Time Filer Expedited Examination Pilot Program	**Application No.** 19/075,701	**Applicant(s)** Kamholz, Leah M.	
	Examiner Liana Walsh	**Art Unit** OPET	**AIA (FITF) Status** Yes

1. THE PETITION FILED March 10, 2025 IS **GRANTED**:

   The above-identified application has met the requirements for the First-Time Filer Expedited Examination Pilot Program. The petition fee pursuant to 37 CFR 1.17(h) for the petition to make special filed under 37 CFR 1.102(d) is hereby waived.

2. **The above-identified application is accepted into the First-Time Filer Expedited Examination Pilot Program and will receive special status until a first Office action.**

3. If a reply to a non-final Office action is not fully responsive because it does not comply with the **pilot claim requirements** (that is, the reply contains more than three independent claims, more than twenty total claims, or one or more multiple dependent claims), but it is a *bona fide* attempt to advance the application to final action, the examiner may provide a **shortened statutory period of two (2) months** for applicant to supply a fully responsive reply. Extensions of this time period under 37 CFR 1.136(a) to the notice of nonresponsive amendment will be permitted, but in no case can any extension carry the date for reply to the notice of nonresponsive amendment beyond the **maximum period of SIX MONTHS** set by statute (35 U.S.C. 133). However, any further nonresponsive amendment will be treated as non-*bona fide* and the time period set in the prior notice will continue to run.

Telephone inquiries with regard to this decision should be directed to Liana Walsh at (571)272-3206.

/LIANA S WALSH/

Lead Paralegal Specialist, Office of Petitions

UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
United States Patent and Trademark Office
Address: COMMISSIONER FOR PATENTS
P.O. Box 1450
Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450
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APPLICATION NUMBER	FILING or 371(c) DATE	GRP ART UNIT	FIL FEE REC'D	ATTY.DOCKET.NO	TOT CLAIMS	IND CLAIMS
19/075,701	03/10/2025		434	LMK-001.01	12	1

CONFIRMATION NO. 3414

UPDATED FILING RECEIPT

178888
Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

OC000000086389060

Date Mailed: 03/26/2025

Receipt is acknowledged of this non-provisional utility patent application. The application will be taken up for examination in due course. Applicant will be notified as to the results of the examination. Any correspondence concerning the application must include the following identification information: the U.S. APPLICATION NUMBER, FILING DATE, NAME OF FIRST INVENTOR, and TITLE OF INVENTION. Fees transmitted by check or draft are subject to collection.

Please verify the accuracy of the data presented on this receipt. If an error is noted on this Filing Receipt, please submit a written request for a corrected Filing Receipt, including a properly marked-up ADS showing the changes with strike-through for deletions and underlining for additions. If you received a "Notice to File Missing Parts" or other Notice requiring a response for this application, please submit any request for correction to this Filing Receipt with your reply to the Notice. When the USPTO processes the reply to the Notice, the USPTO will generate another Filing Receipt incorporating the requested corrections provided that the request is grantable.

Inventor(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Applicant(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Power of Attorney: The patent practitioners associated with Customer Number 178888

Domestic Applications for which benefit is claimed - None.
A proper domestic benefit claim must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim for domestic benefit. See 37 CFR 1.76 and 1.78.

Foreign Applications for which priority is claimed (You may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at the USPTO. Please see http://www.uspto.gov for more information.) **- None.**
Foreign application information must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim to foreign priority. See 37 CFR 1.55 and 1.76.

Permission to Access Application via Priority Document Exchange: No

Permission to Access Search Results: No

Applicant may provide or rescind an authorization for access using Form PTO/SB/39 or Form PTO/SB/69 as appropriate.

If Required, Foreign Filing License Granted: 03/17/2025

The country code and number of your priority application, to be used for filing abroad under the Paris Convention, is **US 19/075,701**

Projected Publication Date: Request for Non-Publication Acknowledged

Non-Publication Request: Yes

Early Publication Request: No
**** MICRO ENTITY ****
Title

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Preliminary Class

Statement under 37 CFR 1.55 or 1.78 for AIA (First Inventor to File) Transition Applications: No

PROTECTING YOUR INVENTION OUTSIDE THE UNITED STATES

Since the rights granted by a U.S. patent extend only throughout the territory of the United States and have no effect in a foreign country, an inventor who wishes patent protection in another country must apply for a patent in a specific country or in regional patent offices. Applicants may wish to consider the filing of an international application under the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT). An international (PCT) application generally has the same effect as a regular national patent application in each PCT-member country. The PCT process **simplifies** the filing of patent applications on the same invention in member countries, but **does not result** in a grant of "an international patent" and does not eliminate the need of applicants to file additional documents and fees in countries where patent protection is desired.

Almost every country has its own patent law, and a person desiring a patent in a particular country must make an application for patent in that country in accordance with its particular laws. Since the laws of many countries differ in various respects from the patent law of the United States, applicants are advised to seek guidance from specific foreign countries to ensure that patent rights are not lost prematurely.

Applicants also are advised that in the case of inventions made in the United States, the Director of the USPTO must issue a license before applicants can apply for a patent in a foreign country. The filing of a U.S. patent application serves as a request for a foreign filing license. The application's filing receipt contains further information and guidance as to the status of applicant's license for foreign filing.

Applicants may wish to consult the USPTO booklet, "General Information Concerning Patents" (specifically, the section entitled "Treaties and Foreign Patents") for more information on timeframes and deadlines for filing foreign patent applications. The guide is available either by contacting the USPTO Contact Center at 800-786-9199, or it can be viewed on the USPTO website at http://www.uspto.gov/web/offices/pac/doc/general/index.html.

For information on preventing theft of your intellectual property (patents, trademarks and copyrights), you may wish to consult the U.S. Government website, http://www.stopfakes.gov. Part of a Department of Commerce initiative, this website includes self-help "toolkits" giving innovators guidance on how to protect intellectual property in specific countries such as China, Korea and Mexico. For questions regarding patent enforcement issues, applicants may call the U.S. Government hotline at 1-866-999-HALT (1-866-999-4258).

LICENSE FOR FOREIGN FILING UNDER

Title 35, United States Code, Section 184

Title 37, Code of Federal Regulations, 5.11 & 5.15

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This license is to be retained by the licensee and may be used at any time on or after the effective date thereof unless it is revoked. This license is automatically transferred to any related applications(s) filed under 37 CFR 1.53(d). This license is not retroactive.

The grant of a license does not in any way lessen the responsibility of a licensee for the security of the subject matter as imposed by any Government contract or the provisions of existing laws relating to espionage and the national security or the export of technical data. Licensees should apprise themselves of current regulations especially with respect to certain countries, of other agencies, particularly the Office of Defense Trade Controls, Department of State (with respect to Arms, Munitions and Implements of War (22 CFR 121-128)); the Bureau of Industry and Security, Department of Commerce (15 CFR parts 730-774); the Office of Foreign AssetsControl, Department of Treasury (31 CFR Parts 500+) and the Department of Energy.

NOT GRANTED

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PATENT APPLICATION FEE DETERMINATION RECORD

Substitute for Form PTO-875

Application or Docket Number: 19/075,701

APPLICATION AS FILED - PART I

FOR	(Column 1) NUMBER FILED	(Column 2) NUMBER EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY FEE($)
BASIC FEE (37 CFR 1.16(a), (b), or (c))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	70
SEARCH FEE (37 CFR 1.16(k), (i), or (m))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	154
EXAMINATION FEE (37 CFR 1.16(o), (p), or (q))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	176
TOTAL CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(i))	12 minus 20 =	* 0			OR	x =	0
INDEPENDENT CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(h))	1 minus 3 =	*				x =	0
APPLICATION SIZE FEE (37 CFR 1.16(s))	If the specification and drawings exceed 100 sheets of paper, the application size fee due is $310 ($155 for small entity) for each additional 50 sheets or fraction thereof. See 35 U.S.C. 41(a)(1)(G) and 37 CFR 1.16(s).						0
MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM PRESENT (37 CFR 1.16(j))							0
* If the difference in column 1 is less than zero, enter "0" in column 2.			TOTAL			TOTAL	400

APPLICATION AS AMENDED - PART II

		(Column 1) CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		(Column 2) HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	(Column 3) PRESENT EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)
AMENDMENT A	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))									
	FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							OR		
						TOTAL ADD'L FEE		OR	TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

		(Column 1) CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		(Column 2) HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	(Column 3) PRESENT EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)
AMENDMENT B	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))									
	FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							OR		
						TOTAL ADD'L FEE		OR	TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

* If the entry in column 1 is less than the entry in column 2, write "0" in column 3.

** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 20, enter "20".

*** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 3, enter "3".

The "Highest Number Previously Paid For" (Total or Independent) is the highest found in the appropriate box in column 1.

IN THE UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

Application No.: 19/075,701 Filing Date: March 10, 2025 Inventor: Kamholz, Leah M. Title: *Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters*	Confirmation No.: 3414 Customer No.: 178888 Certificate of Electronic Transmission I hereby certify that this correspondence is being transmitted via the USPTO electronic filing system on 2025-03-19. By: /Scott E. Kamholz/ Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

RESPONSE TO NOTICE TO FILE MISSING PARTS

To the Commissioner for Patents:

In response to the Notice to File Missing Parts mailed 2025-03-19, Applicant pays the basic filing fee and surcharge.

Respectfully submitted,

Date: 2025-03-19

By: /Scott E. Kamholz/
Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543

UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
United States Patent and Trademark Office
Address: COMMISSIONER FOR PATENTS
P.O. Box 1450
Alexandria, Virginia 22313-1450
www.uspto.gov

APPLICATION NUMBER	FILING OR 371(C) DATE	FIRST NAMED APPLICANT	ATTY. DOCKET NO./TITLE
19/075,701	03/10/2025	Leah M. Kamholz	LMK-001.01

CONFIRMATION NO. 3414

178888
Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

FORMALITIES LETTER

OC000000085974353

Date Mailed: 03/19/2025

NOTICE TO FILE MISSING PARTS OF NONPROVISIONAL APPLICATION

FILED UNDER 37 CFR 1.53(b)

Filing Date Granted

An application number and filing date have been accorded to the above-identified nonprovisional application. The item(s) indicated below, however, are missing. Applicant is given **TWO MONTHS** from the date of this Notice within which to file all required items below to avoid abandonment. Extensions of time may be obtained by filing a petition accompanied by the extension fee under the provisions of 37 CFR 1.136(a).

- The statutory basic filing fee has not been received.
- Surcharge as set forth in 37 CFR 1.16(f) has not been received.

  The surcharge is due for any one of:
  - late submission of the basic filing fee, search fee, or examination fee,
  - late submission of inventor's oath or declaration,
  - filing an application that does not contain at least one claim on filing, or
  - submission of an application filed by reference to a previously filed application.

SUMMARY OF FEES DUE:

The fee(s) required (including the fees noted above) are as follows. Micro entity discount is in effect.

- $**70** basic filing fee.
- $**34** surcharge.
- $(**0**) previous unapplied payment amount.
- $**104** TOTAL FEE BALANCE DUE.

Replies must be received in the USPTO within the set time period or must include a proper Certificate of Mailing or Transmission under 37 CFR 1.8 with a mailing or transmission date within the set time period. For more information and a suggested format, see Form PTO/SB/92 and MPEP 512.

Replies should be addressed to:

Mail Stop Missing Parts
Commissioner for Patents
P.O. Box 1450
Alexandria VA 22313-1450

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A reply may be submitted via electronic filing only by registered users of the appropriate USPTO patent electronic filing system and must include:

- A separate document having the document description, "**Applicant response to Pre-Exam Formalities Notice**"; and
- the item(s) for which a reply period is set forth above.

For more information about electronic filing, contact the Patent Electronic Business Center (EBC) 1-866-217-9197 or visit https://www.uspto.gov/ebc

NOTE: If the reply is not being submitted electronically, a copy of this notice must be included.

Questions about the contents of this notice and the requirements it sets forth should be directed to the Office of Data Management, Application Assistance Unit, at **(571) 272-4000** or **(571) 272-4200** or **1-888-786-0101**.

/hnguyen/

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APPLICATION NUMBER	FILING or 371(c) DATE	GRP ART UNIT	FIL FEE REC'D	ATTY.DOCKET.NO	TOT CLAIMS	IND CLAIMS
19/075,701	03/10/2025		330	LMK-001.01	12	1

CONFIRMATION NO. 3414

178888
Scott E. Kamholz, PLLC
3600 N. Potomac St.
Arlington, VA 22213

FILING RECEIPT

OC00000085974351

Date Mailed: 03/19/2025

Receipt is acknowledged of this non-provisional utility patent application. The application will be taken up for examination in due course. Applicant will be notified as to the results of the examination. Any correspondence concerning the application must include the following identification information: the U.S. APPLICATION NUMBER, FILING DATE, NAME OF FIRST INVENTOR, and TITLE OF INVENTION. Fees transmitted by check or draft are subject to collection.

Please verify the accuracy of the data presented on this receipt. If an error is noted on this Filing Receipt, please submit a written request for a corrected Filing Receipt, including a properly marked-up ADS showing the changes with strike-through for deletions and underlining for additions. If you received a "Notice to File Missing Parts" or other Notice requiring a response for this application, please submit any request for correction to this Filing Receipt with your reply to the Notice. When the USPTO processes the reply to the Notice, the USPTO will generate another Filing Receipt incorporating the requested corrections provided that the request is grantable.

Inventor(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Applicant(s)

Leah M. Kamholz, Arlington, VA;

Power of Attorney: The patent practitioners associated with Customer Number 178888

Domestic Applications for which benefit is claimed - None.
A proper domestic benefit claim must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim for domestic benefit. See 37 CFR 1.76 and 1.78.

Foreign Applications for which priority is claimed (You may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at the USPTO. Please see http://www.uspto.gov for more information.) **- None.**
Foreign application information must be provided in an Application Data Sheet in order to constitute a claim to foreign priority. See 37 CFR 1.55 and 1.76.

Permission to Access Application via Priority Document Exchange: No

Permission to Access Search Results: No

Applicant may provide or rescind an authorization for access using Form PTO/SB/39 or Form PTO/SB/69 as appropriate.

If Required, Foreign Filing License Granted: 03/17/2025

The country code and number of your priority application, to be used for filing abroad under the Paris Convention, is **US 19/075,701**

Projected Publication Date: Request for Non-Publication Acknowledged

Non-Publication Request: Yes

Early Publication Request: No
**** MICRO ENTITY ****
Title

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Preliminary Class

Statement under 37 CFR 1.55 or 1.78 for AIA (First Inventor to File) Transition Applications: No

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LICENSE FOR FOREIGN FILING UNDER

Title 35, United States Code, Section 184

Title 37, Code of Federal Regulations, 5.11 & 5.15

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NOT GRANTED

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Alexandria, VA 22313 - 1450
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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**03/19/2025 10:41:26 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	69643138	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 1

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
Response to NTFMP.pdf	1	Applicant Response to Pre-Exam Formalities Notice	113 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
Response to NTFMP.pdf	61A0894D2083F18B45BA85B43BE9F47DC19DBBC092EB28B2 579AB59F8A317A23EAD38CA4F4DF89DFB48BF7F86C7D2D7B BD6745168D4D44BEAF84F386F4CE4AB3

This Acknowledgement Receipt evidences receipt on the noted date by the USPTO of the indicated documents, characterized by the applicant, and including page counts, where applicable. It serves as evidence of receipt similar to a Post Card, as described in MPEP 503.

New Applications Under 35 U.S.C. 111

If a new application is being filed and the application includes the necessary components for filing date (see 37 CFR 1.53(b)-(d) and MPEP 506), a Filing Receipt (37 CFR 1.54) will be issued in due course and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the filing date of the application

National Stage of an International Application under 35 U.S.C. 371

If a timely submission to enter the national stage of an international application is compliant with the conditions of 35 U.S.C. 371 and other applicable requirements a Form PCT/DO/EO/903 indicating acceptance of the application as a national stage submission under 35 U.S.C. 371 will be issued in addition to the Filing Receipt, in due course.

New International Application Filed with the USPTO as a Receiving Office

If a new international application is being filed and the international application includes the necessary components for an international filing date (see PCT Article 11 and MPEP 1810), a Notification of the International Application Number and of the International Filing Date (Form PCT/RO/105) will be issued in due course, subject to prescriptions concerning national security, and the date shown on this Acknowledgement Receipt will establish the international filing date of the application.

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PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

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ELECTRONIC PAYMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**03/19/2025 10:41:26 AM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	69643138	AUTHORIZED BY	-
CUSTOMER #	178888	FILING DATE	03/10/2025
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz

Payment Information

PAYMENT METHOD	PAYMENT TRANSACTION ID	PAYMENT AUTHORIZED BY
CARD / 6274	**E20253IA43037905**	**SCOTT KAMHOLZ**

FEE CODE	DESCRIPTION	ITEM PRICE($)	QUANTITY	ITEM TOTAL($)
3011	BASIC FILING FEE - UTILITY (PAPER FILING ALSO REQUIRES NON-ELECTRONIC FILING FEE UNDER 1.16(T))	70.00	1	70.00
3051	SURCHARGE- LATE FILING FEE, SEARCH FEE, EXAMINATION FEE, INVENTOR'S OATH OR DECLARATION, OR APPLICATION FILED WITHOUT AT LEAST ONE CLAIM OR BY REFERENCE	34.00	1	34.00
			TOTAL AMOUNT:	**$104.00**

This Acknowledgement Receipt evidences receipt on the noted date by the USPTO of the indicated documents, characterized by the applicant, and including page counts, where applicable. It serves as evidence of receipt similar to a Post Card, as described in MPEP 503.

New Applications Under 35 U.S.C. 111

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National Stage of an International Application under 35 U.S.C. 371

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PATENT APPLICATION FEE DETERMINATION RECORD

Substitute for Form PTO-875

Application or Docket Number: 19/075,701

APPLICATION AS FILED - PART I

FOR	(Column 1) NUMBER FILED	(Column 2) NUMBER EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY FEE($)
BASIC FEE (37 CFR 1.16(a), (b), or (c))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	70
SEARCH FEE (37 CFR 1.16(k), (i), or (m))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	154
EXAMINATION FEE (37 CFR 1.16(o), (p), or (q))	N/A	N/A	N/A			N/A	176
TOTAL CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(i))	12 minus 20 =	* 0			OR	x =	0
INDEPENDENT CLAIMS (37 CFR 1.16(h))	1 minus 3 =	*				x =	0
APPLICATION SIZE FEE (37 CFR 1.16(s))	If the specification and drawings exceed 100 sheets of paper, the application size fee due is $310 ($155 for small entity) for each additional 50 sheets or fraction thereof. See 35 U.S.C. 41(a)(1)(G) and 37 CFR 1.16(s).						0
MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM PRESENT (37 CFR 1.16(j))							0
* If the difference in column 1 is less than zero, enter "0" in column 2.			TOTAL			TOTAL	400

APPLICATION AS AMENDED - PART II

		(Column 1) CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		(Column 2) HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	(Column 3) PRESENT EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)
AMENDMENT A	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))									
	FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							OR		
						TOTAL ADD'L FEE		OR	TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

		(Column 1) CLAIMS REMAINING AFTER AMENDMENT		(Column 2) HIGHEST NUMBER PREVIOUSLY PAID FOR	(Column 3) PRESENT EXTRA	SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)	OR	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY RATE($)	OTHER THAN SMALL ENTITY ADDITIONAL FEE($)
AMENDMENT B	Total (37 CFR 1.16(i))	*	Minus	**	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Independent (37 CFR 1.16(h))	*	Minus	***	=	x =		OR	x =	
	Application Size Fee (37 CFR 1.16(s))									
	FIRST PRESENTATION OF MULTIPLE DEPENDENT CLAIM (37 CFR 1.16(j))							OR		
						TOTAL ADD'L FEE		OR	TOTAL ADD'L FEE	

* If the entry in column 1 is less than the entry in column 2, write "0" in column 3.

** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 20, enter "20".

*** If the "Highest Number Previously Paid For" IN THIS SPACE is less than 3, enter "3".

The "Highest Number Previously Paid For" (Total or Independent) is the highest found in the appropriate box in column 1.

Application Data Sheet 37 CFR 1.76

The Application Data Sheet is part of the provisional or non-provisional application for which it is being submitted. The following form contains the bibliographic data arranged in a format specified by the United States Patent and Trademark Office as outlined in 37 CFR 1.76.

Inventor Information

of inventors: 1

1. **Leah M. Kamholz**

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UNITED STATES

Application Information

Customer number	**178888 -**
Correspondence address	---
Title of invention	**Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters**
Attorney docket number	**LMK-001.01**
Entity status	Small

Application type	Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)
Subject matter	Utility
Total number of drawing sheets	---
Suggested figure for publication	---
Filing by reference	No
Publication request	**REQUEST NOT TO PUBLISH** under 35 U.S.C. 122(b)

I hereby request that the attached application not be published under 35 U.S.C. 122(b) and certify that the invention disclosed in the attached application has not and will not be the subject of an application filed in another country, or under a multilateral international agreement, that requires publication at eighteen months after filing.

Representative Information

of representatives: 1

Representative information should be provided for all practitioners having a power of attorney in the application. Providing this information in the Application Data Sheet does not constitute a power of attorney in the application (see 37 CFR 1.32).

Customer number 178888

Domestic Benefit/National Stage Information

of benefit claims: 0

This section allows for the applicant to either claim benefit under 35 U.S.C. 119(e), 120, 121, or 365(c), 386(c), or indicate National Stage entry from a PCT application. Providing benefit claim information in the Application Data Sheet constitutes the specific reference required by 35 U.S.C. 119(e) or 120, and 37 CFR 1.78(a)(2) or CFR 1.78(a)(4), and need not otherwise be made part of the specification.

Data was not provided for this section.

Foreign Priority Information

of foreign priority claims: 0

This section allows for the applicant to claim benefit of foreign priority and to identify any prior foreign application for which priority is not claimed. Providing this information in the Application Data Sheet constitutes the claim for priority as required by 35 U.S.C. 119 (b) and 37 CFR 1.55. When priority is claimed to a foreign application that is eligible for retrieval under the priority document exchange program (PDX) the information will be used by the Office to automatically attempt retrieval pursuant to 37 CFR 1.55(i)(1) and (2). Under the PDX program, applicant bears the ultimate responsibility for ensuring that a copy of the foreign application is received by the Office from the participating foreign intellectual property office, or a certified copy of the foreign priority application is filed, within the time period specified in 37 CFR 1.55(g)(1).

Data was not provided for this section.

Statement under 37 CFR 1.55 or 1.78 for AIA (First Inventor to File) Transition Applications

Checking this box will cause the application to be examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

☐ This application (1) claims priority to or the benefit of an application filed before March 16, 2013 and (2) also contains, or contained at any time, a claim to a claimed invention that has an effective filing date on or after March 16, 2013. NOTE: By providing this statement under 37 CFR 1.55 or 1.78, this application, with a filing date on or after March 2016, 2013, will be examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

Authorization or Opt-Out of Authorization to Permit Access

When this Application Data Sheet is properly signed and filled with the application, applicant has provided written authority to permit a participating foreign intellectual property (IP) office access to the instant application-as-filed (see paragraph A in subsection 1 below) and the European Patent Office (EPO) access to any search results from the instant application (see paragraph B in subsection 1 below).

Should applicant choose not to provide an authorization identified in subsection 1 below, applicant **must opt-out** of the authorization by checking the corresponding box A or B or both in subsection 2 below.

NOTE:
This section of the Application Data Sheet is **ONLY** reviewed and processed with the **INITIAL** filing of an application. After the initial filing of an application, an Application Data Sheet cannot be used to provide or rescind authorization for access by a foreign IP office(s). Instead, Form PTO/SB/39 or PTO/SB/69 must be used as appropriate.

1. Authorization to Permit Access by a Foreign Intellectual Property Office(s)

A.

Priority Document Exchange (PDX)

Unless box A in subsection 2 (opt-out of authorization) is checked, the undersigned hereby **grants the USPTO authority** to provide the European Patent Office (EPO), the Japan Patent Office (JPO), the Korean Intellectual Property Office (KIPO), the China National Intellectual Property Administration (CNIPA), the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), and any other foreign intellectual property office participating with the USPTO in a bilateral or multilateral priority document exchange agreement in which a foreign application claiming priority to the instant patent application is filed, access to: (1) the instant patent application-as-filed and its related bibliographic data, (2) any foreign or domestic application to which priority or benefit is claimed by the instant application and its related bibliographic data, and (3) the date of filing of this Authorization. See 37 CFR 1.14(h) (1).

Search Results from U.S. Application to EPO

B. Unless box B in subsection 2 (opt-out of authorization) is checked, the undersigned hereby **grants the USPTO authority** to provide the EPO access to the bibliographic data and search results from the instant patent application when a European patent application claiming priority to the instant patent application is filed. See 37 CFR 1.14(h)(2).

The applicant is reminded that the EPO's Rule 141(1) EPC (European Patent Convention) requires applicants to submit a copy of search results from the instant application without delay in a European patent application that claims priority to the instant application.

2. Opt-Out of Authorizations to Permit Access by a Foreign Intellectual Property Office(s)

☑ A. Applicant **DOES NOT** authorize the USPTO to permit a participating foreign IP office access to the instant application-as-filed. If this box is checked, the USPTO will not be providing a participating foreign IP office with any documents and information identified in subsection 1A above.

☑ B. Applicant **DOES NOT** authorize the USPTO to transmit to the EPO any search results from the instant patent application. If this box is checked, the USPTO will not be providing the EPO with the search results from the instant application.

NOTE:

Once the application has published or is otherwise publicly available, the USPTO may provide access to the application in accordance with 37 CFR 1.14.

Applicant Information

of applicants: 0

The information to be provided in this section is the name and address of the legal representative who is the applicant under 37 CFR 1.43; or the name and address of the assignee, person to whom the inventor is under an obligation to assign the invention, or person who otherwise shows sufficient proprietary interest in the matter who is the applicant under 37 CFR 1.46.

Data was not provided for this section.

Assignee Information including Non-Applicant Assignee Information

of assignees: 0

An assignee-applicant identified in the "Applicant" section will appear on the patent application as an applicant.

Providing assignment information in this section does not substitute for compliance with any requirement of part 3 of Title 37 of CFR to have an assignment recorded by the Office.

Data was not provided for this section.

Signature

NOTE:

This Application Data Sheet must be signed in accordance with 37 CFR 1.33(b). **However, if this Application Data Sheet is submitted with the INITIAL filing of the application and either box A or B is not checked in subsection 2 of the "Authorization or Opt-Out of Authorization to Permit Access" section, then this form must also be signed in accordance with 37 CFR 1.14(c)**

This Application Data Sheet **must** be signed by a patent practitioner if one or more of the applicants is a **juristic entity** (e.g., corporation or association). If the applicant is two or more joint inventors, this form must be signed by a patent practitioner, **all** joint inventors who are the applicant, or one or more joint inventor-applicants who have been given power of attorney (e.g., see USPTO Form PTO/AIA/81) on behalf of **all** joint inventor-applicants.

See CFR 1.4(d) for the manner of making signatures and certifications.

Signature	First name	Last name	Registration #	Date
/Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543/	SCOTT	KAMHOLZ	48543	03/10/2025

CLARINET TONE HOLE RING ADAPTERS

BACKGROUND

[0001] Modern clarinets typically are built with a system of keys, rings, posts, shafts, levers, and springs, called the "Boehm" or "modified Boehm" system. Various components of this system are actuated by the player to control which holes in the instrument are opened or closed, thereby altering the effective length or resonance characteristics of the instrument in order to change the pitch produced.

[0002] The modern B-flat soprano clarinet has seven holes, called "tone holes," which are opened or closed directly by the player's fingers sealing them. In most clarinets, above six of these holes are positioned "rings," which are mounted on shafts running longitudinally and swing between an open position above the tone holes and a closed position resting on the tone holes. The shaft is typically biased by a spring to keep the rings in the open position unless the player exerts enough force on one or more rings to depress it to the closed position. Also attached to the shaft are one or more keys that close holes on the clarinet other than tone holes. The rings thus cause those keys to close when any of the rings attached to the same shaft are closed, thus simplifying the fingering procedure. The ring itself does not obstruct airflow through its respective tone hole.

[0003] The tone holes underlying rings are typically formed with a raised central turret, the top surface of which is sealed by the player's finger pad, and a recess surrounding the turret to receive the ring in the closed position such that the top of the ring is flush or near-flush with the top surface of the turret.

[0004] The tone holes on a modern B-flat soprano clarinet typically vary in diameter along the instrument, with the tone holes in the upper section progressing from about 4.5 mm to about 6.5 mm and the tone holes in the lower section progressing from about 7 mm to about 10 mm downward along the section. In standard operation, a player presses a finger pad fully down on a tone hole to form an air-tight seal in order to produce a clear tone (for certain advanced techniques such as glissando a player may cover a hole only partially).

[0005] A problem may arise, however, if a player's fingers are too small to cover the hole fully, or a player's fingers lack full mobility such as due to arthritis, trauma, or neurological impairment. In such cases, a player may find it difficult or impossible to form an airtight seal, particularly on the lower tone holes, and especially the lowest or largest tone hole. Players with small fingers, such as young children in the early stages of clarinet playing, can find it essentially impossible to close the lower tone holes. Players desiring to wear gloves while playing, such as participants in an outdoor performance, may similarly find it impossible to achieve air-tight seals on the tone holes due to the intervening fabric.

[0006] One solution to the problem of tone hole air leaks is to replace the rings with filled-in keys, sometimes called "plateau" keys. Plateau keys fully cover the tone holes regardless of whether the player contacts the entire key surface with a finger, as long as the player presses hard enough. Plateau keys can cause a muffled or distorted sound, however, because they impede airflow out the tone hole when it is uncovered. Plateau clarinets also require considerably more keywork to ensure proper functioning of the clarinet, because plateau keys moving simultaneously into the closed position on a single shaft would make it difficult or impossible for the player to achieve the wide variety of fingerings required to play the range of notes on the clarinet. The revised keywork on a plateau clarinet essentially allows each plateau key to close the non-tone-hole keys without also closing the other plateau keys. Even on more modern plateau clarinets that minimize sound muffling, the additional keywork adds weight to the instrument and increases the maintenance burden.

[0007] A solution for a related problem on the flute is the use of hole plugs. Flutes for beginner students are typically made with plateau keys, but flutes for more advanced players and professionals may have key holes. The holes may be fitted with plugs to make an advanced flute easier for a beginner to play. The turret on flute tone holes typically does not extend to the height of the keys, so the plugs do not interfere with the turrets. Such plugs would not work on a clarinet ring, however, because the turret would displace the plug when the ring moves to the closed position.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. 1 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section of a clarinet tone hole and ring in an open position.

[0009] FIG. 2 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section of a clarinet tone hole and ring in a closed position.

[0010] FIG. 3 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section of a clarinet tone hole and ring in which the ring is pressed into the closed position by a finger too small to form an air-tight seal.

[0011] FIG. 4 schematically shows a tone hole ring adapter.

[0012] FIG. 5 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section of a clarinet tone hole and ring in which a tone hole ring adapter has been fitted to the ring, and the ring is pressed into the closed position by the too-small finger which can now form an air-tight seal.

[0013] FIG. 6 is a schematic perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which a tone hole ring adapter has been fitted to a tone hole ring.

[0014] FIG. 7 is a schematic perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which a tone hole ring adapter in the form of a slipcover has been fitted to a tone hole ring.

[0015] FIG. 8 is a schematic perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which a tone hole ring adapter in the form of a stemmed slipcover has been fitted to a tone hole ring.

[0016] FIG. 9 is a schematic perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which a tone hole ring adapter in the form of a disk has been fitted placed on a tone hole ring.

[0017] FIG. 10 is a schematic cross-sectional view of an adapter having a peripheral clip.

[0018] FIG. 11 is a schematic top view of an adapter having two peripheral clips.

[0019] FIG. 12 is a photograph of a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings.

[0020] FIG. 13 is a photograph of a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings with a player's hands in position pressing each of the rings to its closed position.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0021] FIG. 1 schematically shows a median longitudinal cross-section (i.e., taken along a plane cutting front-to-back through the middle of a clarinet) of clarinet tone hole **10** and tone hole ring **20**. Tone hole ring **20** is depicted in the open position, in which it lies above the tone hole and typically does not contact it. Ring **20** extends from a ring arm **22** which is mounted on shaft **24**. Ring arm **22** is typically biased to its open position by a biaser such as a spring (not shown). Shaft **24** is secured to the clarinet body by one or most posts (not shown) that allow shaft **24** and ring arms attached to it to pivot on the shaft long axis. Tone hole **10** is formed in clarinet body **1** and communicates with clarinet main bore **2** by tone hole bore **12**. Tone hole bore **12** is defined by circumferential bore wall **13**, which extends above the surface of clarinet main body **1** to circumferential turret **14** having top surface **15**. Ring sink **16** surrounds bore wall **13** and forms a sunken area relative to the surface of clarinet body **1**. Tone hole rings typically have inner diameters of about 8 mm to about 13 mm, with the smaller rings toward the top of the clarinet and larger rings toward the bottom. The rings are typically about 1 mm in width, giving outer diameters of about 10 mm to about 15 mm. Adapters may be sized and shaped to accommodate these dimensions.

[0022] FIG. 2 schematically shows the same view as **FIG. 1** but with tone hole ring **20** in a closed position. In the closed position, top surface **21** of tone hole ring **20** is flush or is approximately flush with top surface **15** of tone hole **20** turret **14**. Ring sink **16** provides clearance for tone hole ring **20** to reach its closed position without contacting clarinet body **1**. Tone hole ring **20** thus extends at least partly into ring sink **16** when in the closed position.

[0023] FIG. 3 schematically shows the same view as **FIG. 2** of tone hole ring **20** in the closed position and further shows finger **30** depressing tone hole ring **20** into the closed position. Finger **30** (shown schematically in cross section) is too small, however, to achieve an air-tight seal of tone hole **10** and leaves one or more gaps, for example gap **32** and/or gap **34**, thereby allowing air to escape through tone hole **10** and preventing the clarinet from sounding the intended pitch.

[0024] FIG. 4 schematically depicts tone hole ring adapter **40** deployed on tone hole ring **20**. In the schematically-depicted embodiment, adapter **40** includes elastomer tube **42**. Tube **42**

includes first end **41** and second end **43**. First end **41** is open, and second end **43** may be open or closed. Elastomer tube **42** may be, for example, the stem portion of a latex balloon, with thickened lip **44** from the balloon forming first end **41** and second end **43** being a cut surface of the balloon. Inclusion of lip **44** or other thickening at first end **41** may help keep adapter **40** in position on tone ring **20** by providing physical obstruction or other resistance to tube **40** slippage. Aperture **45** may be formed in the sidewalls of tube **42** to provide a transverse path for airflow across tube **42**. In the case of tube **42** being cut from a balloon stem, aperture **45** may be formed by, for example, pricking or hole-punching the stem. Although shown here loosely surrounding tone hole ring **20**, adapted **40** may fit snugly, or it may be stretched to fit around tone hole ring **20**.

[0025] FIG. **5** shows the same view as **FIG. 3** but with ring adapter **40** deployed on tone hole ring **20**. Finger **30** is depressing tube **42** of adapter **40**, thereby stretching it into tone hole **10** and pressing it into inner edges of top surface **15** . The gaps allowing airflow around finger **30** are thereby obliterated (schematically depicted as **32**´ and **34**´). Adapter **40** thereby assists finger **30** in sealing tone hole **10** and allowing the clarinet to sound the intended pitch. When finger **30** is lifted (not shown), tone hole ring **20** returns to the open position and lifts adapter **40** out of contact with tone hole **10**, thereby restoring the possibility of airflow through tone hole **10**.

[0026] FIG. 6 is a perspective view of a portion of a clarinet in which tone hole ring adapter **40** has been fitted to tone hole ring **20**. Tone hole ring **20** is in the open position. Adapter **40** includes aperture **45** in its top surface; a similar aperture **45** is provided on the bottom surface of tube **40** (not shown). Clarinet body **1**, tone hole top surface **15**, tone hole ring arm **22**, and shaft **24** are shown for context with the other drawings.

[0027] A tone hole ring adapter may serve as a substitute for, or approximation of, a plateau key, in the sense of providing a way to close ringed tone holes with an air-tight seal when the player is otherwise unable to do so. An adapter may be removeable or otherwise temporary. An adapter may define apertures in its surfaces separating a player's finger from the tone hole in order to provide a path for air to escape the tone hole across the adapter when a finger is not pressing on the corresponding tone hole ring. The adapter may include a peripheral region

sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with a clarinet tone hole ring about the ring's entire circumference. The peripheral region may define a central void (that is, an aperture).

[0028] A variety shapes, sizes, and configurations are suitable for a tone hole ring adapter. As described above, an adapter may be formed from a sleeve or tube of elastic material. As shown in **FIG. 7**, an adapter may be formed as a slipcover with top and bottom layers and side passage **46** through which the tone hole ring **20** is passed, so that the slipcover encases the tone hole ring. As shown in **FIG. 8**, a slipcover aperture may include stem **47**. A slipcover-style adapter should be made of an especially thin, flexible, and/or elastic material, at least on the bottom layer to accommodate the tone hole turret in order to allow the tone hole ring to reach the closed position essentially without obstruction. The adapter could be applied directly to the top surface **15** of turret **14**, typically in the form of a single layer with adhesive on the underside.

[0029] As shown in **FIG. 9**, an adapter may be a flat (or essentially flat) disk **48** placed on top of tone hole ring **20**. Disk **48** may be circular, oval, or elliptical. It may also be polygonal (though still may be referred to figuratively as a "disk"). The underside of disk **48** may include an adhesive material or a deformable material, such as glue, wax, or putty, to affix the disk to ring **20** with an airtight seal. Disk **48** may be rigid or semirigid, or may have a rigid or semirigid component together with a flexible component. For example, disk **48** may have rigid top component made of plastic or metal and a bottom component made of cork, felt, or other material typically used in clarinet key pads. The bottom component may be a bladder typically used in clarinet key pads. An adapter can include a top piece with only an annulus of adhesive provided on the underside surface that corresponds to the tone hole ring, so that there is no adhesive on the underside that is exposed to the turret. An adapter can include a top piece with adhesive provided on the underside, and a second piece of material covering the portion of the adhesive corresponding to the inner diameter of the tone hole ring (that is, the turret location), similarly to prevent unwanted sticking to the turret. The second piece would have an aperture if there is an aperture in the top piece.

[0030] As shown in **FIG. 10**, disk **48** may include side clip **49** that clips around ring **20**. Side clip **49** may extend circumferentially around disk **48** or may be formed by a series of clips

distributed around the circumference, such as two clips as shown in **FIG. 11**. Clips may be lined with rubber or another material to improve grip on ring **20** and/or help create an airtight seal. Disk **48** may be made of flexible materials, such as plastic, paper, electrical tape, or other adhesive tape. In one embodiment, an adapter can be formed from two piece of opposing adhesive tape between which a tone hole ring is sandwiched. In another embodiment, an adapter may include an annular ring of paper or cardboard (resembling a binder paper hole reinforcement). Adapters, regardless of the particular form, can include a transverse passage through the adapter, represented in the drawings by aperture **45**, to allow airflow from the tone hole when a finger is not pressing the tone hole ring. An adapter with more than one layer, such as an upper layer positioned on the upper side of the tone hole ring and a lower layer positioned on the bottom side of the tone hole ring, may have apertures that are in register with one another, that is, aligned with one another, to define the transverse passage.

[0031] FIG. 12 is a photograph of a clarinet with tone hole ring adapters fitted to the five visible tone hole rings. Each adapter was cut from a piece of electrical tape and placed on the top surface of each tone hole ring with its adhesive surface contacting the ring. A hole was cut in the center of each piece of electrical tape to serve as an aperture. **FIG. 13** is a photograph of the same clarinet shown in **FIG. 12** with a player's hands positioned on the clarinet and holding all visible tone hole rings in their closed positions.

[0032] A wide variety of materials, shapes, sizes, and properties are suitable for a tone hole ring adapter. An adapter could be made from thin latex or another elastomer. An adapter could be made of a deformable plastic, such as plastic wrap made from polyethylene, low-density polyethylene, polyvinyl chloride, or polyvinylidene chloride. In the case of plastic wrap, the wrap could simply be folded over the tone hole ring and pressed together. Other materials include fabric and felt. Such materials should be airtight or treated to be airtight, such as being impregnated with wax or plastic or coated with a sealant. the tip of a glove made from think latex or another thin elastomer. An adapter could be made from a piece of plastic wrap, such as is used for food storage, folded over the tone hole ring.

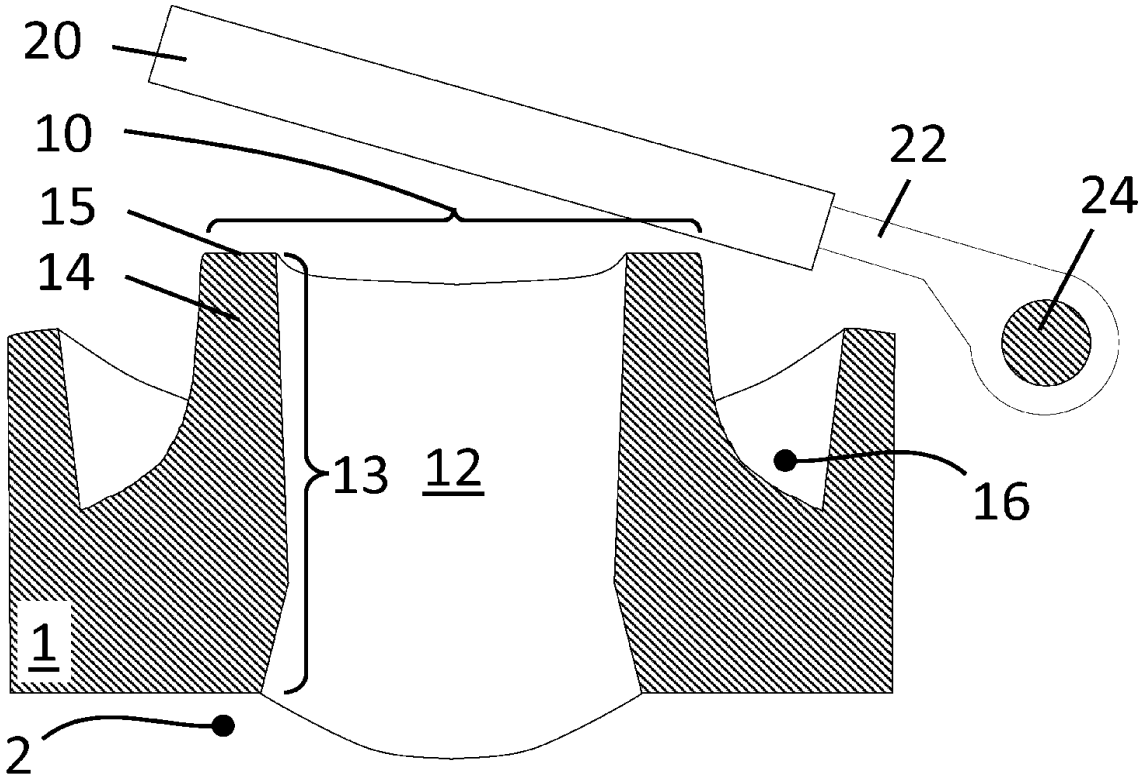


FIG. 1

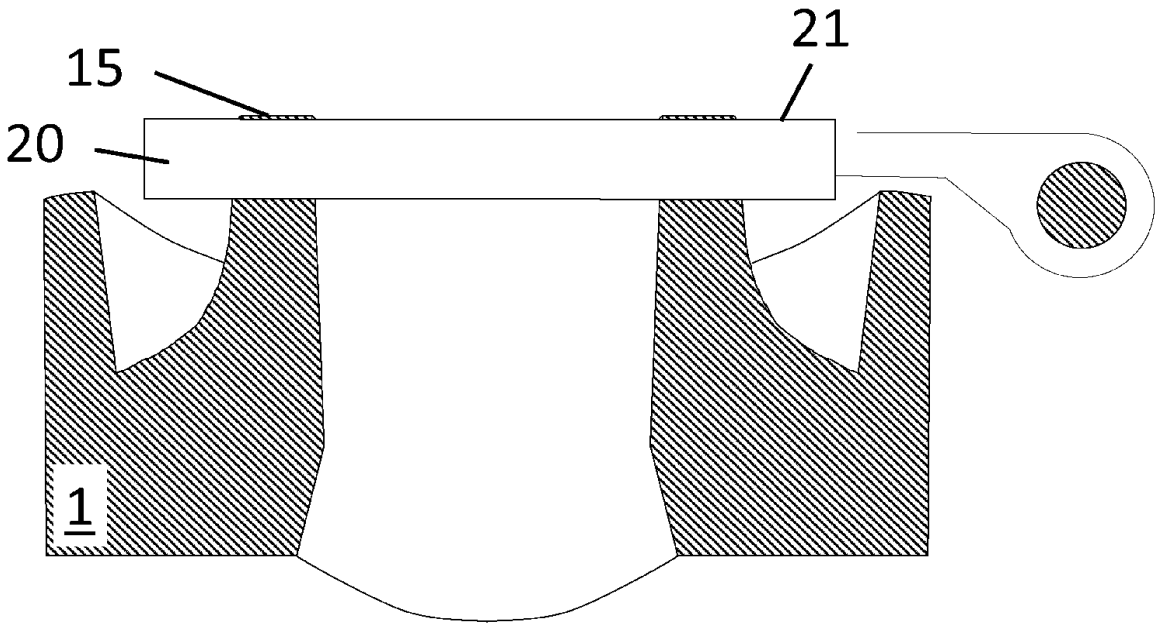


FIG. 2

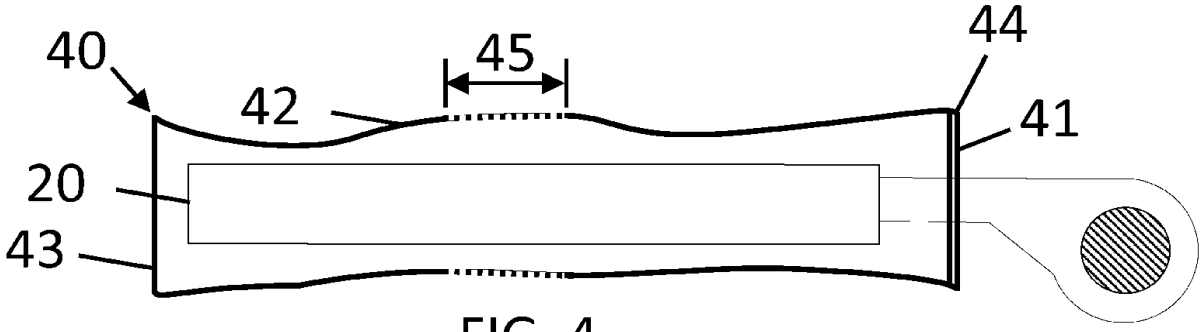


FIG. 4

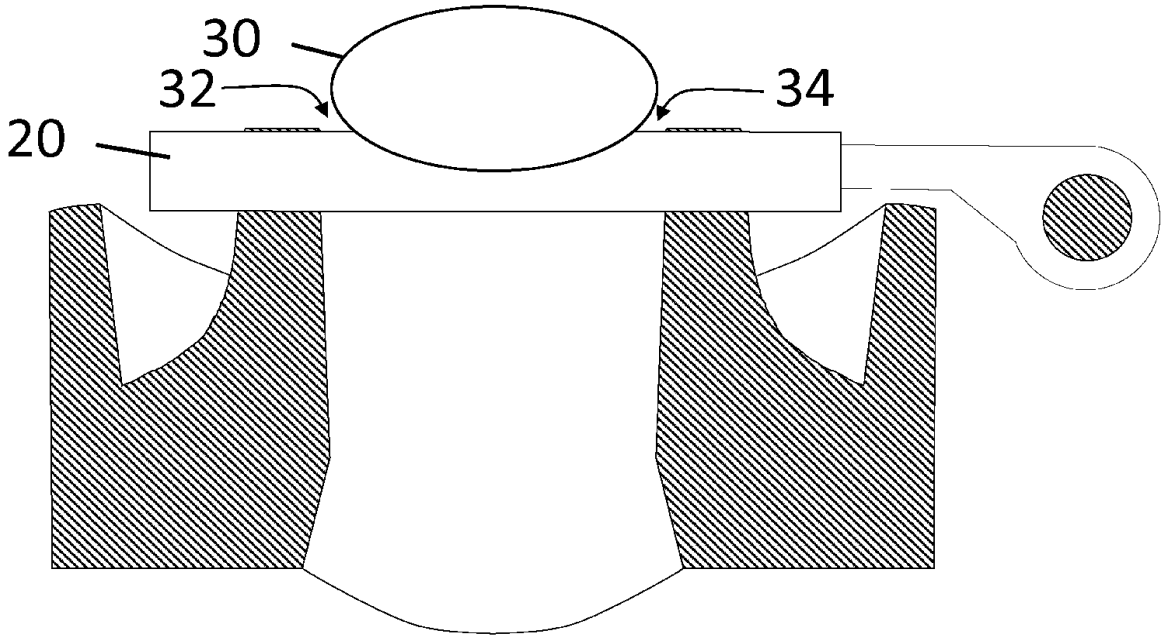


FIG. 3

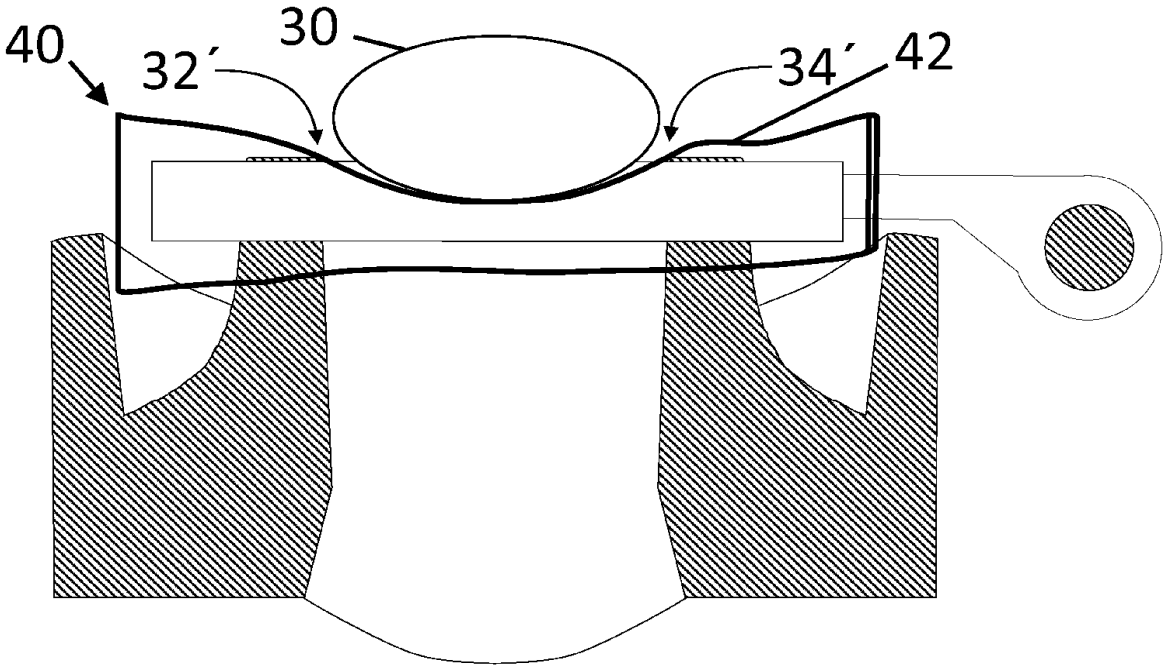


FIG. 5

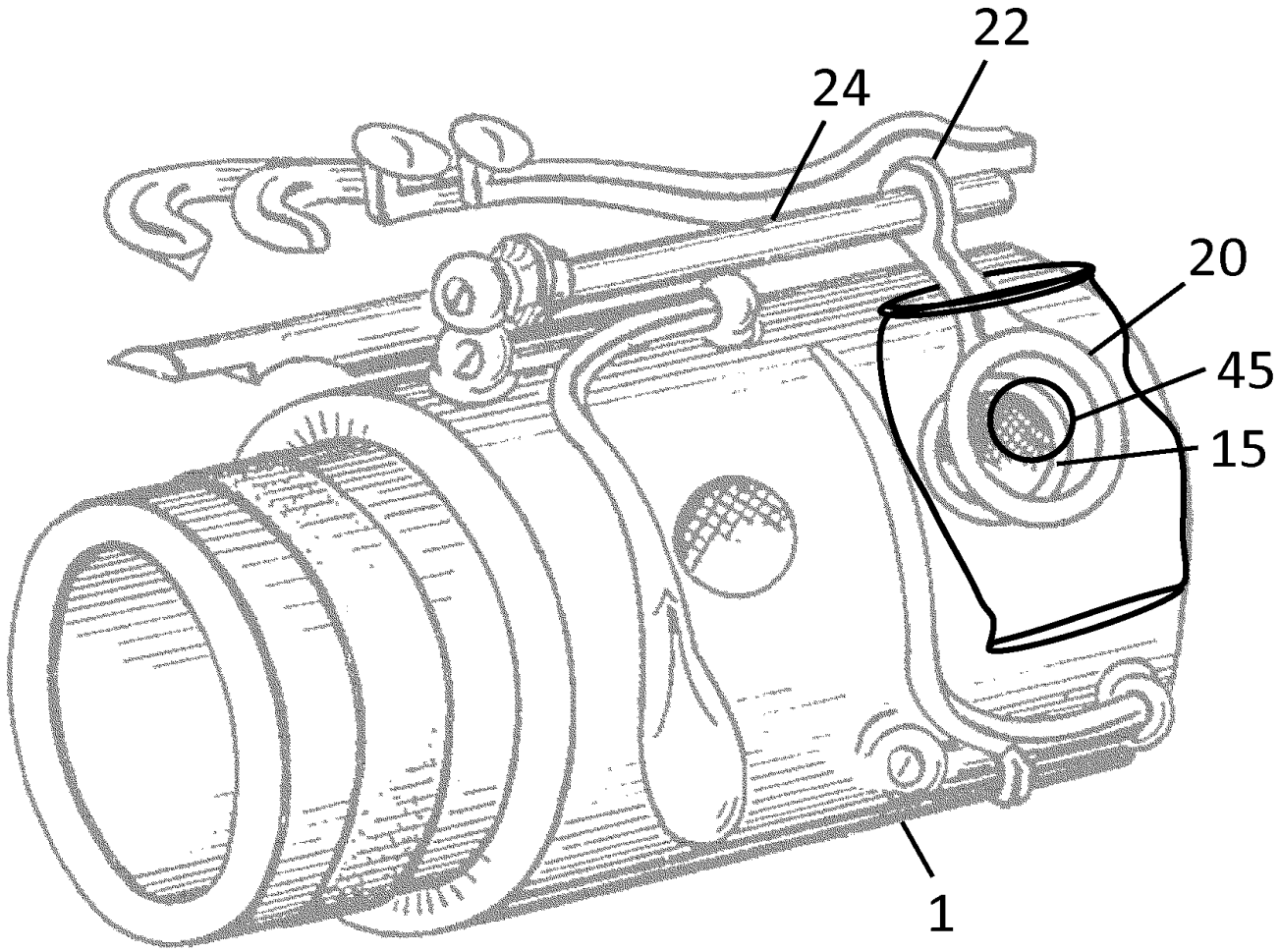


FIG. 6

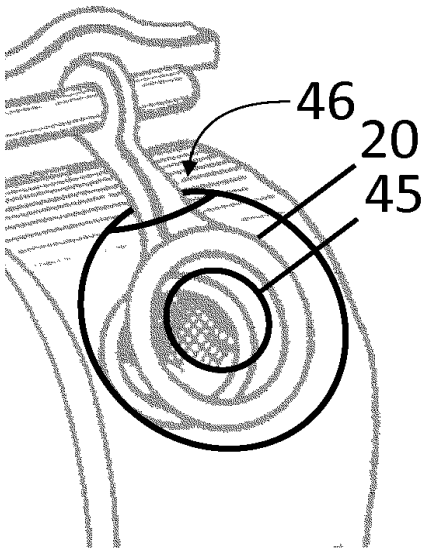


FIG. 7

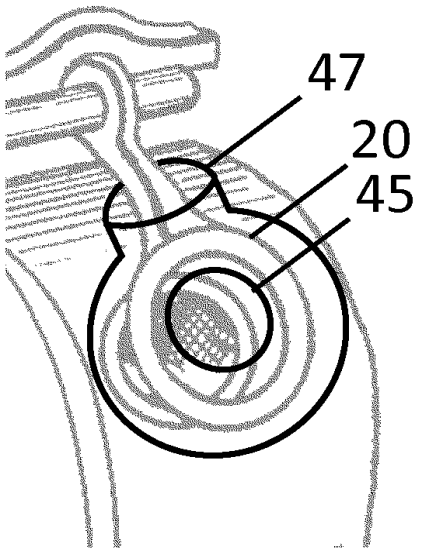


FIG. 8

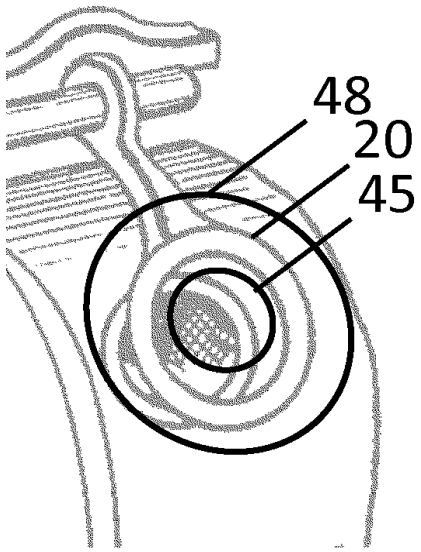


FIG. 9

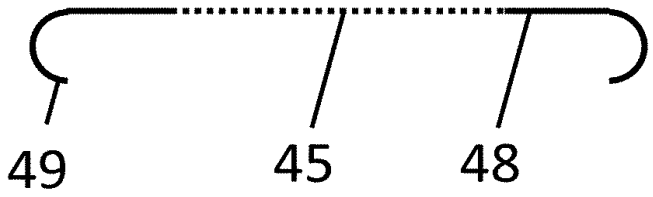


FIG. 10

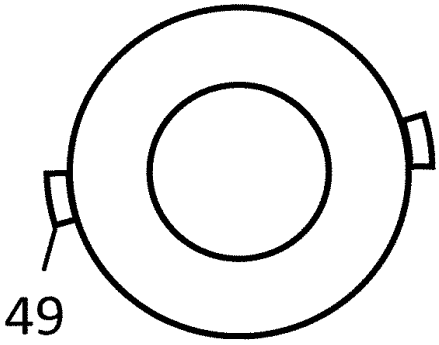


FIG. 11

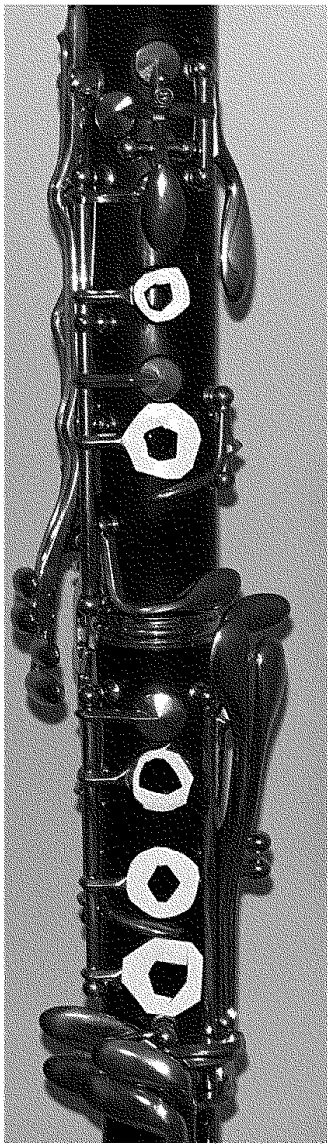


FIG. 12



FIG. 13

CLAIMS

I claim:

1. A clarinet tone hole ring adapter comprising a peripheral region sized and shaped to form air-tight contact with a clarinet tone hole ring about the ring's entire circumference, and a central void defined by the peripheral region.
2. The adapter of claim 1, wherein the adapter comprises a tube of elastomeric material sized and shaped to stretch-fit around the clarinet tone hole ring, thereby defining a top surface of the adapter and a bottom surface of the adapter, further wherein the central void is defined in the top surface and bottom surface by apertures.
3. The adapter of claim 2, wherein the elastomeric material comprises latex.
4. The adapter of claim 1, wherein the adapter comprises and upper layer of adhesive tape having an adhesive side and a lower layer of adhesive tape having an adhesive side, the adhesive sides of the layers facing one another, further wherein the upper layer is sized and shaped to be adhered to a top surface of the tone hole ring, and the lower layer is sized and shaped to be adhered to a bottom surface of the tone hole ring, further wherein the central void is defined in the upper layer and the lower layer by apertures.
5. The adapter of claim 1, wherein the adapter comprises a disk of rigid or semirigid material and an adhesive on a bottom surface of the adapter, the bottom surface being sized and shaped to adhere to the tone hole ring, further wherein the central void is defined in the disk by an aperture.
6. The adapter of claim 5, wherein the bottom surface of the adapter is defined by an airtight material.
7. The adapter of claim 1, further comprising one or more clips extending from the peripheral region, wherein the adapter is sized and shaped to attach to the tone hole ring by the one or more clips.
8. The adapter of claim 7, wherein the clips are lined with airtight material to seal against the tone hole ring.
9. The adapter of claim 1, wherein the adapter comprises a slipcover having a top layer attached peripherally to a bottom layer leaving a side passage sized and shaped to

permit passage of the tone hole ring such that the slipcover encases the tone hole ring, further wherein the top layer and the bottom layer define apertures to form the central void.

10. The adapter of claim 9, further comprising a stem extending from the slipcover sized and shaped to permit passage of the tone hole ring.

11. The adapter of claim 1, wherein the adapter comprises a first layer of adhesive tape sized and shaped to adhere to the tone hole ring, the first layer defining an aperture to form the central void.

12. The adapter of claim 11, further comprising a second layer adhered to a bottom surface of the first layer, the second layer sized and shaped to correspond to an inner diameter of the tone hole ring, thereby shielding adhesive from exposure, the second layer defining an aperture to form the central void.

ABSTRACT

Adapters that cover or narrow the apertures of clarinet tone hole rings may be used to make it easier for players with small fingers or reduced finger mobility to achieve air-tight seals of the tone holes. An adapter may be formed, for example, by a sleeve of a thin, flexible, and elastic material that is slipped over a clarinet ring. The sleeve may define a hole through the plane of the ring to improve air flow through the tone hole when the ring is not depressed.

Doc code: IDS
Doc description: Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Filed

PTO/SB/08 (01-25)
Approved for use through 11/30/2027. OMB 0651-0031
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INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	
Examiner Name	
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

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Examiner Initial*	Cite No	Patent Number	Kind Code[1]	Issue Date	Name of Inventor of cited Document	Pages, Columns, Lines where Relevant Passages or Relevant Figures Appear
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	2	7468479		2008-12-23	Kraus	
	3	7851685		2010-12-14	Reissner	

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Application Number	
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First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	
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	1	"Plateau Mechanism - Covered Holes" -- retrieved from the internet on March 8, 2025 from https://www.clarinet.dk/content/show_content.php?id=101&cont=eu&lang=en&instr=cla	☐
	2	"10pcs Open Hole Flute Plugs" -- retrieved from the internet on March 8, 2025 from https://www.amazon.com/MusicMedic-10pcs-Open-Flute-Plugs/dp/B0829D5DXF	☐

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EXAMINER SIGNATURE

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[1] See Kind Codes of USPTO Patent Documents at www.USPTO.GOV or MPEP 901.04. [2] Enter office that issued the document, by the two-letter code (WIPO Standard ST.3). [3] For Japanese patent documents, the indication of the year of the reign of the Emperor must precede the serial number of the patent document. [4] Kind of document by the appropriate symbols as indicated on the document under WIPO Standard ST.16 if possible. [5] Applicant is to place a check mark here if English language translation is attached.

INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT

Application Number	
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
Art Unit	
Examiner Name	
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

TIMING STATEMENT

Please see 37 CFR 1.97(e) to make the appropriate selection(s):

☐ That each item of information contained in the information disclosure statement was first cited in any communication from a foreign patent office in a counterpart foreign application not more than three months prior to the filing of the information disclosure statement. See 37 CFR 1.97(e)(1).

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☐ See attached timing statement under 37 CFR 1.97(e).

☒ A timing statement under 37 CFR 1.97(e) is not submitted herewith.

TIMING FEE

☐ The fee set forth in 37 CFR 1.17(p) has been submitted herewith.

COPIES

☐ An identification of an earlier application pursuant to 37 CFR 1.98(d)(1) is attached.

SIZE FEE ASSERTION

Please see 37 CFR 1.17(v) and the IDS Auto-Load Instructions for completing this form to make the appropriate selection of an assertion under 37 CFR 1.98. For the information disclosure statement (IDS) submitted herewith, the applicant or patent owner certifies the following with respect to the cumulative number of applicant-provided or patent-owner provided items of information submitted to date including those in the accompanying IDS (select only one):

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SIGNATURE

A signature of the applicant or representative is required in accordance with 37 CFR 1.33 and 11.18. Please see 37 CFR 1.4(d) for the form of the signature.

Signature	/Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543/	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)	2025-03-10
Name/Print	Scott E. Kamholz	Registration Number	48543

INFORMATION DISCLOSURE STATEMENT BY APPLICANT		
	Application Number	
	Filing Date	2025-03-10
	First Named Inventor	KAMHOLZ, Leah M.
	Art Unit	
	Examiner Name	
	Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

This collection of information is required by 37 CFR 1.97 and 1.98. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 1 hour to complete, including gathering, preparing and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. **SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450.**

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The Privacy Act of 1974 (P.L. 93-579) requires that you be given certain information in connection with your submission of the attached form related to a patent application or patent. Accordingly, pursuant to the requirements of the Act, please be advised that: (1) the general authority for the collection of this information is 35 U.S.C. 2(b)(2); (2) furnishing of the information solicited is voluntary; and (3) the principal purpose for which the information is used by the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office is to process and/or examine your submission related to a patent application or patent. If you do not furnish the requested information, the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office may not be able to process and/or examine your submission, which may result in termination of proceedings or abandonment of the application or expiration of the patent.

The information provided by you in this form will be subject to the following routine uses:

1. The information on this form will be treated confidentially to the extent allowed under the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552) and the Privacy Act (5 U.S.C. 552a). Records from this system of records may be disclosed to the Department of Justice to determine whether the Freedom of Information Act requires disclosure of these record s.

2. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, in the course of presenting evidence to a court, magistrate, or administrative tribunal, including disclosures to opposing counsel in the course of settlement negotiations.

3. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a Member of Congress submitting a request involving an individual, to whom the record pertains, when the individual has requested assistance from the Member with respect to the subject matter of the record.

4. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a contractor of the Agency having need for the information in order to perform a contract. Recipients of information shall be required to comply with the requirements of the Privacy Act of 1974, as amended, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 552a(m).

5. A record related to an International Application filed under the Patent Cooperation Treaty in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the International Bureau of the World Intellectual Property Organization, pursuant to the Patent Cooperation Treaty.

6. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to another federal agency for purposes of National Security review (35 U.S.C. 181) and for review pursuant to the Atomic Energy Act (42 U.S.C. 218(c)).

7. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the Administrator, General Services, or his/her designee, during an inspection of records conducted by GSA as part of that agency's responsibility to recommend improvements in records management practices and programs, under authority of 44 U.S.C. 2904 and 2906. Such disclosure shall be made in accordance with the GSA regulations governing inspection of records for this purpose, and any other relevant (i.e., GSA or Commerce) directive. Such disclosure shall not be used to make determinations about individuals.

8. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the public after either publication of the application pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 122(b) or issuance of a patent pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 151. Further, a record may be disclosed, subject to the limitations of 37 CFR 1.14, as a routine use, to the public if the record was filed in an application which became abandoned or in which the proceedings were terminated and which application is referenced by either a published application, an application open to public inspections or an issued patent.

9. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a Federal, State, or local law enforcement agency, if the USPTO becomes aware of a violation or potential violation of law or regulation.

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Application Number	
Filing Date	2025-03-10
First Named Inventor	Leah M. Kamholz
Title	Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters
Art Unit	
Examiner Name	
Attorney Docket Number	LMK-001.01

I hereby revoke all previous powers of attorney given in the above-identified application.

☐ A Power of Attorney is submitted herewith.

OR

☒ I hereby appoint Practitioner(s) associated with the following Customer Number as my/our attorney(s) or agent(s) to prosecute the application identified above, and to transact all business in the United States Patent and Trademark Office connected therewith:

178888

OR

☐ I hereby appoint Practitioner(s) named below as my/our attorney(s) or agent(s) to prosecute the application identified above, and to transact all business in the United States Patent and Trademark Office connected therewith:

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Please recognize or change the correspondence address for the above-identified application to:

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I am the:

☒ Applicant/Inventor.

OR

☐ Assignee of record of the entire interest. See 37 CFR 3.71.
Statement under 37 CFR 3.73(b) (Form PTO/SB/96) submitted herewith or filed on _____.

SIGNATURE of Applicant or Assignee of Record

Signature	/Leah M. Kamholz/	Date	2025-03-10
Name	Leah M. Kamholz	Telephone	
Title and Company			

NOTE: Signatures of all the inventors or assignees of record of the entire interest or their representative(s) are required. Submit multiple forms if more than one signature is required, see below*.

☐ *Total of _____ forms are submitted.

This collection of information is required by 37 CFR 1.31, 1.32 and 1.33. The information is required to obtain or retain a benefit by the public which is to file (and by the USPTO to process) an application. Confidentiality is governed by 35 U.S.C. 122 and 37 CFR 1.11 and 1.14. This collection is estimated to take 3 minutes to complete, including gathering, preparing, and submitting the completed application form to the USPTO. Time will vary depending upon the individual case. Any comments on the amount of time you require to complete this form and/or suggestions for reducing this burden, should be sent to the Chief Information Officer, U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, U.S. Department of Commerce, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450. DO NOT SEND FEES OR COMPLETED FORMS TO THIS ADDRESS. **SEND TO: Commissioner for Patents, P.O. Box 1450, Alexandria, VA 22313-1450.**

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3. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a Member of Congress submitting a request involving an individual, to whom the record pertains, when the individual has requested assistance from the Member with respect to the subject matter of the record.
4. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to a contractor of the Agency having need for the information in order to perform a contract. Recipients of information shall be required to comply with the requirements of the Privacy Act of 1974, as amended, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 552a(m).
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6. A record in this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to another federal agency for purposes of National Security review (35 U.S.C. 181) and for review pursuant to the Atomic Energy Act (42 U.S.C. 218(c)).
7. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the Administrator, General Services, or his/her designee, during an inspection of records conducted by GSA as part of that agency's responsibility to recommend improvements in records management practices and programs, under authority of 44 U.S.C. 2904 and 2906. Such disclosure shall be made in accordance with the GSA regulations governing inspection of records for this purpose, and any other relevant (i.e., GSA or Commerce) directive. Such disclosure shall not be used to make determinations about individuals.
8. A record from this system of records may be disclosed, as a routine use, to the public after either publication of the application pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 122(b) or issuance of a patent pursuant to 35 U.S.C. 151. Further, a record may be disclosed, subject to the limitations of 37 CFR 1.14, as a routine use, to the public if the record was filed in an application which became abandoned or in which the proceedings were terminated and which application is referenced by either a published application, an application open to public inspection or an issued patent.
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Doc Code: MES.GIB
Document Description: Certification of Micro Entity Status (Gross Income Basis)

PTO/SB/15A (07-14)

CERTIFICATION OF MICRO ENTITY STATUS
(GROSS INCOME BASIS)

Application Number or Control Number (if applicable):	Patent Number (if applicable):
First Named Inventor: Leah M. Kamholz	Title of Invention: Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

The applicant hereby certifies the following—

(1) **SMALL ENTITY REQUIREMENT –** The applicant qualifies as a small entity as defined in 37 CFR 1.27.

(2) **APPLICATION FILING LIMIT –** Neither the applicant nor the inventor nor a joint inventor has been named as the inventor or a joint inventor on more than four previously filed U.S. patent applications, excluding provisional applications and international applications under the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT) for which the basic national fee under 37 CFR 1.492(a) was not paid, and also excluding patent applications for which the applicant has assigned all ownership rights, or is obligated to assign all ownership rights, as a result of the applicant's previous employment.

(3) **GROSS INCOME LIMIT ON APPLICANTS AND INVENTORS –** Neither the applicant nor the inventor nor a joint inventor, in the calendar year preceding the calendar year in which the applicable fee is being paid, had a gross income, as defined in section 61(a) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 (26 U.S.C. 61(a)), exceeding the "Maximum Qualifying Gross Income" reported on the USPTO Web site at http://www.uspto.gov/patents/law/micro_entity.jsp which is equal to three times the median household income for that preceding calendar year, as most recently reported by the Bureau of the Census.

(4) **GROSS INCOME LIMIT ON PARTIES WITH AN "OWNERSHIP INTEREST" –** Neither the applicant nor the inventor nor a joint inventor has assigned, granted, or conveyed, nor is under an obligation by contract or law to assign, grant, or convey, a license or other ownership interest in the application concerned to an entity that, in the calendar year preceding the calendar year in which the applicable fee is being paid, had a gross income, as defined in section 61(a) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, exceeding the "Maximum Qualifying Gross Income" reported on the USPTO Web site at http://www.uspto.gov/patents/law/micro_entity.jsp which is equal to three times the median household income for that preceding calendar year, as most recently reported by the Bureau of the Census.

SIGNATURE by an authorized party set forth in 37 CFR 1.33(b)

Signature	/Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543/				
Name	Scott E. Kamholz				
Date	2025-03-10	Telephone	617-678-0222	Registration No.	48,543

☐ There is more than one inventor and I am one of the inventors who are jointly identified as the applicant. The required additional certification form(s) signed by the other joint inventor(s) are included with this form.

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Routine uses of the information in this record may include disclosure to: 1) law enforcement, in the event that the system of records indicates a violation or potential violation of law; 2) a federal, state, local, or international agency, in response to its request; 3) a contractor of the USPTO having need for the information in order to perform a contract; 4) the Department of Justice for determination of whether the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requires disclosure of the record; 5) a Member of Congress submitting a request involving an individual to whom the record pertains, when the individual has requested the Member's assistance with respect to the subject matter of the record; 6) a court, magistrate, or administrative tribunal, in the course of presenting evidence, including disclosures to opposing counsel in the course of settlement negotiations; 7) the Administrator, General Services Administration (GSA), or their designee, during an inspection of records conducted by GSA under authority of 44 U.S.C. 2904 and 2906, in accordance with the GSA regulations and any other relevant (i.e., GSA or Commerce) directive, where such disclosure shall not be used to make determinations about individuals; 8) another federal agency for purposes of National Security review (35 U.S.C. 181) and for review pursuant to the Atomic Energy Act (42 U.S.C. 218(c)); 9) the Office of Personnel Management (OPM) for personnel research purposes; and 10) the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) for legislative coordination and clearance.

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Doc Code: PET.FTF
Document Description: Petition for First-Time Filer Pilot

PTO/SB/464 (01-25)

CERTIFICATION AND PETITION FOR THE FIRST-TIME FILER EXPEDITED EXAMINATION PILOT PROGRAM

(Page 1 of 1)

First-Named Inventor:	Leah M. Kamholz	Nonprovisional Application Number (if known):	
Title of Invention:	Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters		

APPLICANT HEREBY CERTIFIES THE FOLLOWING AND PETITIONS TO PARTICIPATE IN THE FIRST-TIME FILER EXPEDITED EXAMINATION PILOT PROGRAM FOR THE ABOVE-IDENTIFIED APPLICATION.

1. The inventor or, where there are joint inventors, each joint inventor has not been named as the sole inventor or a joint inventor on any other nonprovisional application.
2. The applicant and the inventor or, where there are joint inventors, the applicant and each joint inventor qualify for micro entity status under the gross income basis requirement. Form PTO/SB/15A is or was filed to establish micro entity status.
3. The inventor or, where there are joint inventors, each joint inventor named on the application is reasonably trained on the basics of the USPTO's patent application process. For applicants who are unsure whether they meet this requirement, exemplary patent application training resources that could be used to meet this requirement are available at https://www.uspto.gov/FirstTimePatentFiler.
4. The application (1) is an original, noncontinuing, nonprovisional utility application filed under 35 U.S.C. 111(a); (2) does not claim the benefit of the filing date of any prior-filed nonprovisional application or international application designating the United States; (3) does not claim a right of foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. 119(a)-(d) or (f) to any foreign application; and (4) is not entering the national stage under the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT) as set forth in 35 U.S.C. 371.
5. Special status has not been previously granted in this application.
6. This petition is being filed using Patent Center before a first Office action (including an action containing only a restriction requirement) has issued in the application.
7. The application is being or was filed using Patent Center.
8. The application is complete under 37 CFR 1.51. That is, the application includes a specification, drawing(s) if necessary, at least one claim, an oath or declaration, and payment of all appropriate fees (that is, basic filing, search, and examination fees, and an application size fee if required).
9. The specification, claim(s) and abstract of the application on filing are being or were submitted in DOCX format.
10. The applicant agrees that the application may not contain, or be amended to contain, more than three independent claims, more than twenty total claims, or any multiple dependent claims.
11. The applicant agrees that if any joint inventor is added to the application after a petition has been granted under this program, the applicant must certify (for example, on a separate letter) that the added joint inventor(s) meet(s) the criteria in items (1) - (3) above.

Signature /Scott E. Kamholz, Reg. No. 48,543/	Date 2025-03-10
Name (Printed/Typed) Scott E. Kamholz	Practitioner Registration Number (if applicable) 48,543

Note: *This form must be signed in accordance with 37 CFR 1.33(b). See 37 CFR 1.4(d) for signature requirements and certifications. If this application is being (or was) filed by joint inventor-applicants, either a single copy of this form must be signed by a patent practitioner or each joint inventor-applicant must sign a separate copy of the form. Submit multiple forms if more than one signature is required.**

☐ *Total of _____ SB/464 forms being submitted.

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PTO/AIA/01 (06-12)
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DECLARATION (37 CFR 1.63) FOR UTILITY OR DESIGN APPLICATION USING AN APPLICATION DATA SHEET (37 CFR 1.76)

Title of Invention	Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

As the below named inventor, I hereby declare that:

This declaration is directed to:

- [■] The attached application, or
- [ ] United States application or PCT international application number _____

filed on _____.

The above-identified application was made or authorized to be made by me.

I believe that I am the original inventor or an original joint inventor of a claimed invention in the application.

I hereby acknowledge that any willful false statement made in this declaration is punishable under 18 U.S.C. 1001 by fine or imprisonment of not more than five (5) years, or both.

WARNING:

Petitioner/applicant is cautioned to avoid submitting personal information in documents filed in a patent application that may contribute to identity theft. Personal information such as social security numbers, bank account numbers, or credit card numbers (other than a check or credit card authorization form PTO-2038 submitted for payment purposes) is never required by the USPTO to support a petition or an application. If this type of personal information is included in documents submitted to the USPTO, petitioners/applicants should consider redacting such personal information from the documents before submitting them to the USPTO. Petitioner/applicant is advised that the record of a patent application is available to the public after publication of the application (unless a non-publication request in compliance with 37 CFR 1.213(a) is made in the application) or issuance of a patent. Furthermore, the record from an abandoned application may also be available to the public if the application is referenced in a published application or an issued patent (see 37 CFR 1.14). Checks and credit card authorization forms PTO-2038 submitted for payment purposes are not retained in the application file and therefore are not publicly available.

LEGAL NAME OF INVENTOR

Inventor: Leah M. Kamholz Date (Optional): 2025-03-10

Signature: /Leah M. Kamholz/

Note: An application data sheet (PTO/AIA/14 or equivalent), including naming the entire inventive entity, must accompany this form or must have been previously filed. Use an additional PTO/AIA/01 form for each additional inventor.

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DocCode - SCORE

Placeholder Sheet for Supplemental Content

Application Number: 19075701 Document Date: 03/10/2025

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ELECTRONIC ACKNOWLEDGEMENT RECEIPT

APPLICATION #	RECEIPT DATE / TIME	ATTORNEY DOCKET #
19/075,701	**03/10/2025 09:35:06 PM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

Title of Invention

Clarinet Tone Hole Ring Adapters

Application Information

APPLICATION TYPE	Utility - Nonprovisional Application under 35 USC 111(a)	PATENT #	-
CONFIRMATION #	3414	FILED BY	SCOTT KAMHOLZ
PATENT CENTER #	69497905	FILING DATE	-
CUSTOMER #	178888	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	AUTHORIZED BY	-

Documents

TOTAL DOCUMENTS: 11

DOCUMENT	PAGES	DESCRIPTION	SIZE (KB)
generatedADS69497905.pdf	5	Application Data Sheet	116 KB
LMK-00101-application-APP.TEXT.docx	10	Application body structured text document	1582 KB
LMK-00101-drawings.pdf	4	Drawings-only black and white line drawings	664 KB
sb0015a.pdf	2	Certification of Micro Entity (Gross Income Basis)	195 KB
sb0464.pdf	2	Petition for First-Time Filer Pilot	198 KB
aia0001.pdf	2	Oath or Declaration filed	353 KB
ids-autoload.pdf	5	Information Disclosure Statement (IDS) Form (SB08)	1315 KB

sb0081.pdf	2	Power of Attorney	256 KB
Flute hole plugs prior art.pdf	5	Non Patent Literature	1244 KB
Lohff-Pfeiffer plateau conversion prior art.pdf	5	Non Patent Literature	5347 KB
LMK-00101-application.pdf	10	Auxiliary PDF of Application	153 KB

Digest

DOCUMENT	MESSAGE DIGEST(SHA-512)
generatedADS69497905.pdf	E7DE9D64C933287CFFBAB80F43C45231508C974C52E2F3B34 11C7566EAB8025A3D34D433C5BB0AE02A49B5A75832A8F2E4 9B930035D091CE695CF50B13F52222
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Flute hole plugs prior art.pdf	7651EE1A922D3567FC2558FB0F4DD34199E649837C7795AB3 281621CCBD6612A61E3DA0120001AD1B2A7B196F2B4762A73 50FA06D62152524DD2D88E63DA338E
Lohff-Pfeiffer plateau conversion prior art.pdf	341AEEC497B919DE83621DF533C07EEEB35236F55BACF5566 6FF96768D8675EF68E255D103249F6FC2F79CD740A1E53CC9 A6A08C6FC67496AD5021FAA8BABBB6

LMK-00101-application.pdf

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96E2243FD2C376780DE55048359A46F

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19/075,701	**03/10/2025 09:35:06 PM Z ET**	**LMK-001.01**

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PATENT CENTER #	69497905	AUTHORIZED BY	-
CUSTOMER #	178888	FILING DATE	-
CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESS	-	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	Leah M. Kamholz

Payment Information

PAYMENT METHOD	PAYMENT TRANSACTION ID	PAYMENT AUTHORIZED BY
CARD / 6274	**E202530L36248257**	**SCOTT KAMHOLZ**

FEE CODE	DESCRIPTION	ITEM PRICE($)	QUANTITY	ITEM TOTAL($)
3111	UTILITY PATENT APPL. SEARCH FEE	154.00	1	154.00
3311	EXAMINATION OF ORIGINAL PATENT APPLICATION	176.00	1	176.00
			TOTAL AMOUNT:	**$330.00**

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